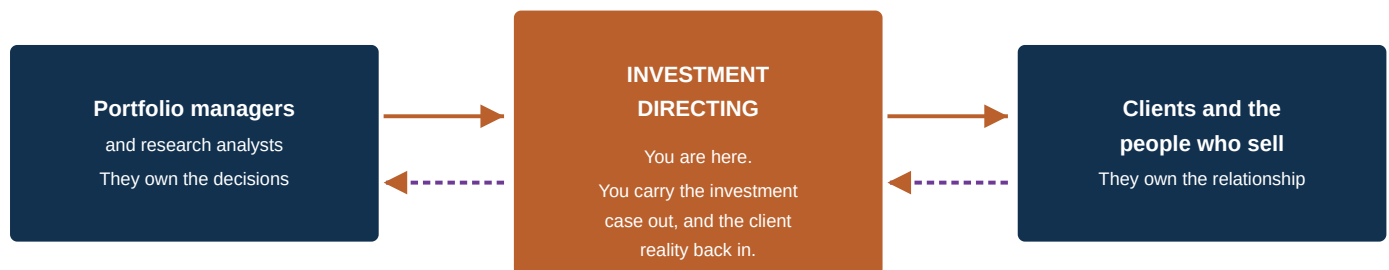


INTERVIEW PREPARATION PACK

Fidelity International Investment Directing

Summer Internship 2027 · London EC4M 5AB · ten weeks · Class of 2028
The role, the firm, the industry, the regulation, and how to hold your frame.



Solid line: the investment view travels outward. Dashed line: what clients need travels back in.

Everything in the orange box is legally a regulated communication before it is a persuasive one.

Structure of the seat, drawn from the job description and a live Fidelity International "Associate Investment Director" posting, accessed 16 September 2026.

PREPARED FOR

A penultimate-year candidate, Class of 2028, with a finance degree and one prior internship. Built against the verbatim job posting.

DEADLINE

Applications close Sunday 15 November 2026, 11:55pm GMT. Two online assessments, about 40 minutes each, must be done by then. Assessment centres December and January.

HEALTH WARNING

Compiled 16 September 2026 from public sources. Fidelity International is private, so much of what is written about it is estimate. This pack says so every time rather than inventing precision.

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Seventeen parts. Read Part 0 first, then the three sections it tells you to read. Everything else is reference you can dip into. Page numbers are real.

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HOW TO READ THE MARKERS

[S14] points to a numbered row in the source table in Part 15, with outlet, title, date, URL and access date. Confidence is tagged inline: **Confirmed** means a primary source or two credible outlets agree; **Reported** means one credible source said it; **Inferred** means it is reasoning by the author of this pack, not a fact anyone published. Only the first of those is safe to state flatly in an interview.

PART 0

How to use this pack

You have sixty days until the window closes, and you are not interviewing tomorrow. That is the best position to be in, because the material that wins this application is the material nobody else bothers to find. Here is the order to read it in.

THE DATES, FROM THE POSTING ITSELF

Application window closes	Sunday 15 November 2026, 11:55pm GMT — sixty days from this pack's compile date
Two online assessments	Around 40 minutes each , and both must be completed <i>before the window closes</i> , not after
Assessment centres	December and January
Eligibility	Penultimate year, graduating in 2028 (Class of 2028), right to work in the UK at point of application
Where	careers.fidelityinternational.com · queries to earlycareersatfidelity@fil.com

Quoted from the 2027 posting [\[S403\]](#) **Confirmed**.

The trap in that table: the assessments are not triggered after you apply and sit in a separate window. They have to be *finished* by 15 November. Two assessments at roughly 40 minutes each is around ninety minutes of focused work. Do not leave them to the final weekend, and note the firm explicitly offers reasonable adjustments if you would benefit from them.

What this pack is, and what it is not

This is a research pack built only from public sources. It is written to take someone with a finance degree and one internship from knowing roughly what an asset manager does to being able to hold a technical conversation about Fidelity International's business model, the Investment Directing function, and the rules that govern what that function is allowed to say to a client.

It is not a script. Every scaffold here is a structure to think inside, not a sentence to recite. Interviewers at asset managers listen to hundreds of these. A memorised answer is audible, and it is worse than a rougher answer that is obviously yours.

Three things this pack does that a normal preparation document does not. It decodes the job description line by line against real, live Fidelity International job postings, so you are working from what the firm actually asks people to do rather than from marketing copy. It gets the regulation right, with rule numbers and dates, because for this specific seat the regulation *is* the job. And it tells you where the evidence is thin, so you never walk into a room repeating something this pack invented.

THE HONESTY RULE THIS PACK FOLLOWS

Fidelity International is a private company. It does not publish quarterly results, hold earnings calls, or file the kind of disclosure a listed rival does. A large share of what is written about it is estimate or single-source reporting. Where that is true, this pack says so and gives a range rather than inventing a precise number. If you quote an estimate as a fact and an interviewer knows the real figure, you have damaged yourself for the rest of the conversation. Saying "reported at around X, though they do not publish it" is stronger, not weaker.

Read in this order

Given the 15 November deadline and assessment centres in December and January, the sequence that pays best is:

1. **Part 0, the rest of this section.** Ten minutes. The facts that do the most work, and the one fact that almost every other preparation source on the internet now has wrong.

- Part 1, the role decoded.** This is what your written application has to show you understand. Fidelity's own early careers language says it does not want pre-existing technical skill but does want "an understanding of what we do and what you would need to do in the role and team you are applying for"^[S262]. Part 1 is that understanding.
- Part 12, "Why Fidelity International".** Written last in this pack, but the thing your application stands or falls on.
- Part 9** now, not later — it covers the two online assessments you must complete before 15 November.
- Part 7 and Part 11** in late November, once the application is in and an assessment centre is the next thing. Part 7 goes stale fastest; re-check it the week of any interview.

The ten-minute emergency version

If you had ten minutes before a conversation about this firm, these are the facts to have.

1969

Founded as the international arm of the Boston firm. Independent since 1980.^[S402]

see note

Size: public figures conflict. Use a range and name the measure. See the box below.^[S402]
^[S122] **Reported**

39.89%

Share reported to be held by the Johnson family per regulatory filings. The rest is management and employees.^[S402]
Reported

SOURCE UNCERTAIN — HOW BIG IS FIDELITY INTERNATIONAL?

Do not quote a single number for this. Public sources disagree, and the disagreement is instructive rather than embarrassing. One widely repeated figure is **US\$1,086bn of total client assets as at 31 December 2025**^[S402]. A figure attributed to the firm's own Pillar 3 regulatory disclosure is materially smaller and split differently: around **US\$469bn of assets under management excluding Canada, plus about US\$203bn of assets under administration, as at 30 June 2025**^[S122] **Reported**.

These are probably not contradictory so much as different measures. **Assets under management** is money the firm actually invests and charges a management fee on. **Assets under administration** is money sitting on its platforms that someone else may manage, where the firm earns a thinner platform or administration fee. "Total client assets" bundles them. A firm that owns both an asset manager and a platform, as this one does, has a large gap between the two numbers, and that gap is the whole subject of Part 3.

What to say: "Reported figures range from roughly 470 billion dollars of assets under management to over a trillion of total client assets depending on whether you count administered platform assets. They are private so it is hard to pin down, and the gap between those two numbers is itself the interesting thing about the business." That answer is correct, honest, and demonstrates you understand the business model. A single confident wrong number does none of that.

WHAT THEY SAY THEY ARE LOOKING FOR, IN THEIR OWN WORDS

The posting is unusually explicit, and it is worth reading literally: "It's who you are that matters here, rather than what you studied." They want interns who are **"analytical, eager to learn and ready to take on a challenge"**, with **"a genuine curiosity and eagerness to learn about investment"**, **"a lively interest in our work and our industry"**, and **"creative thinking and attention to detail"**^[S403] **Confirmed**.

Read that list against the job. "Attention to detail" is not filler in a seat where a wrong number in a factsheet is a regulatory matter. "Lively interest in our industry" is why Part 7 exists. And "creative thinking" in a function this constrained means finding a way to make something clear *within* the rules, not around them. Each of those four phrases is answerable with something specific from this pack.

The nine facts that do most of the work

- Fidelity International is not Fidelity Investments.** The posting describes a firm "helping clients plan and invest for their futures for over 50 years", from "more than 25 locations", serving "everyone from central banks to private individuals"^[S403]. That is the firm you are applying to. It shares a name, a founding family and a history with the Boston business, and they are separate companies. Fidelity International began in 1969 as the overseas arm of the Boston business and became independent in 1980^[S402]

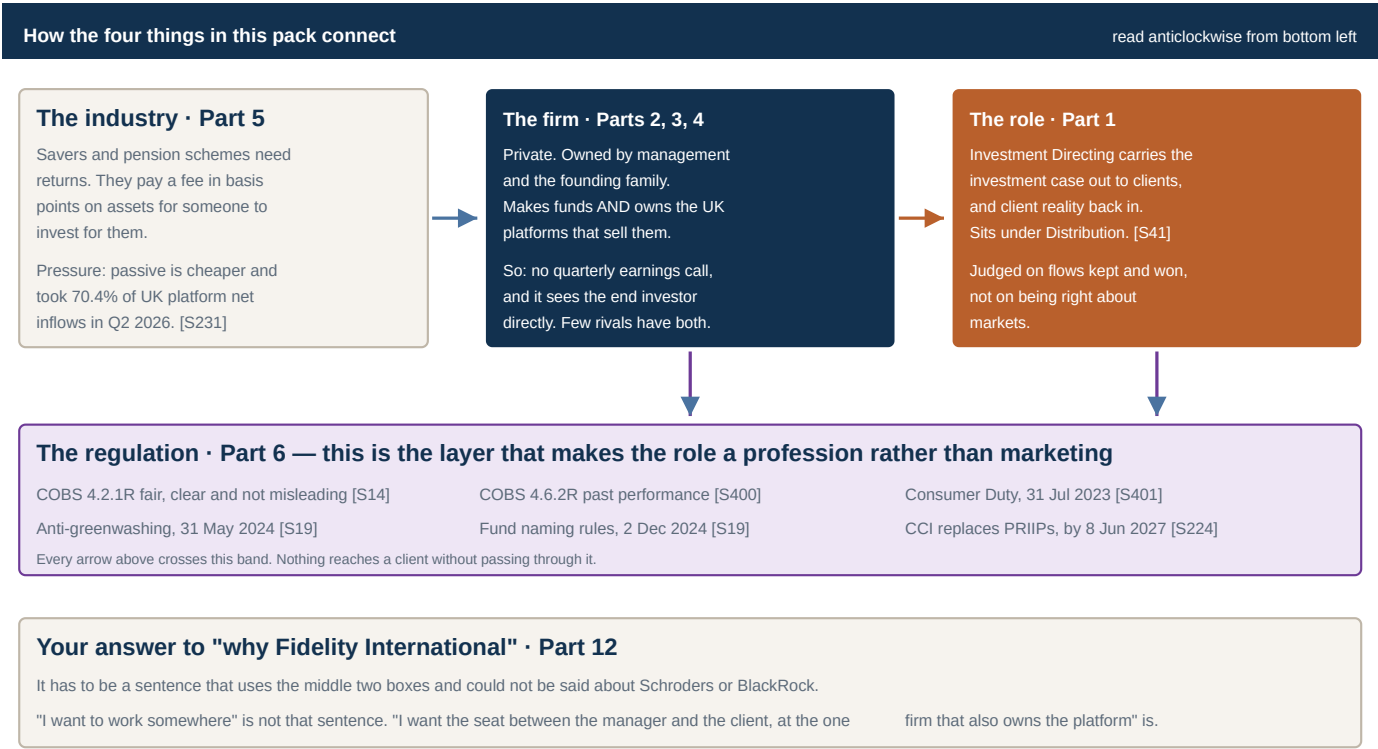
- Confirmed** . It is headquartered in Pembroke, Bermuda, and its largest investment hub is London^{[S402][S44]}. Almost every confusing "Fidelity" story you will read online, and a large share of the internship advice, is about the American firm. Getting this wrong in the first minute is the most common way to lose this interview.
2. **It is private, and that is a business model, not a footnote.** No quarterly earnings call, no share price to defend, no listed currency to pay for acquisitions with. The consequences run through everything in Part 3.
 3. **Investment Directing sits under Distribution, not under the Chief Investment Officer.** Public descriptions place the "Client Propositions team comprised of product, solutions and investment directing teams" under the Global Head of Asset Management Distribution^[S41] **Reported** . That single fact reframes the whole role: you are a commercial function that must be technically credible, not an investment function that happens to talk to clients. Most candidates get this backwards.
 4. **The industry name for the job is Client Portfolio Manager.** Fidelity calls it Investment Director and has a junior grade called Associate Investment Director^[S1]. Schroders and Janus Henderson say Client Portfolio Manager, M&G says Investment Specialist, BlackRock says Product Strategist^{[S2][S3][S4][S5]}. Knowing that the seat exists at every serious firm under different names shows you understand the function, not just the advert.
 5. **Five investment groups.** Equities, Fixed Income, Multi Asset, Systematic Investing and Real Estate. The job description names them, and an Investment Director is assigned to one^{[S21][S1]}. Real Estate is the odd one out because it is physical and illiquid, so it reports to clients differently.
 6. **Everything this function produces is a regulated communication.** The governing rule is COBS 4.2.1R: "A firm must ensure that a communication or a financial promotion is fair, clear and not misleading"^[S14] **Confirmed** . Past performance has its own rules under COBS 4.6.2R, including that it must not be the most prominent feature, must cover the preceding five years in complete twelve-month periods, and must carry a prominent warning that past performance is not a reliable indicator of future results^[S400] **Confirmed** . This is the single highest-leverage technical area for this role.
 7. **The rules changed recently and are still changing.** Consumer Duty, published 27 July 2022, in force for open products 31 July 2023^[S401]. The anti-greenwashing rule from 31 May 2024 and fund naming and marketing rules from 2 December 2024^[S19]. And the Consumer Composite Investments regime, which replaces PRIIPs, commenced 6 April 2026 with full implementation by 8 June 2027^[S224]. That last one lands during and just after your internship, and it means rewriting client documents.
 8. **Active management is under commercial pressure, visibly.** UK platform data for the second quarter of 2026 showed passive funds taking 70.4% of net inflows against 29.6% for active^[S231] **Reported** . Do not pretend this is not happening. The interesting answer is what an active house does about it, which is Part 8.
 9. **The house view is published and quotable.** Fidelity International runs an annual Analyst Survey. The 2026 edition, "A power puzzle", was published 4 April 2026 and draws on its analysts' company meetings^[S288]. Reading one piece of the firm's own research and having a view on it is worth more than any amount of general market commentary.

THE ONE FACT ALMOST EVERY OTHER SOURCE NOW HAS WRONG

Anne Richards became chief executive of Fidelity International in December 2018, and for six years that was the right answer. **It is no longer current.** As of September 2026 the reported leadership is Abigail Johnson as Chair, Anne Richards as Vice Chair, and Keith Metters as President^{[S402][S281]} **Confirmed** . Note also that Abigail Johnson is separately chief executive of Fidelity Investments in Boston, the other firm.

Older preparation articles, forum posts and AI-generated summaries still say "CEO Anne Richards". If you say it to someone who works there, you have told them your research is second-hand and out of date. **Check the firm's own leadership page the week of any interview** and let that override this pack.

FIGURE 1 · THE MASTER MAP



PART 1

The role, decoded

What an Investment Director actually does on a Tuesday, what the internship's duty lines really mean, what binds the job legally, and who sits around you. Built from live Fidelity International job postings rather than from the internship advert.

1.1 What an Investment Director actually is

An Investment Director sits between the people who manage the money and the people who sell it. That is the whole job in one sentence, and almost every other fact about the seat follows from it.

The industry's generic name for this seat is **Client Portfolio Manager**. Fidelity International calls it Investment Director, and runs a junior grade called Associate Investment Director^[S1] **Confirmed**. Schroders and Janus Henderson use Client Portfolio Manager directly; M&G says Investment Specialist; BlackRock says Product Strategist; Baillie Gifford splits the job in two, pairing a Client Manager who owns the commercial relationship with an Investment Specialist who owns the investment content^{[S2][S3][S4][S5][S6]} **Reported**.

That the same function exists at every serious firm under six different names tells you it is structural, not a Fidelity quirk. It exists for an economic reason. A fund manager who is excellent at picking stocks is not necessarily good at spending two hours being cross-examined by a pension scheme's investment consultant, and the firm does not want its scarcest and most expensive investment talent doing that all day. Equally, a salesperson who cannot answer a probing question about duration positioning will lose the room. The Investment Director is built to do both: technically credible enough that the portfolio manager trusts them to speak for the strategy, commercially fluent enough to read a client **Inferred**.

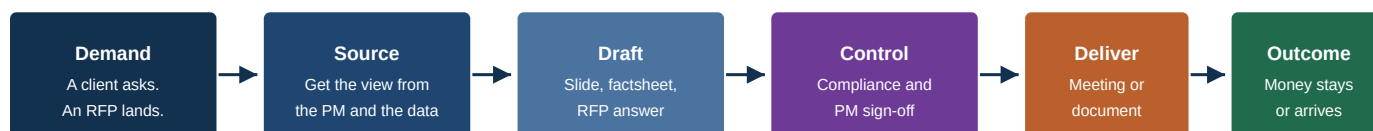
KEY TERM · CLIENT PORTFOLIO MANAGER (CPM)

A client-facing investment professional who represents a strategy to clients but does not make the buy and sell decisions. They explain the portfolio, they do not run it. One live Fidelity International advert describes the role, in the firm's own words, as a "Portfolio Manager (PM) proxy responsible for client facing activities including investment process, strategy updates, product updates, client pitches, client servicing, prospecting, due-diligence, RFPs and product development"^[S47] **Confirmed**. "PM proxy" is the most precise two-word definition of this job you will find anywhere, and it came from Fidelity, not from this pack.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

"The way I understand it, Investment Directing is the translation layer. The portfolio managers own the decisions, Distribution owns the relationship, and the Investment Director is the person who can stand in front of a client and explain the portfolio at the manager's level of detail without being the manager. One of your own adverts calls it a PM proxy, which I thought was a good description."

Why it works: it shows you found a real job posting, it uses the firm's own phrase, and it gets the reporting line right, which most candidates do not.

FIGURE 2 · THE VALUE CHAIN OF THE SEAT**From a client's question to a decision the firm gets paid for**

The intern lives in boxes two and three. The whole value of the seat is destroyed in box four if boxes two and three were sloppy: a number that does not tie to the official record, or a claim the portfolio manager will not stand behind, cannot be fixed later.

Where the money is: the firm earns a management fee in basis points on assets. Nothing in this chain generates revenue directly. It protects and wins the assets that do. That is why the function is judged on flows, not on being right about markets.

Structure inferred from the duty lines in the job description and the duty list in a live Fidelity International posting [S1][S47]. Author's framing.

Figure 2. The role's value chain. **Inferred** structure, built from sourced duty lists. Underlying sources as marked; all accessed 16 September 2026.

1.2 Every duty line, decoded

The posting describes the team's job, then the intern's job. Below, every line is taken apart: what it means, who you deal with, what good looks like, and what it quietly reveals about how the firm is built. Seven team lines and five intern lines, all quoted verbatim.

THIS SECTION IS NOW BUILT ON THE REAL POSTING

Everything below is decoded against the **verbatim 2027 job description**, supplied directly from the Fidelity International careers site^[S403] **Confirmed**. It replaces the reconstruction used in the first draft of this pack. Four things the real posting changed:

- It is **Class of 2028**, graduating in 2028 — penultimate year now. Not 2027.
- The window closes **Sunday 15 November 2026 at 11:55pm GMT**, with assessment centres in December and January.
- There are **two online assessments, each around 40 minutes**, both due before the window closes.
- There are two duty lines the reconstruction missed entirely, decoded as lines 6 and 7 below.

Team line 1 · "Representing the Equities, Fixed Income, Multi Asset, Systematic Investing and Real Estate groups to prospective and existing clients"

What it means. The investment engine is organised into five asset-class groups, and an Investment Director is assigned to one of them, not to all five. A live advert was scoped specifically to Systematic Investing^[S1]. "Representing" means being the person in the room for a prospect meeting, a client review, a consultant call or a conference panel, carrying that group's house view.

Counterparties. Inside: the portfolio managers and analysts in that group, whose views you must reflect rather than invent. Outside: pension schemes, insurers, sovereign wealth funds, wholesale fund selectors, platforms, private banks and wealth managers^{[S1][S10]}.

What good looks like. Technical accuracy that would survive the portfolio manager reading it, plus the ability to translate for a non-specialist without flattening it into something misleading. Those two things pull against each other, and managing that tension is the craft of the job.

What it reveals. Real Estate is the odd one out. It is physical and illiquid, valued by appraisal rather than by a daily market price, so it reports to clients on a different rhythm from a daily-priced equity fund^[S10]. If you are asked which of the five interests you and you pick Real Estate, be ready to say why the illiquidity changes the communication problem. That is a strong answer.

Team line 2 · "Reporting on portfolios"

What it means. The production line of monthly and quarterly factsheets, commentary, client review packs, and performance attribution. Attribution answers: did we beat the benchmark, by how much, and from what — stock selection, sector allocation, duration, currency.

Counterparties. A performance and attribution team supplies the numbers (Fidelity has such roles; a live Dublin vacancy is titled "Performance & Attribution Lead - Associate Director"^[S45]), portfolio managers approve the narrative, and Compliance signs off the wording before it leaves the building.

What good looks like. The numbers tie exactly to the official performance record. You cannot round favourably or quietly drop an ugly period, partly because it is against the rules and partly because a consultant such as Mercer is very likely re-running the same numbers independently^{[S8][S11]}.

Team line 3 · "Promoting thought leadership on topics"

What it means. White papers, "viewpoints", webinars, outlook pieces, conference panels. This is not about one fund's last quarter. It keeps the house view visible so that when a client eventually runs a search, the firm is already in mind.

The trap. Candidates assume thought leadership is the fun, unregulated part. It is not. A white paper is a financial promotion in FCA terms just as much as a factsheet is, and clears the same "fair, clear and not misleading" bar^[S14].

Team line 4 · "Working with product development to create new products to meet investors' demands"

What it means. There is a distinct Product function, separate from both the investment teams and Distribution. Live Fidelity vacancies include "Product Owner - Equity" and "Product Owner - Multi-Asset"^{[S43][S44]} Confirmed. So the firm splits *manage*, *manufacture* and *sell* three ways. Investment Directing is the channel through which structured client demand — the same RFP question asked eleven times, a consultant's repeated objection, a platform's request for a different share class — flows back into what gets built. One live advert lists "Content for Product launches, reshapes, DDQ, RFPs, perspectives" as a deliverable^[S1].

Team line 5 · "Generating marketing material to support sales activity"

What it means. Pitchbooks, RFP and DDQ answers, one-pagers, case studies. Highest volume, most junior-accessible, and almost certainly where most of your ten weeks will go, because drafting a first version needs accuracy and structure rather than years of judgement.

KEY TERMS · RFP AND DDQ

A **Request for Proposal** is a formal document a prospective client or its consultant sends out when it wants to hire a manager, containing dozens to hundreds of questions. A **Due Diligence Questionnaire** is the same idea aimed at how the firm is run: its controls, its people, its risk processes. Both are answered largely from a maintained library of approved answers, which someone has to keep current. That someone is often the most junior person in the team. It sounds dull and it is genuinely important: the answers are contractual in tone and wrong ones are expensive.

Team line 6 · "The team has a strong knowledge of markets and Fidelity's portfolio strategies, combined with a capacity to communicate these in different formats, including through direct client relationships"

What it means. This is the person specification hiding inside the team description, and it is the most revealing sentence in the whole posting. It names two capabilities and insists on both: *knowing* markets and the firm's strategies, and *communicating* them "in different formats". Note which comes first and which is described as a "capacity" — the knowledge is assumed, the communication is the differentiator.

"Different formats" is a list you should be able to produce. A factsheet, a pitchbook, an RFP answer, a webinar, a white paper, a two-minute answer in a meeting, a one-line reply to a salesperson. The same underlying view, recast for each. The skill is not writing; it is knowing what to drop for each format without the remaining version becoming misleading.

"Including through direct client relationships" is the phrase to notice. It confirms that this team does not only produce material for other people to deliver. Investment Directors hold relationships themselves. That is what separates this seat from a marketing or content role, and it is the single best justification for why the job requires genuine technical depth.

Team line 7 · "The Investment Team manages portfolios on behalf of institutional, wholesale and retail clients all around the world"

What it means. All three channels, not one. Institutional means pension schemes, insurers, sovereign wealth funds — and, per the posting's own opening, "everyone from central banks to private individuals"^[S403]. Wholesale means fund selectors, wealth managers and private banks. Retail means end investors, many of them reached through Fidelity's own UK platforms.

KEY DETAIL · "CENTRAL BANKS"

Very few asset managers list central banks among their clients, and the firm does so in the first paragraph of this advert. It is consistent with the Government Institutional Group named on its own distribution pages^[S303]. Central banks and sovereign institutions are the most conservative, most process-driven clients in the market: long due diligence, heavy reporting requirements, and almost no tolerance for a number that does not tie out. If you want one sentence that explains why this function is so controlled, it is that some of its readers are central banks.

Why the three channels matter to you. The same fund, explained to a central bank, an adviser and a retail investor, is three different documents under three different regulatory intensities. Consumer Duty's consumer understanding outcome bites hardest at the retail end^[S401]. That is the practical reason the posting asks for a "capacity to communicate these in different formats".

The five intern lines

The advert says, verbatim	Which means	Judged on
"Support investment directing and investment specialists"	You are embedded support. You are not leading a client meeting, though you may sit in one.	Whether senior people stop checking your work as closely by week six.
"Prepare core marketing presentations and reporting materials to support sales activities"	Pitchbook slides and factsheet drafts. The grind, and the actual apprenticeship.	Accuracy first, speed second, design third. In that order.
"Work with internal stakeholders to source key data and obtain the latest internal views on issues"	You are a junior information broker: go to an analyst, get a current view, package it without misquoting them.	Whether busy people take your call twice. This is the real test of the internship.
"Assist with project management tasks as assigned by the team"	Roadshow logistics, meeting follow-ups, CRM records, template building.	Nothing dropped. Unglamorous and highly visible when it fails.
"You'll experience fund and market analysis, client reporting, and will work with colleagues from across the investment specialist teams, the fund analysts, Portfolio Managers and local sales and marketing professionals"	The line the reconstruction missed. It names your counterparties explicitly: investment specialists, fund analysts, portfolio managers, and local sales and marketing. Four groups, three of them more senior and busier than you.	Whether those four groups would have you back. "Fund and market analysis" is also a promise of real analytical work, not only production.

Duty lines quoted verbatim from the 2027 posting ^[S403] **Confirmed** ; the "which means" and "judged on" columns are the author's reading **Inferred** .

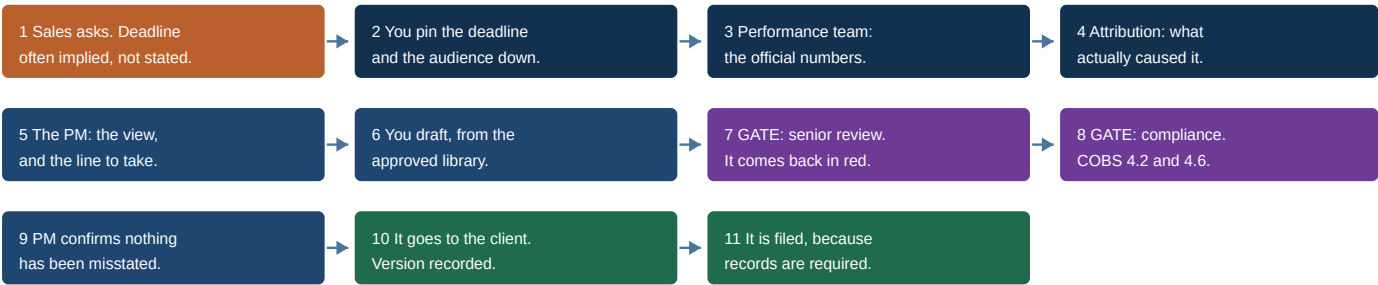
YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

Of the five duty lines, which one do you think is hardest to do well, and why? There is no right answer, and having one ready is worth more than knowing all five. A defensible view: line three, thought leadership, because it is the only output with no deadline forcing it and no client demanding it, so it is the first thing dropped when the quarter gets busy, and the first thing a competitor beats you on. Write your own version in the margin.

FIGURE 3 · THE LIFE OF ONE REQUEST

"Can you send the client something on why the fund lagged last quarter?"

Eleven steps, four teams, two control gates. This is what "prepare reporting materials" actually means.



Where an intern's time actually goes: steps 3, 4, 6 and the loop back through 7.
Sales sees step 1 and step 10 and thinks the job took an afternoon. Knowing that gap exists is most of what makes someone easy to work with.

Sequence inferred from the duty lists in [S1] and [S47] and the control requirements in [S14] and [S400]. Author's construction.

Figure 3. One request end to end. Inferred process. Underlying sources as marked; all accessed 16 September 2026.

1.3 A worked day in the seat

FIGURE 4 · THE DAY, TWO SEATS COMPARED

A plausible day. Times are London.

This is a reconstruction from the sourced duty lists, not a published schedule. Treat as illustrative.

	The intern	The Investment Director
07:00	Read the overnight wrap: Asia close, US close	Asia handover note. Anything that moves a fund?
08:30	Team stand-up: what is due today	Sync with PMs: the line to take today
09:30	Production block. Pitchbook slides, pull attribution numbers, chase an analyst for a current view.	Client-facing block. A portfolio review, a consultant due-diligence call, or delivering a new-business pitch.
12:00		
13:00	Lunch, often an internal speaker session	Working lunch with Distribution on a live pitch
15:00	Review loop: your draft comes back marked up. Incorporate, resubmit.	Sign-off. Reviewing the junior drafts, carrying the accuracy risk personally.
17:00		
18:00	Project work: CRM, templates, roadshow logistics, set up tomorrow	US overlap window, then thought leadership or product work

Note the symmetry: your 15:00 review loop is their 15:00 sign-off. You are two ends of the same control. [Inferred from S1, S47]

Figure 4. Reconstructed day. Inferred — do not present this to an interviewer as a fact about Fidelity's schedule. Present it as your understanding of the shape of the work. Method diagram: no external source. Devised by the author of this pack; compiled 16 September 2026.

1.4 What the team is judged on

No firm publishes its internal targets, and none were found for Fidelity^[S1]. The structural logic points to three things Inferred :

- Net flows and asset retention for the strategies covered. Money kept is worth as much as money won, and is cheaper to get.
- Win rate on RFPs and pitches. The industry treats this as a measurable, improvable skill; vendors sell software on precisely that claim^[S13] Reported .

- **Consultant ratings and buy-list status.** A manager usually has to be rated by a gatekeeper such as Mercer, WTW or Aon before most institutional searches will consider it^[S11]. The UK investment consultants' market was significant enough that the Competition and Markets Authority ran a full market investigation into it^[S12].

The sharpest version of the third point, and a good thing to say out loud: a downgrade by one consultant can shut off more new business than any marketing campaign can replace. That is why this function exists at a senior level at all.

DON'T SAY THIS

"I'd be judged on how persuasive the materials are." No. Persuasion that outruns the evidence is the specific failure mode the rules in 1.5 exist to prevent. The honest version is that you are judged on whether clients stay invested through a bad quarter because the explanation was good and true, not because it was flattering.

1.5 The control dimension: why you cannot just write what sells

This is the single highest-value thing you can raise unprompted, because the naive answer — "I would write compelling material that helps win the mandate" — is exactly what marks a candidate as not having done the reading.

Nearly everything this function produces is, in FCA terms, a communication with a client or a financial promotion. Both are bound by hard rules. Here are the ones that matter, with the numbers and dates, because vague gestures at "compliance" are worth nothing and precise references are worth a great deal.

The rule	Date	What it actually forbids or requires
COBS 4.2.1R Fair, clear and not misleading	In force	The umbrella rule. Verbatim: "A firm must ensure that a communication or a financial promotion is fair, clear and not misleading" ^[S14] . Guidance under COBS 4.2.5G warns against words like "guaranteed" or "protected" unless they genuinely apply. Confirmed
COBS 4.6.2R Past performance	In force	Past performance must not be "the most prominent feature of the communication"; must cover the preceding five years (or the life of the product if shorter) in complete twelve-month periods; must state the reference period and source; must carry "a prominent warning that the figures refer to the past and that past performance is not a reliable indicator of future results"; must state the currency with a fluctuation warning if not sterling; and must disclose the effect of fees if shown gross ^[S400] . Confirmed <i>The consequence worth saying out loud: you cannot pick a flattering start date. The rule fixes the window.</i>
Consumer Duty PS22/9	Published 27 Jul 2022; in force 31 Jul 2023 (open products), 31 Jul 2024 (closed)	Four outcomes: products and services, price and value, consumer understanding, consumer support ^[S401] . The consumer understanding outcome bites directly on this job: material that is technically true but written so the risk or cost is hard to grasp now fails, even if it breaches no older rule. Confirmed
MiFID II product governance	2018 onward	Every fund has a defined target market, reviewed over time, and distributors must be given what they need to sell it only into that market ^[S16] . Your pitch has to be consistent with the target market. It is not free to be aimed at whoever might buy. Reported
Anti-greenwashing rule	In force 31 May 2024	Any sustainability claim about a product must be fair, clear and not misleading ^[S19] . Confirmed

The rule	Date	What it actually forbids or requires
SDR naming and marketing ESG 4.3.2R–4.3.8R, from PS23/16	PS23/16 published 28 Nov 2023; labels usable 31 Jul 2024; naming rules 2 Dec 2024; extension to 2 Apr 2025	A fund cannot be named or marketed as sustainable, ESG or impact unless it earns that description under the specific rules ^{[S19][S20]} . Confirmed
Consumer Composite Investments replaces PRIIPs	Commenced 6 Apr 2026; full implementation 8 Jun 2027	The disclosure regime that governs the key documents retail investors receive is being replaced ^[S224] . This lands during and just after your internship, which makes it the single best live example to raise. Reported
GIPS	Industry standard	Performance quoted in marketing traces back to a compliant composite built to fixed rules, so a firm cannot show only its best account ^[S18] . Many institutional RFPs require it. Reported
Market abuse and wall-crossing FCA TR15-01	Review published 2 Mar 2015	You sit near people holding price-sensitive views. The FCA's thematic review set out good practice: independent contact points for soundings so information can be declined before a manager hears a company name, tight logs of who knows what, pre-clearance before meeting a company close to results. Poor practice included a manager being wall-crossed, not trading, and never logging it ^[S17] . Confirmed

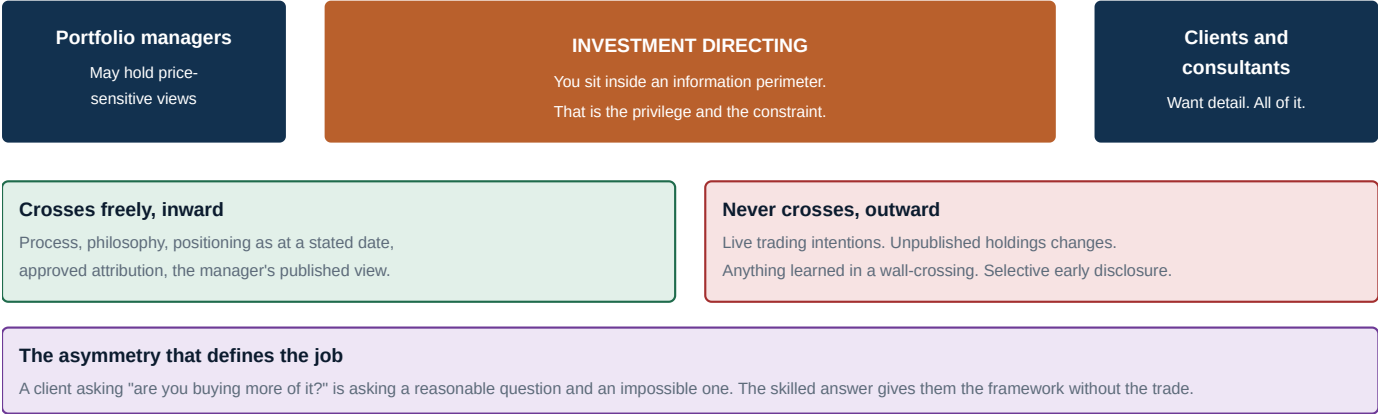
Regulatory references verified against primary FCA sources where marked Confirmed. Rule text is a living document; re-check before quoting in a written assessment.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

"The thing that surprised me reading into the role is that it is not really a marketing job, it is a regulated-communications job. Everything the team produces is a financial promotion under COBS 4.2, so it has to be fair, clear and not misleading. Past performance has its own rules — it can't be the most prominent feature and it has to cover five complete twelve-month periods, so you can't choose a flattering start date. And Consumer Duty added a consumer understanding test on top, so material can be true and still fail. That constraint is what makes the job interesting to me rather than off-putting."

Why it works: three specific, correct references; it reframes a "soft" job as a technical one; and the last sentence answers the motivation question before it is asked.

FIGURE 5 · THE WALLS AROUND THE SEAT
What crosses each boundary, and what never does



Boundary content drawn from FCA TR15-01 good and poor practice examples [S17]. Diagram is the author's construction.

Figure 5. The information boundaries around the function. Content sourced ^[S17]; arrangement **Inferred**. Underlying sources as marked; all accessed 16 September 2026.

1.6 Career path from this seat

One rung is confirmed from real postings: **Associate Investment Director** exists as a distinct grade below Investment Director^[S1] **Confirmed**. A regional **Head of Investment Directing, Asia Pacific** post is confirmed to exist by a Hong Kong advert naming it as the reporting line^[S47] **Confirmed**. The rest of the ladder — intern, analyst, associate, director, head — follows standard industry convention but was not confirmed by a named Fidelity posting **Inferred**.

The lateral moves this seat opens follow directly from who you work with daily: into Product, into Distribution, or — for those who build the deepest technical grounding — into an investment research seat. The seat is unusually good for optionality because it is one of the few that touches the investment floor, the sales floor and the product function in the same week.

1.7 The team, reconstructed from public evidence

Fidelity International publishes no org chart for this function. What follows was rebuilt from live job adverts, press coverage and public professional profiles. The method is shown so you can judge the evidence yourself, and so you can describe how you did it, which is itself a good answer.

THE METHOD · JOB ADVERTS ARE AN ORG CHART IN DISGUISE

A company will not publish its structure, but it will publish a hundred job adverts that each name a reporting line and a set of partner teams. Collect enough of them and the shape appears. Two adverts did most of the work here, and both are quoted below.

Where the function sits — the single most useful structural finding

Public descriptions place "the Client Propositions team comprised of product, solutions and investment directing teams" under the Global Head of Asset Management Distribution, from March 2024^{[S41][S53]} **Reported**, corroborated across two independent write-ups.

So Investment Directing is owned by Distribution, not by the Chief Investment Officer organisation. Most candidates assume the opposite. It reframes the role as a commercial function that must be technically credible, rather than an investment function that happens to face clients.

But the picture is not clean, and saying so is better than pretending otherwise. Two live adverts point different ways:

*An "Investment Director, Fixed Income" role in Hong Kong reports to the "**Head of Investment Directing, Asia Pacific**", and describes the job as a "Portfolio Manager (PM) proxy responsible for client facing activities including investment process, strategy updates, product updates, client pitches, client servicing, prospecting, due-diligence, RFPs and product development".*

Live Fidelity International job advert ^[S47] **Confirmed**. The same advert states the fixed income business it supports manages "over \$US80 billion".

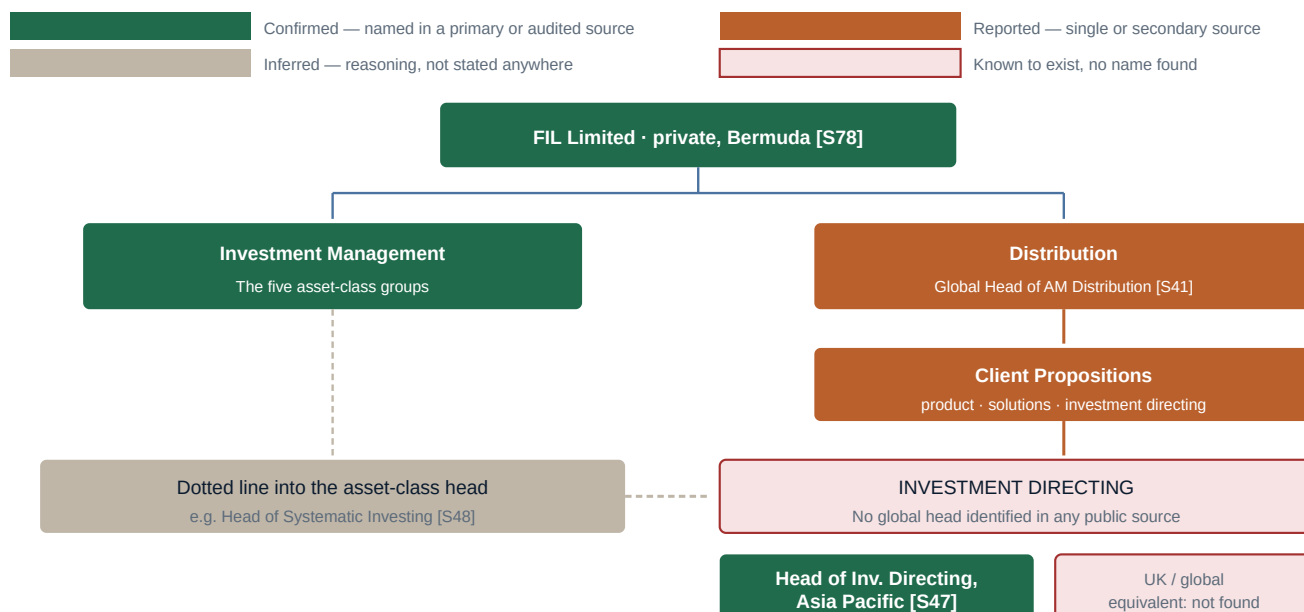
*An "Associate Investment Director – Systematic Investing" role in London reports instead to the "**Head of Systematic Investing**", sits in an "ISS Client Propositions team", and names its key partners as "Multi Asset, Solutions, ETFs, Investment Management, Distribution (PMs, PSG, Stats, PCR, Sales & Marketing, RFP teams)".*

Live Fidelity International job advert ^[S48] **Confirmed**. The same advert says Systematic Investing has grown from roughly \$3bn to roughly \$30bn of assets in about five years.

The honest reading: Investment Directing is **matrixed**. It is owned centrally by Distribution, and individual post-holders can be line-managed by the asset-class head they represent. That is normal in asset management, and the public record does not fully resolve it **Inferred**.

FIGURE 6 · THE RECONSTRUCTED ORG CHART

Colour shows how well evidenced each box is, not how senior it is



The red boxes are the honest part of this diagram. A post is confirmed to exist in Asia Pacific because an advert names it as a reporting line; no name, and no UK equivalent, was found. [S40][S47][S48]

Figure 6. Reconstructed structure, colour-coded by evidence quality. Mixed confidence as shown. Underlying sources as marked; all accessed 16 September 2026.

How big is the team?

SOURCE UNCERTAIN — THIS IS AN ESTIMATE, AND THE METHOD MATTERS MORE THAN THE NUMBER

No source anywhere gives a headcount for Investment Directing. Building one from the structure: five asset-class groups, across roughly two to three regional hubs, at perhaps two to five people per cell, gives a range of very roughly **30 to 80 people globally**^[S40].
Inferred .

Cross-checks: Janus Henderson disclosed a twelve-person Portfolio Construction and Strategy team, though that figure is from 2021 and the scope is not identical^[S40]. Fidelity International's UK average headcount was 2,941 in 2024^[S78], so this function is a small fraction of one per cent of the firm.

Do not quote the range as fact. If it comes up, give the method and call it a guess. The method is the impressive part.

Where the work splits

- **By asset class.** Equities, Fixed Income, Multi Asset, Systematic Investing, Real Estate. Notably, no Real Estate *Investment Director* title was found, only an "Implementation Director, Real Estate"^[S43].
- **By region.** An Asia Pacific Investment Directing line is confirmed^[S47]. Fidelity describes London as its largest investment hub^[S44].
- **By channel.** The firm's own Distribution pages name a Global Institutional Team, a Government Institutional Group, retail and wholesale funds, DC and Workplace Savings, Personal Investing and Adviser Solutions^[S303].

FIGURE 7 · WHAT THE FIRM WAS ADVERTISING FOR

Live and recent vacancies found in this research, by office

A snapshot on 16 September 2026, not a complete list. Absence from this chart is not evidence a function does not exist in that office.

London Associate Investment Director, Systematic Investing Product Owner – Equity Implementation Director, Real Estate ESG Data & Reporting Manager, Real Estate Solutions Implementation Associate Director / Director [S43][S46]	Hong Kong Investment Director, Fixed Income Senior Investment Specialist Product Owner – Multi-Asset Product Owner – Fixed Income Portfolio Construction & Risk Analyst, and Senior Analyst [S44][S47]	Dublin Performance & Attribution Lead, Associate Director Otherwise technology, data and customer service roles. Nothing found in Luxembourg, Frankfurt, Paris, Singapore, Tokyo, Shanghai, Toronto or Sydney. Recorded as a gap, not an absence. [S45]
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The interesting signal: Hong Kong carries more client-facing investment-specialist vacancies than London did on this date, consistent with the firm's Asian weighting. [Inferred]

Figure 7. Vacancy snapshot. Titles **Confirmed** verbatim from fetched listings; the inference is the author's.

What rivals call the same seat

Firm	Title used	Notes
Fidelity International	Investment Director, and Associate Investment Director	Sits under Distribution via Client Propositions[S41]
Schroders, Janus Henderson	Client Portfolio Manager	The industry-standard term[S2][S3]
M&G, JPMorgan AM	Investment Specialist	JPMAM describes an "integrated team model"[S4][S64]
BlackRock	Product Strategist	Sits within Investment Product Strategy[S5]
Baillie Gifford	Client Manager plus Investment Specialist	Splits the job in two rather than combining it[S6]

Titles as found in public postings and careers pages. Most peer rows are **Reported** from search summaries rather than fetched pages.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

"I tried to work out how the team is actually structured and couldn't find an org chart, so I went through job adverts instead. What I took from it is that Investment Directing sits under Distribution, in a Client Propositions group alongside product and solutions — but the reporting lines look matrixed, because a Hong Kong fixed income role reports to a Head of Investment Directing for Asia Pacific while a London systematic role reports to the Head of Systematic Investing. Have I read that right?"

Why it works: it demonstrates a research method rather than a memorised fact, it lands a genuinely non-obvious structural insight, and the closing question protects you if the public record is out of date.

PART 2

The firm as a business

Not the brochure. Where the money comes from, what it costs to earn, who owns the place, and what has gone wrong. Built where possible from audited accounts filed at Companies House, because the global parent publishes nothing comparable.

2.1 The founding insight, and the split that explains everything

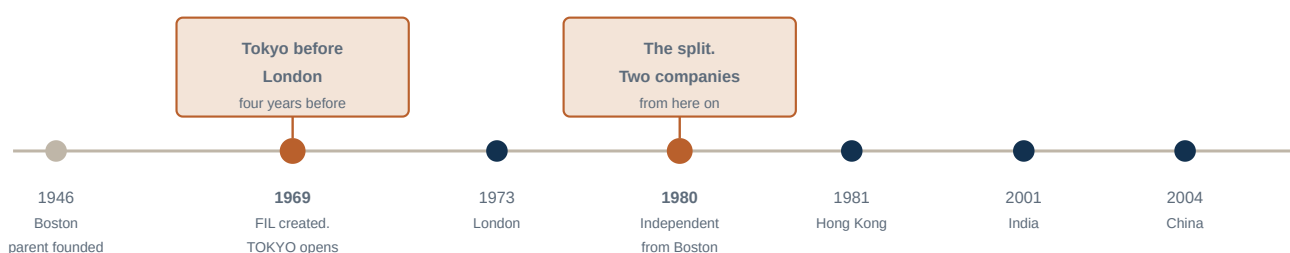
Fidelity Management & Research was founded in Boston by Edward C. Johnson II in 1946^[S70]. Fidelity International was set up in 1969 as its international arm, opening in Tokyo that same year, then London in 1973 and Hong Kong in 1981^[S70] **Reported**. In 1980, under Edward "Ned" Johnson III, the international business was separated from the US parent and became independently owned^[S70] **[S402]** **Confirmed**.

Three consequences follow from that, and they run through the rest of this pack.

- **They are two companies.** Fidelity International and Fidelity Investments share a name, a founding family and a pre-1980 history, and nothing else operationally. Get this wrong and the interview effectively ends.
- **Asia is not an afterthought.** Tokyo came before London. Most UK-associated asset managers built a domestic book first and bolted Asia on later. This one did the reverse^[S70]. That is why it still runs long-established single-country vehicles such as Fidelity Japan Trust, Fidelity China Special Situations and Fidelity Asian Values^[S72] — products a UK-only competitor would struggle to staff credibly.
- **It stayed private.** FIL Limited is incorporated in Bermuda, registered at Pembroke Hall, 42 Crow Lane, Hamilton HM19^[S78] **Confirmed from the audited related-party note of the UK group accounts**.

FIGURE 8 · THE FIRM OVER TIME

Where and when it was built. Note the order.



Dates [S70, Reported], corroborated by [S402]. The observation that Asia preceded London is the author's reading of that sequence.

Figure 8. Founding sequence. **Reported** dates.

Who owns it

A partnership controlled by Edward C. Johnson III and family has been reported to hold voting rights over approximately **39.89%** of FIL voting stock, with the balance held by fund managers and senior employees^{[S79][S402]} **Reported**.

SOURCE UNCERTAIN — THE OWNERSHIP SPLIT

The 39.89% figure is widely repeated but traces to a single secondary report of a company statement, and appears to date from a 2012 Bermuda filing^[S79]. The commonly quoted "roughly 40 to 45 per cent employee-owned" claim **could not be verified against any primary source** and is not repeated here as fact. Say "management and the founding family, with the family reported at just under 40 per cent of voting stock" and you are on safe ground.

The firm's own stated purpose, quoted verbatim from the 2024 statutory accounts, is "working together to build better financial futures"^[S78] **Confirmed** . Its own website adds a line worth remembering because it connects ownership to behaviour: "As a private company we think generationally and invest for the long term"^[S76] **Confirmed** .

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

"The 1980 split is the fact I'd want to get right first. Fidelity International has been a separate company from the Boston business since then, and it was built out of Asia before it was built out of London — Tokyo in 1969, London in 1973. That's why it can run a China or a Japan trust with its own research behind it, which most UK-headquartered managers of that size cannot."

2.2 How the money actually flows

The global parent files no public group accounts. Its UK subsidiaries do, and they are audited. That is the back door into the real numbers, and using it is itself a good answer to "how did you research a private firm?"

FIL Holdings (UK) Limited is the UK sub-group. Its consolidated accounts for the year ended 31 December 2024, audited by PricewaterhouseCoopers, give the following^[S78] **Confirmed** :

£293.9bn Total UK customer assets at 31 Dec 2024: £189.5bn managed plus £104.4bn administered ^[S78]	£1,228m UK group turnover, FY2024. Essentially flat on 2023's £1,225m ^[S78]	£66.8m UK group operating profit, FY2024, down about 35% from £103.1m ^[S78]
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The two fee engines, and why they are not the same business

The turnover splits into investment management fees of £666.772m, service and platform fees of £213.701m, other distribution revenue of £58.033m and other income of £289.587m^[S78] . Set the first two against the assets that generate them and the business model becomes visible:

Engine	Assets	Fees FY2024	Implied margin	What it is
Asset management Assets under management	£189.5bn	£666.772m	≈35 bps	Fidelity picks the investments and charges a management fee.
Platform Assets under administration	£104.4bn	£213.701m	≈20 bps	Money on Fidelity's platforms, often in other firms' funds. Thinner service fee.

Asset and fee figures from FIL Holdings (UK) Limited audited accounts, year ended 31 Dec 2024 ^[S78] **Confirmed** . The basis-point margins are **this pack's own calculation** dividing fees by period-end assets **Inferred** . They are approximations: period-end assets are not average assets, and intra-group recharges affect where revenue lands.

FIGURE 9 · WHICH SIDE IS GROWING**UK customer assets, 2023 against 2024, from the audited accounts**

FIL Holdings (UK) Limited audited accounts, years ended 31 Dec 2023 and 2024 [S78, Confirmed]. The platform side is smaller and growing faster — and earns roughly 20 bps against roughly 35 bps.

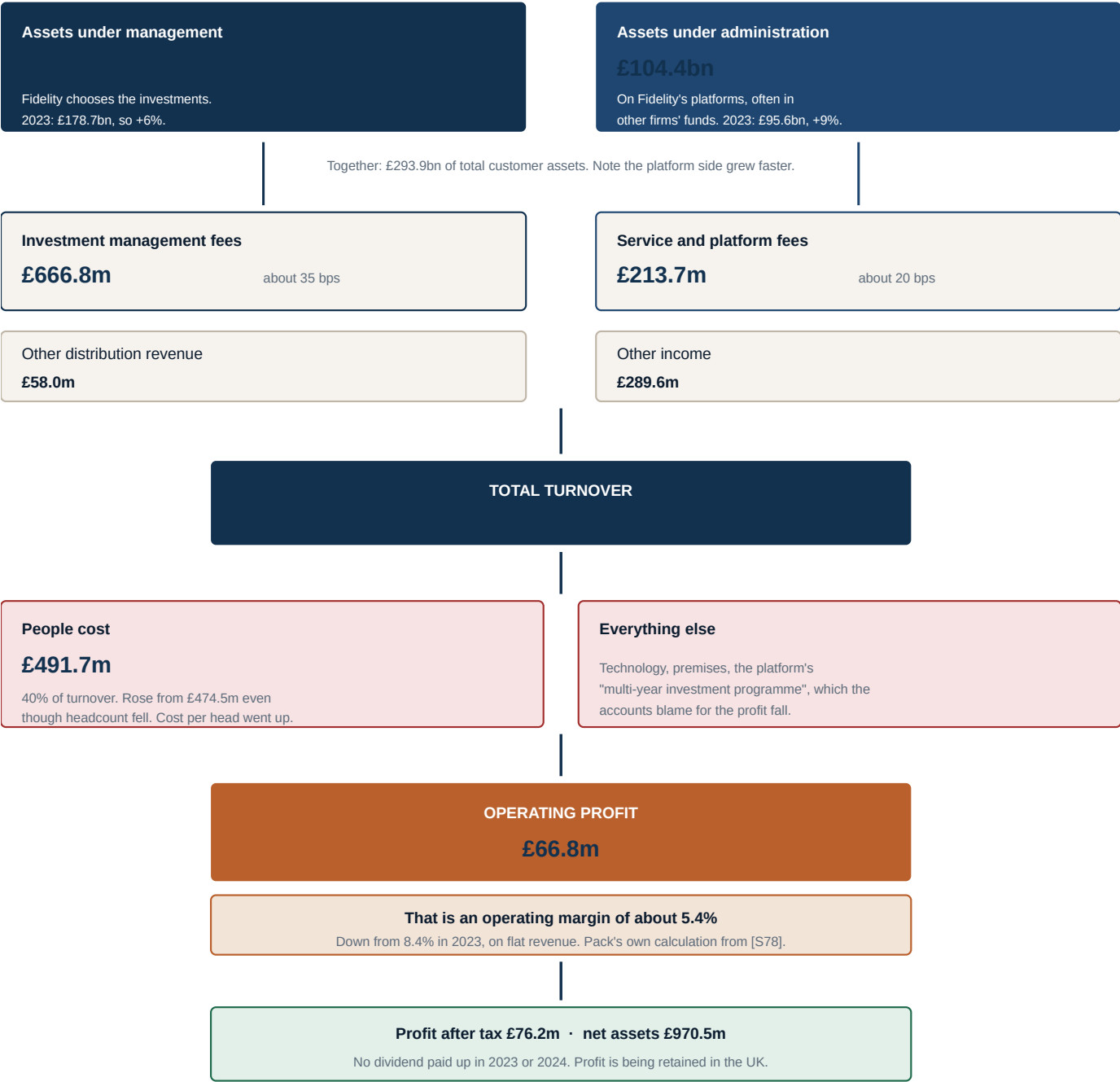
Figure 9. Growth by side of the business. **Confirmed** figures. Method diagram: no external source. Devised by the author of this pack; compiled 16 September 2026.

KEY TERM · BASIS POINT

One basis point is one hundredth of one per cent, written "bp" or "bps". A 35 bp fee on £1,000 is £3.50 a year. The whole industry is priced in basis points because the fee is charged on the value of the assets, so revenue rises and falls with markets without anyone issuing an invoice. This is why a market fall is an immediate revenue event for an asset manager, and why cost discipline matters so much.

FIGURE 10 · THE MONEY FLOW, UK GROUP, FY2024

Every figure below is from audited accounts filed at Companies House, year ended 31 December 2024 [S78]



The comparison that makes the point

FIL Investment Services (UK) Limited, the entity that actually manages the UK funds, filed separately: turnover £313.3m, operating profit £85.4m. That is a margin of roughly 27%. [S77, Confirmed]

The pure fund manager earns about 27%. The whole UK group earns about 5%.

The gap is what owning a platform and a workplace pensions business costs you in margin — and buys you in reach.

Handle this comparison carefully

The two entities have different scopes and intra-group recharges move costs between them, so this is not a clean like-for-like. Present it as a direction of travel, not a precise contrast. [Inferred from Confirmed figures]

All figures: FIL Holdings (UK) Limited and FIL Investment Services (UK) Limited statutory accounts, year ended 31 December 2024, filed 21 June 2025 [S77][S78].
Margins and basis-point conversions are this pack's calculations from those audited figures, and are approximations.

Figure 10. The money flow through the UK group. Audited inputs **Confirmed** ; ratios **Inferred** .

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

Is the platform worth it? The case for: it grew faster than the managed book, it owns the end-client relationship, and it survives even when a fund underperforms. The case against: it drags group margin from roughly 27% to roughly 5%, it eats capital in a "multi-year investment programme", and it puts Fidelity in a technology arms race against businesses that do nothing else. Pick a side before the interview. Either is defensible; having no view is not.

2.3 The business lines

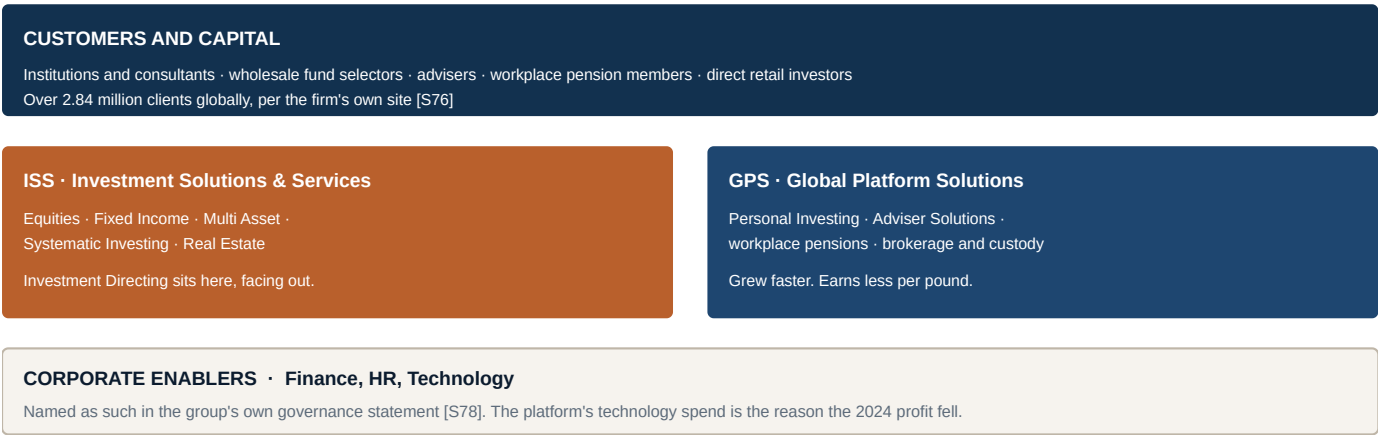
The UK accounts name two^[S78] Confirmed :

- **Investment Solutions & Services (ISS)** — the manufacturing business that "offers Fidelity's investment expertise to wholesale, institutional and other professional investing clients" across equities, fixed income, real estate and multi asset, plus segregated mandates. **This is where Investment Directing lives.** The five groups your job description names sit inside ISS.
- **Global Platform Solutions (GPS)** — Fidelity Adviser Solutions and Fidelity Personal Investing, the UK direct-to-consumer platform, plus workplace pension administration.

Supported by "Corporate Enablers": Finance, HR and Technology^[S78].

FIGURE 11 · THE OPERATING MODEL IN LAYERS

Three layers, and what passes between them



Structure and labels quoted from FIL Holdings (UK) Limited 2024 statutory accounts [S78, Confirmed].
Placement of Investment Directing within ISS follows the job description's list of groups [S21] and the Distribution reporting line in [S41].

Figure 11. The operating model as the firm itself describes it. Confirmed labels.

2.4 The contracts the business is made of

Every business is a set of implicit bargains. Here are Fidelity International's, reconstructed from filings and postings.

Stakeholder	Gives	Gets
Fund investors and platform customers	Their savings, and a fee in basis points, charged whether or not the fund beats its benchmark.	Access to a global research operation, a fund range, and a platform that holds it all. Plus a published annual Assessment of Value in which the manager marks its own homework ^[S78] .
Portfolio managers and analysts	Investment judgement, and their time for client work when it matters.	A research platform they could not build alone, and a layer of Investment Directors who absorb most of the client load so they can keep managing money.
Distribution and Investment Directing	The commercial relationship, and accountability for what is said to clients.	Products to sell and technical backing credible enough to survive due diligence.

Stakeholder	Gives	Gets
Employees and management as owners	Careers, and capital locked into a private company with no listed market for the shares.	A share of a business that does not have to explain itself to public shareholders every quarter.
The founding family	Patient capital, reported at just under 40% of voting stock ^[S79] .	Control, and a business that can "think generationally" ^[S76] .
The regulator	Permission to manage other people's money.	Compliance with COBS, Consumer Duty, CASS and the rest — and the firm's own CASS Oversight Forum at board level to prove it takes client assets seriously ^[S78] .

Reconstructed by the author from the cited primary sources Inferred as a framework; the underlying facts are sourced individually.

2.5 The risk and control architecture

The UK business runs through several separately FCA-authorised entities rather than one licence, including FIL Investment Services (UK) Limited, FIL Investments International, Financial Administration Services Limited and FIL Pensions Management^[S90] Reported. The group's own accounts set out a four-part risk taxonomy, and name **non-financial operational risk as "the largest risk to which the Group is exposed"**^[S78] Confirmed — not market risk, which is the answer most candidates would guess.

Governance: the UK board is chaired by a non-executive, Peter Horrell, separately from the chief executive, Cara Hewitt, appointed 19 July 2024^[S78]. It applies the Wates Principles for large private companies and runs three committees, one of which is a dedicated **CASS Oversight Forum** — CASS being the FCA's client assets rules^[S78] Confirmed. A board-level forum devoted solely to client money is a strong, specific detail to have.

2.6 Recent moves, and the skeletons told straight

FIGURE 12 · THE LAST THREE YEARS, DATE-STAMPED

What has actually happened, in order



Orange: cost. Navy: leadership and structure. Green: growth. Dates as cited; treat Reported items as single-source.

Figure 12. Recent moves. Mixed Confirmed and Reported as marked. Method diagram: no external source. Devised by the author of this pack; compiled 16 September 2026.

The strategic tension worth noticing

The 2024 accounts say ISS decided to "cease manufacturing of non-core private asset classes in order to pivot resources to areas of unique strength... active ETFs and the distribution of third-party capabilities for both private assets and select public market investments"^[S78] Confirmed. In August 2025 it launched an LTAF to put private assets into workplace pensions^[S89]. Those look contradictory until you see the distinction: **stop building niche private-asset products in house, keep building access to private assets for the pensions business, largely using other people's** Inferred. That is a sophisticated observation and a very good thing to raise.

The skeletons

- **A disclosed remediation.** At 31 December 2024 the group carried a **£2.503m provision** for "potential liabilities arising from processing errors identified in its defined contribution pension business", with £613,000 paid to affected clients during 2024^[S78] **Confirmed**. A real, disclosed operational-risk event. If you are asked for an example of operational risk at Fidelity, use this one.
- **Job cuts.** Roughly 1,000 roles globally in March 2024^[S84], and a UK headcount fall of about 13%^[S78]. Do not pretend this did not happen.
- **Senior investment churn.** Within roughly eighteen months: a UK chief executive change, a co-CIO stepping down, and a fixed income CIO transition^{[S78][S73][S90]}. That is a lot of turnover at the top of the investment organisation, and it is fair to note.
- **A pricing experiment that was withdrawn.** See below.

SOURCE UNCERTAIN — ENFORCEMENT HISTORY

No FCA fine or public censure against a Fidelity International UK entity was found in this research^[S78]. **That is not the same as confirming there has never been one.** The FCA register was not queried entity-by-entity. Never tell an interviewer "Fidelity has never been fined." Say "I didn't find any enforcement action in my research, though I wouldn't claim that's exhaustive." One of those sentences can be wrong. The other cannot.

2.7 The fulcrum fee: the best story in the firm's recent history

This is the single most useful episode to know, because it shows the firm doing something genuinely unusual, and then honestly abandoning it.

In July 2018 Fidelity International launched a variable management fee share class on five UK funds, explicitly in response to the FCA's 2016 Asset Management Market Study, which had criticised the lack of fee innovation and clustering around a flat 0.75%^[S72] **Confirmed**. The base charge was cut to **0.65%**, then moved symmetrically up or down by up to 0.20 percentage points on rolling three-year performance against benchmark: a **maximum of 0.85%** if the fund beat the benchmark, a **minimum of 0.45%** if it lagged^[S72].

On 25 May 2021 Fidelity scrapped it on the open-ended funds, citing limited client demand. A spokesperson said: "We've seen limited client demand in our open-ended funds, and as a result we decided the UK-domiciled VMF share classes were too small to manage cost-effectively... Adoption of our model was always a client choice and we are pleased to see that it opened the doors to wider discussions on pricing structures"^[S72] **Confirmed**. It survived on three investment trusts holding about £2.9bn, because a trust has one share class and an independent board to negotiate with^[S72].

AJ Bell's Ryan Hughes named the flaw: "The challenge with fulcrum fees is always that they need explaining... There is also a natural difficulty in explaining to customers that if the fund does well, they will pay higher fees"^[S72] **Confirmed**.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

"The fulcrum fee is the thing I found most interesting. In 2018 Fidelity cut the base fee to 0.65% and let it flex between 0.45% and 0.85% on three-year performance, directly answering the FCA's market study. Then they pulled it in 2021 on the open-ended funds because clients didn't take it up, and it only survived on the investment trusts where there's one share class and a board to negotiate with. What strikes me is that the reason it failed is a communication problem — you have to explain to a customer that good performance means a higher fee. That is exactly the kind of problem this team would own."

Why it works: it is specific, correctly dated, it shows you understand a pricing mechanism, and the last sentence turns a firm fact into a reason you want *this* seat. Very few candidates will have this.

PART 3

Why the firm is built this way

Four mechanisms: why it is shaped like this, how the parts connect, what clients are actually buying, and how big the non-investing half is. This is the part of the pack that cannot be transplanted to a rival by changing the name.

3.1 The structural choice: it makes the funds *and* owns the shelf

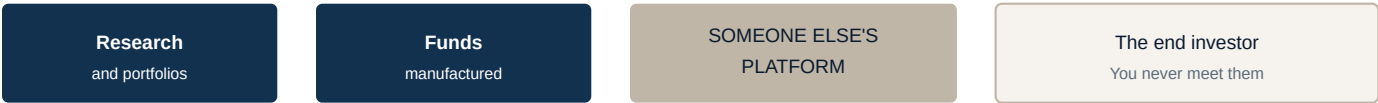
Most active asset managers manufacture funds and then pay someone else to distribute them. Fidelity International does both. In the UK it runs the fund range, a direct-to-consumer platform, an adviser platform and a workplace pensions business. That is the single most unusual thing about its shape.

The firm's own Distribution pages name the constituent teams: a Global Institutional Team, a Government Institutional Group, retail and wholesale funds, DC and Workplace Savings, Personal Investing and Adviser Solutions^[S303] Confirmed . The audited UK accounts put numbers against the two halves: £189.5bn managed, £104.4bn administered^[S78] Confirmed .

FIGURE 13 · TWO WAYS TO BUILD AN ASSET MANAGER

The ordinary model, and the Fidelity International model

A. The ordinary active manager



You pay a third party for shelf space, you see the flows only after they happen, and the platform owns the customer.

B. Fidelity International in the UK



What it buys

You see demand directly, not through a reseller.
Flows are stickier: platform money stays even when a fund lags. And no quarterly shareholder is asking why you are investing in it.

What it costs

Group operating margin around 5%, against about 27% for the fund manager alone. A permanent technology bill. And a conflict you must manage: you sell your own funds on your own shelf.

Asset figures from audited UK accounts, 31 Dec 2024 [S78]. Margin comparison is this pack's calculation [S77][S78]. Model contrast is the author's framing.

Figure 13. The design choice. Figures Confirmed ; the two-model contrast Inferred .

The conflict, named

If you sell your own funds on your own platform, you have a conflict of interest, and pretending otherwise is the wrong answer. The governing framework is the FCA's SYSC 10, which requires firms to identify and manage conflicts through information barriers and a conflicts policy, and treats disclosure as a last resort rather than a fix^[S304] Confirmed .

The concrete mitigant worth knowing: Fidelity's UK platform offers whole-of-market fund choice, with thousands of funds from other managers, rather than a closed shelf of its own products^[S305] Reported . That is the difference between a distribution business and a shop window.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

"The structure I find most interesting is that it manufactures and distributes. In the UK it runs the funds, a direct platform, an adviser platform and workplace pensions. That's rare for an active manager, and it cuts both ways. It means you see client demand first-hand instead of through a third-party platform. It also means you're carrying a conflict — selling your own funds on your own shelf — which is a SYSC 10 problem you have to manage with real information barriers, not disclose your way out of. The fact that the platform is whole-of-market rather than a closed shelf tells you something about how they've chosen to handle it."

Why it works: almost no candidate raises the conflict unprompted. Naming it, naming the rule, and naming the mitigant in three sentences reads as someone who has actually thought about the business.

3.2 Why the research platform has to be shared

Fidelity International's pitch rests on proprietary research: its own analysts meeting companies, rather than buying someone else's view. That is expensive, and the economics only work if the cost is spread across every asset class and every product built on top of it

Inferred.

SOURCE UNCERTAIN — THE SIZE OF THE RESEARCH PLATFORM

Two different Fidelity pages give different headline numbers: roughly **360 versus 400-plus** investment professionals, and roughly **16,000 versus 17,000** company meetings a year^[S306]. The discrepancy is probably different dates or different definitions of who counts. **Do not quote a precise figure.** Say "several hundred investment professionals and something like sixteen to seventeen thousand company meetings a year, depending which of their own pages you read" — which is accurate, and quietly shows you read more than one.

FIGURE 14 · WHY ONE RESEARCH PLATFORM SERVES FIVE ASSET CLASSES

The fixed cost that only makes sense if everyone uses it

**Why this matters to Investment Directing**

The research is the product. Your job is to make it visible. A client cannot inspect an analyst's judgement, so the only evidence they ever see that the platform exists is the quality of what this team writes and says.

Platform figures [S306], with the discrepancy noted above. The "shared fixed cost" argument is the author's reasoning, not a Fidelity statement. [Inferred]

Figure 14. The economics of owning research. **Inferred** argument built on **Reported** figures. Underlying sources as marked; all accessed 16 September 2026.

FIGURE 15 · WHY A CONNECTIVE FUNCTION EXISTS AT ALL

The tangle without it, and the hub with it

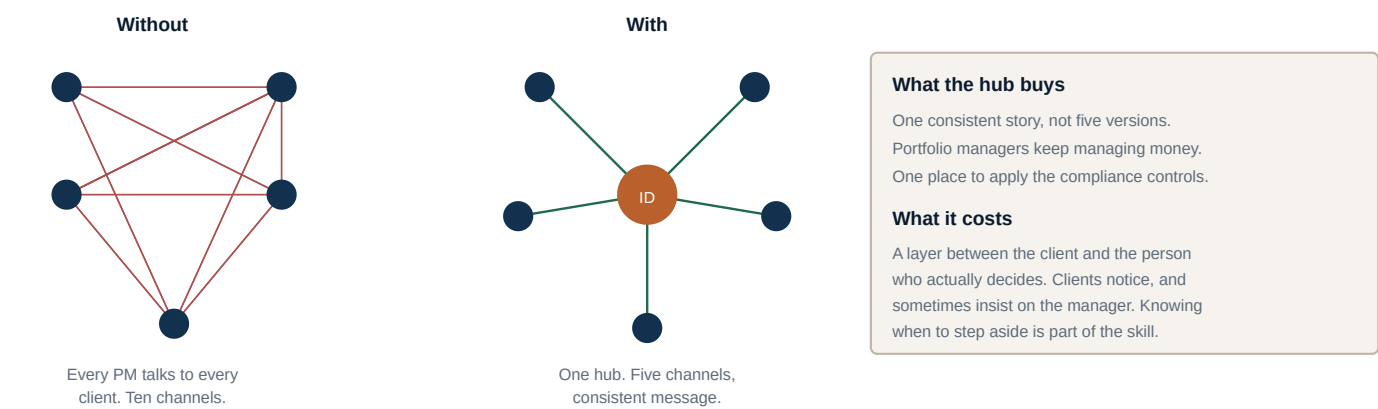


Figure 15. The hub argument, and its cost. Inferred . Method diagram: no external source. Devised by the author of this pack; compiled 16 September 2026.

3.3 What clients are actually buying, and the case against

Be careful here. The weak answer is "strong long-term performance". The evidence does not support that as a general claim about active management, and an interviewer at an active house knows the numbers better than you do.

The honest case for paying an active fee	The case against, with numbers
Access to proprietary research and to markets a retail investor cannot reach directly, particularly in Asia, where this firm has been present since 1969 ^[S70] .	SPIVA data shows 94.1% of US active funds underperformed over the twenty years to 2024 ^[S307] Reported . That is the headline number an interviewer may throw at you.
One provider across a saver's whole life: workplace pension, ISA, drawdown. Switching costs are real and service has value.	Morningstar's Active/Passive Barometer reported a 38% one-year success rate for 2025, and only 21% over ten years ^[S308] Reported .
Breadth: equities, fixed income, real estate and multi asset under one relationship, which matters to an institution that wants fewer managers to monitor.	Fees compound against you. Passive funds at roughly 10 bps against active at under 60 bps on average means active must beat the index by the fee difference every year merely to draw level ^[S166] .
Durability. A private, family-and-management-owned firm is not going to be sold out from under a client mid-mandate — a live risk elsewhere, as Part 4 shows.	UK platform data for Q2 2026: passive took 70.4% of net inflows, active 29.6% ^[S231] . Clients are voting.

Active underperformance statistics are Reported via trade press summaries of SPIVA and Morningstar rather than read from the primary reports. Check the current edition before quoting exact figures.

FIGURE 16 · WHAT THE EVIDENCE SAYS, BOTH DIRECTIONS

Share of active funds beating their passive comparator, on the measures most often quoted

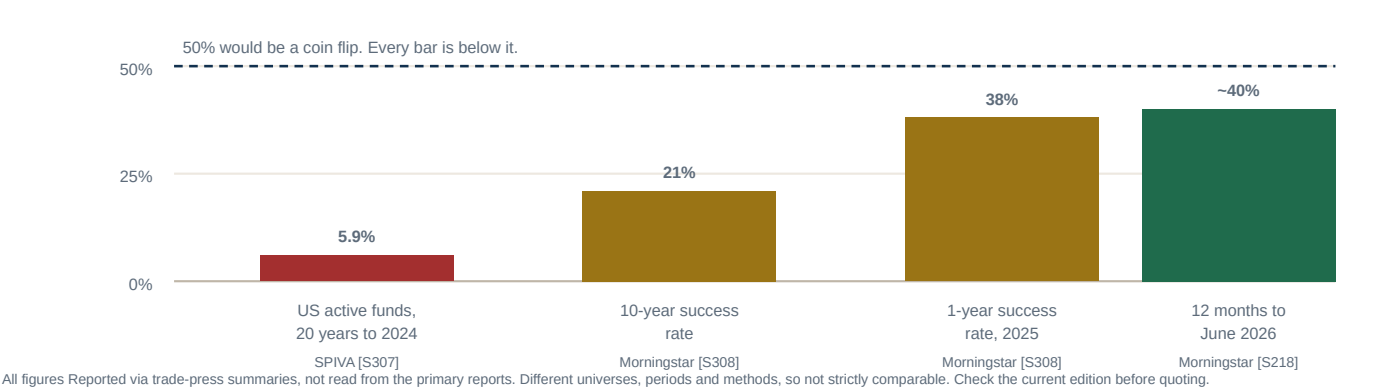


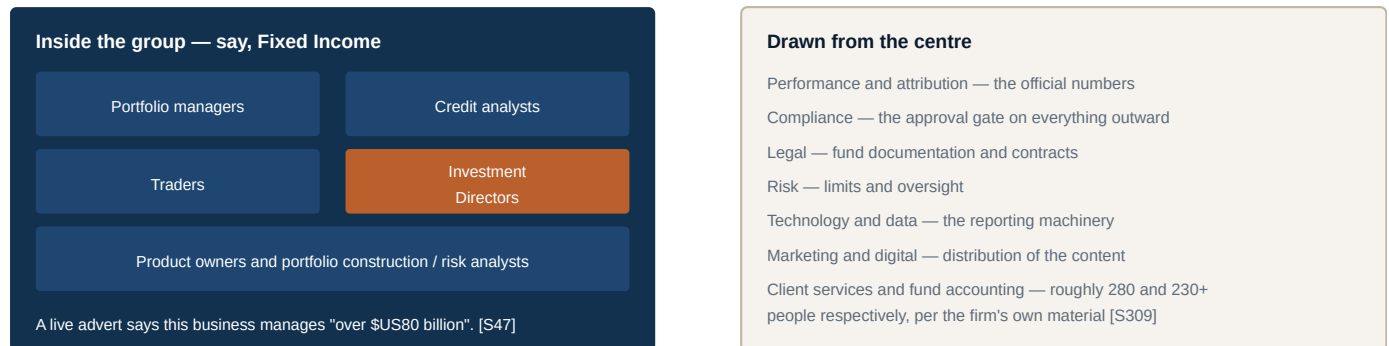
Figure 16. The active performance evidence. Reported ; see Part 16.3 on why these need care.

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE — AND YOU WILL BE ASKED

"If most active managers underperform, why should anyone pay for active management?" is a near-certain question at an active house. The losing answers are denial ("our funds beat the index") and capitulation ("honestly, they probably shouldn't"). A defensible position: the index-beating claim is the wrong claim. Active earns its fee where markets are less efficiently priced and information is harder to get — smaller Asian companies, credit, property — and where a client needs a specific outcome rather than a benchmark return, such as income in retirement. In a large, liquid, heavily covered market, the passive case is strong and an honest firm should say so. *Write your own version. Do not use these words.*

FIGURE 17 · ANATOMY OF ONE ASSET-CLASS GROUP

What sits inside a front-line group, and what it draws from the rest of the firm



Composition inferred from the vacancy set found in this research [S43][S44][S47][S48] and the central functions named in [S78] and [S309]. Author's construction.

Figure 17. A front-line unit and its dependencies. **Inferred** composition. Underlying sources as marked; all accessed 16 September 2026.

3.4 The non-investing side, which is most of the firm

Candidates imagine an asset manager as a floor of fund managers. It is not. The firm describes itself in four parts: Investment Management, Distribution, Customer Operations and Central Functions^[S309] **Reported**. The audited UK accounts name the same shape differently — ISS, GPS and Corporate Enablers^[S78].

Scale indicators from the firm's own material: around 280 people in Client Services, more than 230 in Fund Accounting, and more than 800 institutional clients supported^[S309] **Reported**. Against a UK average headcount of 2,941^[S78], the operational machine is plainly a large share of the firm, not a back office.

FIGURE 18 · HOW A FRONT-LINE SEAT IS WIRED INTO THE CENTRE

Three kinds of connection, and which one Investment Directing is



The consequence for you: a connective role has two masters and no home team.

That is why "who do you actually report to?" is such a good question to ask, and why the answer in Part 1.7 is genuinely ambiguous in public sources.

Categories are the author's framework. Placement of Investment Directing follows the Distribution reporting line [S41] and the conflicting posting evidence [S48].

Figure 18. Connection types. **Inferred** framework on **Reported** evidence. Underlying sources as marked; all accessed 16 September 2026.

PART 4

How it stands out

Ten firms compared, the design choices that separate them, the handful of things only this firm can claim, and an honest list of where it does not lead. Overclaiming is the fastest way to lose credibility with someone who works in the industry.

4.1 The peer table

Dates and scopes differ between firms and some figures are from tertiary sources. Read the as of column before quoting anything. "AUMA" means assets under management and administration, a wider measure than AUM.

Firm	Ownership	Size	As of	Staff	Position, and what it means for this seat
Fidelity International	Private. Founding family reported ~39.89% of voting stock; rest management and employees ^[S79]	Contested: ~US\$469bn AUM plus ~US\$203bn AUA ^[S140] , or US\$1,086bn total client assets ^[S120]	30 Jun 2025 / 31 Dec 2025	7,600+ but that figure is from 2018 and stale ^[S120]	Active, global, unusually Asian, owns UK distribution. Calls the seat Investment Director .
Schroders	Listed; Schroder family ~44%. Agreed acquisition by Nuveen for ~£9.9bn, Feb 2026 ^[S129]	£778.7bn	31 Dec 2024 ^[S141]	—	The closest UK comparator, and about to change owner. Uses Client Portfolio Manager .
M&G	Listed	£375.9bn AUMA ^[S130]	31 Dec 2025	8,282 ^[S130]	UK retail and institutional, with a large insurance heritage. Uses Investment Specialist .
Aberdeen Group	Listed. Rebranded from "abrdn" back to Aberdeen in March 2025 ^[S131]	£390.4bn investments; ~£556bn group AUMA	2025, scope unclear ^[S131]	~4,000 ^[S131]	Has spent years restructuring. A cautionary tale about listed-company pressure.
Janus Henderson	Listed. Agreed ~\$7.4bn acquisition by Triand General Catalyst, expected to close mid-2026 ^[S132]	\$493.2bn ^[S126]	31 Dec 2025	2,000+ ^[S126]	FY2025 revenue \$3,097m, operating income \$976.8m, a 31.5% margin, and \$56.5bn of net inflows ^[S126] . Uses Client Portfolio Manager .
Baillie Gifford	Private partnership	—	—	~1,640	The other big private active house. Splits the seat in two: Client Manager plus Investment Specialist ^[S6] .
Invesco	Listed	\$2,169.9bn ^[S124]	31 Dec 2025	7,499 ^[S133]	Reported a 2025 operating loss of \$695m ^[S133] . Scale does not guarantee profit.
Amundi	Listed; Crédit Agricole 68.35% ^[S134]	€2.38trn ^[S134]	31 Dec 2025	—	Europe's largest. Bank-owned, so distribution comes through the parent's branches.
BlackRock	Listed	\$14–15.3trn, sources differ ^{[S135][S138]}	2025–2026	~24,900 ^[S135]	The passive giant via iShares. A different business, not really a competitor for the same mandate. Uses Product Strategist .

Firm	Ownership	Size	As of	Staff	Position, and what it means for this seat
JPMorgan AM	Part of a listed bank	\$4.3–4.6trn ^[S128]	2025	—	Bank-backed scale. Uses Investment Specialist in an integrated team model ^[S64] .
Fidelity Investments <i>the other firm</i>	Private, Johnson family	\$7.1trn managed ^[S137]	FY2025	~80,000 ^[S137]	Not your employer. Boston, separate since 1980. Revenue \$37.7bn in 2025 ^[S137] . Listed here only so you never confuse the two.

Compiled from company results, press reporting and tertiary sources as marked ^{[S120]–[S149]}. Mixed confidence; most non-company-sourced rows are **Reported**. Dashes mean the figure was not established in this research.

FIGURE 19 · SCALE, ROUGHLY

Approximate assets, converted to US dollars for scale only

Do not quote these converted numbers. Rates are approximate and the as-of dates differ by up to a year. The point is the ordering, not the values.



Figure 19. Relative scale. **Inferred** conversions of **Reported** figures. Method diagram: no external source. Devised by the author of this pack; compiled 16 September 2026.

4.2 The design axes

FIGURE 20 · WHERE EACH FIRM SITS

Six choices that separate asset managers, and where Fidelity International sits on each



Fidelity International sits at one end of five of these six axes. That is what makes a "why here" answer possible at all.

Figure 20. Positioning. Placements are the author's judgement from the sourced facts **Inferred**. Method diagram: no external source. Devised by the author of this pack; compiled 16 September 2026.

4.3 Six things only this firm can claim

- 1. It cannot be bought out from under its clients right now, and two named peers can.** Schrodgers has an agreed acquisition by Nuveen for about £9.9bn from February 2026^[S129], and Janus Henderson an agreed roughly \$7.4bn deal with Triand General Catalyst expected to close in mid-2026^[S132] **Reported**. *Why it matters:* the single hardest question in an institutional due diligence meeting is "will you still be here, unchanged, in five years?" Private ownership is a real answer to that, and right now it is a differentiated one.
- 2. It manufactures funds and owns the UK shelf they sit on.** £189.5bn managed and £104.4bn administered in the UK alone^[S78] **Confirmed**. *Why it matters:* the Investment Directing team's content reaches advisers and end investors through channels the firm controls.
- 3. It was built out of Asia before it was built out of London.** Tokyo 1969, London 1973, Hong Kong 1981^[S70]. *Why it matters:* it can staff a China or Japan strategy with its own analysts. Most UK-headquartered peers of similar size cannot.
- 4. It ran a real fee experiment and reported honestly when it failed.** The 0.65% base fee flexing between 0.45% and 0.85%, launched July 2018 against the FCA's market study, withdrawn from open-ended funds in May 2021^[S72] **Confirmed**. *Why it matters:* you can discuss a pricing mechanism and its communication problem, which is exactly this team's problem.
- 5. There is no quarterly earnings call.** It files no public group accounts; the numbers in this pack came out of UK subsidiary filings at Companies House^[S78]. *Why it matters:* saying this proves you did primary research, and it is the honest answer to "what couldn't you find out?"
- 6. It shares a brand with a much larger company it has not been part of since 1980.**^{[S70][S402]} *Why it matters:* it is a live brand-confusion problem for the firm, and demonstrating you are not confused is a quiet, powerful signal.

4.4 Where it does not lead — read this before you overclaim

DON'T SAY THIS

"Fidelity is the leading asset manager." It is not, on any measure, and the person opposite you knows it.

- **Not the biggest.** Far smaller than BlackRock, Amundi, Invesco, JPMorgan AM, and smaller than its own Boston namesake at about \$7.1trn^[S137].
- **No passive scale.** Nothing resembling iShares. It competes on active and active ETFs^[S85].
- **It has shed staff.** About 1,000 roles globally in March 2024, roughly 9%^[S142], and UK average headcount down from 3,370 to 2,941^[S78].
- **It has had outflows.** Reported net outflows of €9.2bn across funds and ETFs in the year to end-October 2023^[S144] **Reported**.
- **UK group profit fell about 35% in 2024** on flat revenue^[S78].
- **At least one named vehicle has struggled.** Fidelity Asian Values saw value-style underperformance trigger a downward fee adjustment under the fulcrum mechanism^[S72].

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

"I wouldn't pretend it's the biggest or the best-performing — it isn't, and 2024 was clearly a hard year, with the job cuts and UK operating profit down around a third on flat revenue. What I think it does have is a structural position very few others have: private ownership, its own distribution in the UK, and genuine Asian research depth going back to 1969. Given two of its closest listed peers are currently being acquired, being un-buyable is worth more to an institutional client today than it was five years ago."

Why it works: conceding the weak points first buys you the right to make the strong claim. A candidate who only praises sounds like they read the website. A candidate who concedes accurately sounds like they read the accounts.

PART 5

The industry from zero

What the product is, who buys it, how the money is made, and the forces reshaping it in 2026. Written so that someone who has never worked in asset management can follow it, with nothing left undefined.

5.1 What is actually being sold

An asset manager takes money from people who have it and invests it on their behalf, for a fee. That is the whole industry. Everything else is variation on the wrapper, the customer and the fee.

Wrapper	What it is, in plain English
Pooled fund	Many investors' money in one pot, managed together. You own units or shares in the pot, not the underlying holdings.
OEIC / unit trust	The two standard UK pooled fund structures. An open-ended investment company issues shares; a unit trust issues units. Practically similar for the investor. "Open-ended" means the fund grows and shrinks as people buy and sell.
SICAV / UCITS	The European equivalents. UCITS is an EU regulatory standard for retail funds that has become a global export label because it is trusted.
Investment trust	A closed-ended company listed on the stock exchange whose business is holding investments. Fixed share count, so the price can differ from the value of the assets. Fidelity runs several, including Japan, China Special Situations and Asian Values ^[S72] .
ETF	Exchange-traded fund. A fund you buy and sell on an exchange like a share, historically index-tracking and cheap. Increasingly also actively managed, which is where Fidelity has been building ^[S85] .
Segregated mandate	A single large client's own portfolio, managed to its own rules. Typical for pension schemes. No pooling.
Model portfolio	A recipe of funds an adviser applies across many clients at once.
LTAF	Long-Term Asset Fund. A UK structure designed to let pension savers hold illiquid private-market assets. Fidelity was authorised for its first in August 2025 ^[S89] .

5.2 Who the customers are, and how differently they buy

Customer	How they buy	What they need from an Investment Director
Retail savers	Direct, through a platform, often into an ISA or SIPP. Small amounts, many of them.	Clarity. Consumer Duty applies at full strength. Plain language is a regulatory obligation, not a style preference.
Financial advisers	On behalf of their clients, usually through an adviser platform.	Material they can pass on, and defensible answers, because they carry their own suitability duty.
Wealth managers and fund selectors	Run buy lists. Concentrated decisions, large tickets.	Depth, and direct access to the manager at the right moments.
DC pension schemes	Default funds for millions of employees who never choose anything. Now the growth engine of UK savings.	Scale, governance, cost, and increasingly private-market access.
DB pension schemes	Closed, maturing, de-risking. Advised by consultants.	Consultant ratings matter more than the pitch itself.
Insurers, sovereign wealth funds, endowments	Very large segregated mandates, long horizons, heavy due diligence.	RFPs and DDQs, months of process, and total consistency of message.

THE STRUCTURAL FACT WORTH MEMORISING

UK industry assets hit a record **£11.1 trillion in 2025**, up 11% on £10.0 trillion in 2024^[S150] **Confirmed**. More importantly for this firm: **retail investors now account for roughly 30% of UK-managed assets and have overtaken pension funds at roughly 25% as the largest client group** — a reversal of what was, until 2020, roughly an 80/20 institutional-to-retail split^{[S150][S152]} **Confirmed**.

Why this is the single best industry fact for a Fidelity interview: the client group that is growing fastest is precisely the one Fidelity International reaches directly through its own platform. Connect those two facts out loud and you have made an argument almost nobody else in the room will make.

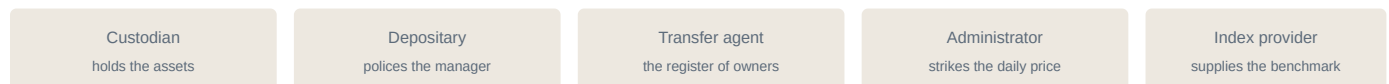
5.3 The value chain, and where the fee goes

FIGURE 21 · FROM A SAVER'S PAY PACKET TO A SHARE

Everyone in this chain takes a slice. The manager's slice is the management fee.



Behind the scenes, none of whom the saver ever meets



Why fee compression is existential rather than annoying

Active funds now average under 60 bps and passive around 10 bps [S217]. Every one of the boxes above still has to be paid. When the manager's slice halves, the fixed costs of research, technology and compliance do not.

Fee levels [S217, Reported]. The ~35 bps and ~20 bps markers are this pack's calculations from Fidelity's UK audited accounts [S78] and are firm-specific, not industry averages. Chain structure is standard industry practice [S150-S219]. Diagram is the author's construction.

Figure 21. The value chain. Structure **Confirmed**; fee markers as noted. Underlying sources as marked; all accessed 16 September 2026.

KEY TERMS · THE FEE VOCABULARY

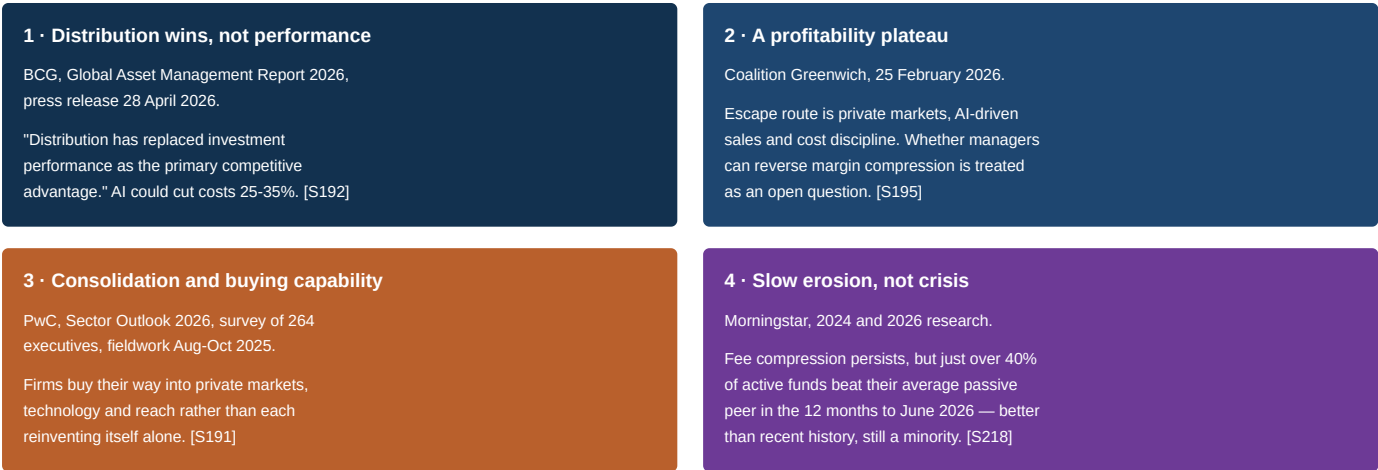
AMC is the annual management charge, the manager's own fee. **OCF** or **TER** is the total cost of running the fund, including the AMC plus administration and audit, and is the number an investor should actually compare. A **performance fee** is an extra slice if the fund beats a hurdle. **Carried interest** is the private-equity version, typically a share of profits above a threshold. The key behavioural point: a fee charged on assets rewards *gathering* assets; a fee charged on performance rewards *taking risk*. Firms choose which incentive they want, and regulators watch both.

5.4 What is actually happening to the industry, and four ways it might go

The diagnosis is not disputed. Passive is taking share, fees are compressing, and costs are rising. Passive strategies make up roughly 30% of assets but only about 7% of revenue in one sample, while alternatives are about 18% of assets and about 57% of revenue^[S195] **Reported**. What happens next is disputed, and knowing that there is a genuine disagreement is more impressive than picking a side.

FIGURE 22 · FOUR CREDIBLE VIEWS OF THE NEXT FIVE YEARS

Same diagnosis, four different prescriptions. Each is attributable and dated.



All four [Reported]. Two of the four (BCG, PwC) were read via search summaries rather than the primary reports, which were access-blocked. Attribute carefully.

Figure 22. Competing industry views, each attributable and dated. **Reported**.

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

Which view do you find most convincing, and why? The strongest interview move is to notice that view 1 and view 4 are in direct tension: if distribution has genuinely replaced performance as the competitive edge, then a firm that owns its own distribution is structurally advantaged regardless of whether its funds beat the index — which is a remarkably convenient argument for Fidelity International specifically. Say that, then say why you are or are not persuaded by it. Noticing that the argument flatters your prospective employer, and saying so, is a sign of a serious mind.

5.5 The UK policy backdrop you should know

The **Mansion House Accord**, signed 13 May 2025, committed 17 workplace pension providers, covering around 90% of active DC savers, to invest 10% of their default funds in private markets by 2030, with 5% ringfenced for UK assets^[S186] **Confirmed**. That moves an asset pool of about £252bn today toward a projected £740bn by 2030^[S186].

This is the direct commercial reason Fidelity International sought FCA authorisation for an LTAF in August 2025 and folded private assets into its £16.9bn FutureWise workplace default^[S89]. Policy created demand; the firm built the vehicle. Being able to draw that line is exactly the "commercial awareness" the assessment tests^[S262].

PART 6

The role's own industry

Where the investment-specialist function came from, the regulation that shaped it, the systems it runs on, and what its internal clients actually value in 2026. If you learn one technical area properly, make it this one.

6.1 Why this job exists at all

The function grew because two things happened at once. Institutional clients and their consultants began demanding far more access and far more evidence, and portfolio managers' time became the scarcest resource in the firm. Someone had to absorb the load without diluting the technical answer. Hence a dedicated seat, at every major firm^{[S1]–[S6]} **Inferred**.

A second force made it a profession rather than a support role: regulation. Once client communications became legally constrained artefacts with rules about prominence, time periods, warnings and target markets, producing them stopped being a marketing task.

6.2 The regulation, in order

FIGURE 23 · THE RULES THAT SHAPED THIS JOB

Dates matter. Getting one wrong is worse than not raising it.



Red is live work. The CCI transition means client documents are being rewritten across the industry right now. That is the one to raise.

Figure 23. Regulatory timeline. Dates verified against FCA primary sources where marked **Confirmed** in Part 1.5.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW — THE SINGLE BEST TECHNICAL ANSWER AVAILABLE TO YOU

"The thing I'd most want to understand on day one is the Consumer Composite Investments transition. It commenced on 6 April 2026 and has to be fully implemented by 8 June 2027, so it lands right across the internship. It replaces the PRIIPs key information document, which means a lot of client-facing documentation has to be rebuilt. For a team that produces factsheets and reporting material, that's not a background regulatory story, it's the work."

Why it works: it is current, correctly dated, specific to this team, and it shows you thought about what the job will actually look like in summer 2027 rather than what it looked like in the brochure. **Re-verify these dates before you use them** — regimes slip, and this pack was compiled on 16 September 2026.

6.3 The tooling

Worth knowing by name, because mentioning one or two shows you understand this is an industrial process and not freehand writing^{[S196]–[S210]} **Reported** :

- **Data and analytics:** Morningstar, FactSet, Bloomberg, MSCI, Aladdin.
- **Institutional databases:** eVestment, where consultants screen managers. If your data there is wrong or stale, you are not in the search.
- **Reporting automation:** Vermilion, Assette and similar, which generate thousands of factsheets from approved components rather than by hand.
- **RFP tooling:** Loopio, Responsive and similar, maintaining a library of approved answers.

The insight underneath the tool names: nearly all of this output is *assembled from an approved component library*, not written from scratch, precisely because every component has already been through compliance. Understanding that is understanding the job.

6.4 What internal clients actually value now

Internal client	What they want from you	What annoys them
Portfolio manager	To be represented accurately, and not to be asked the same question twice.	Being sent a draft that misstates their view, or a request with no deadline attached.
Distribution / sales	Material that arrives before the meeting, and an answer they can use in the room.	"Compliance is still reviewing it" on the morning of the pitch.
Compliance	Drafts that already respect the rules, with sources attached.	Being treated as an obstacle, and last-minute submissions.
Product	Structured signal about what clients keep asking for.	Anecdote presented as a trend.
Performance team	Requests that specify the exact period, share class and currency.	"Can you send me the performance?" with none of those specified.

Author's construction from the counterparty map in Part 1 **Inferred** . Useful as a framework, not as a claim about Fidelity specifically.

PART 7

What is happening right now

Compiled 16 September 2026. This is the part of the pack that goes stale fastest. Re-read the sources in Part 7.4 the week before any interview and update it yourself. Everything here carries a date for exactly that reason.

READ THIS BEFORE USING ANYTHING IN PART 7

Market levels and live corporate stories decay in days. Several items below were reported by outlets whose full text was paywalled, so they are single-source. Each is tagged. **Never quote a market level you have not checked that morning.** The framing in this section will stay useful for months; the numbers will not.

7.1 Fidelity International: the four stories that matter

1 · The China tension — the most interesting thing you can raise

On 21 August 2026 it was reported that Fidelity International is weighing withdrawal from its wholly owned China mutual fund business, three years after launching its Shanghai subsidiary, citing domestic competition, management changes and difficulty reaching scale^[S223] **Reported**. Reported detail: assets peaked around 6bn yuan and fell about 25% to roughly 4.5bn yuan by end-June 2026; about \$218m invested; internal analysis reportedly concluded the unit needed at least \$14bn of assets to break even. No formal application has been filed, and the firm's public line was that "China remains an important market" with "no change to report"^[S223].

Why it is the best question in this pack: at the same time, Fidelity's own investment people have been publicly constructive on Chinese equities^[S237]. So the firm may be retreating from *manufacturing* funds in China while remaining bullish on *investing* in China. Those are not contradictory, but noticing the distinction is exactly the analytical move this job requires.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW — OR BETTER, ASK IT

"One thing I found genuinely interesting is the reporting from August that Fidelity might step back from onshore fund manufacturing in China, at the same time as the house view has been constructive on Chinese equities. I read that as a distinction between where you want to build a distribution business and where you want to invest clients' money, which aren't the same decision. Is that a fair reading, or am I missing something?"

Why it works: it is current, it shows you separated two things most people conflate, and ending on a genuine question invites them to teach you, which senior people enjoy. It also protects you — if the reporting is wrong or out of date, you have framed it as a question rather than a claim.

2 · The private assets push

FCA approval for the Fidelity Diversified Private Assets LTAF, spanning private equity, private credit, infrastructure, real estate and natural resources with a liquid sleeve^[S224] **Confirmed**, reportedly to be built into the workplace default's growth phase toward roughly 15% in private markets over about three years^{[S224][S225]} **Reported**. This is downstream of the Mansion House Accord (Part 5.5). For this team it is a communication problem: illiquid assets, notice periods and valuation uncertainty are hard to explain honestly and are precisely the "new products to meet investors' demands" the job description names.

3 · Active ETFs in Europe

Two new Research Enhanced investment-grade corporate bond ETFs, USD (FBIU) and EUR (FBIE), listed on Xetra, Borsa Italiana and the London Stock Exchange, reported late January 2026^[S226] **Reported**. Semi-active and rules-based rather than pure index tracking. This is how an active house competes in a market flowing to ETFs without pretending to be a passive giant.

4 · Sustainability labels, live and being reported against

Fidelity confirmed plans to adopt the FCA's "Sustainability Focus" label for three UK equity funds with combined assets cited above £865m^[S228] **Confirmed** . **Date caveat: the confirming articles are from 18 November 2024**, so this is background rather than news; what is current is that the labels are live and being reported against during 2026^[S229] **Reported** .

7.2 The industry backdrop

FIGURE 24 · THE FLOW WAR, UK PLATFORMS, Q2 2026

Where new money went, against where existing money sits

Net new money, Q2 2026: £4.6bn total



Existing assets on platform: £565.9bn



The gap between those two bars is the entire commercial problem of active management

Active still holds two thirds of the money and is winning under a third of the new money. In June 2026 alone, passive took £1.7bn of £1.8bn of net inflows, leaving active £45m.

This is not an abstract industry trend. It is the reason the Investment Directing function exists and is funded.

Fundscape data reported by Money Marketing, 24 July 2026 [S232, Confirmed, fetched]. Corroborating LSEG Lipper year-to-date figures [S233, Reported].

Figure 24. UK platform flows. **Confirmed** from a fetched source. Method diagram: no external source. Devised by the author of this pack; compiled 16 September 2026.

Story	Date	What happened	Why it matters to this seat
UK industry hits record assets	Reported 6 Aug 2026	UK investment management assets reached £11.1trn in 2025, up 11%. Retail funds saw their strongest month since August 2021 in June 2026 at £3.8bn, and nine consecutive months of inflows to July 2026 ^[S234] Confirmed .	The industry is growing even as the mix shifts to passive. Useful counterweight if an interviewer pushes a doom narrative.
Consolidation	Through 2026	Nuveen's approach for Schroders and a Triam/General Catalyst consortium interest in Janus Henderson ^[S230] . One widely cited forecast expects over 1,500 deals among managers with \$1bn+ of assets through 2029, potentially shrinking the number of global managers by about 20% ^[S230] Reported .	Directly strengthens the private-ownership argument in Part 4.3. Two named comparators are in play; this one is not.
Mansion House Accord	Signed 13 May 2025	17 DC providers, about 90% of active DC savers, committed to 10% of default funds in private markets by 2030, 5% ringfenced for the UK ^[S235] Confirmed .	The policy cause of the LTAF launch. Cause and effect you can name in one sentence.
Consumer Composite Investments	Commenced 6 Apr 2026	The regime replacing PRIIPs, with full implementation by 8 June 2027 ^[S224] .	Rewrites client documentation across the industry, during your internship.
ETF share classes	2026	US regulators granting relief allowing one fund to offer both mutual fund and ETF share classes ^[S236] . A US development, not yet live in the UK or EU.	Know it is a <i>US</i> story. Claiming it as a UK one is a detectable error.

DON'T SAY THIS — THE TRAP THAT CATCHES MOST CANDIDATES

Large amounts of 2026 "Fidelity" news are about **Fidelity Investments in Boston**: assets of about \$7.1trn, roughly 800 US job cuts in May 2026, US ETF share-class launches, US office-attendance mandates^{[S137][S143]}. None of it is your employer. If you walk in with a confident line about "your \$7 trillion in assets" or "your recent return-to-office policy", you have identified yourself as someone who searched "Fidelity" and stopped there.

7.3 Markets, as at 16 September 2026

SOURCE UNCERTAIN — AND DELIBERATELY BRIEF

Reported levels on the compile date: FTSE 100 around 10,732, having reached a high near 10,991 in July; UK 10-year gilt yields around 5.3 to 5.4%, near multi-decade highs, with 30-year yields around 5.9 to 6%; Bank Rate held at 3.75% with a decision due 17 September 2026^[S238] **Reported**. Gold data found in this research was internally inconsistent and is therefore omitted rather than guessed.

These will be wrong by the time you read this. Check them the morning of any interview. What matters is not the level but being able to say what moved and why.

The three themes to be able to discuss, which will outlast the specific numbers:

- **AI capital spending** as the dominant equity market driver, and the question of whether the returns justify the spend. Fidelity's own Analyst Survey 2026, "A power puzzle", published 4 April 2026, is the house view on this and is the single best thing to read before an interview^[S288].
- **UK government borrowing costs.** Long gilt yields near multi-decade highs matter directly to pension schemes and to anyone selling a bond fund.
- **The shift from rate cuts to "higher for longer"**, and what that does to the case for bonds against equities, which is the core of any multi-asset conversation.

7.4 What to read, and a twenty-minute morning routine

EVERY MORNING, TWENTY MINUTES

1. FT markets page and Lex, five minutes. What moved and why.
2. Reuters funds coverage, five minutes.
3. One UK trade outlet, five minutes: Investment Week, Portfolio Adviser or Citywire.
4. Five minutes on one thing in depth, rather than skimming a fourth source.

WEEKLY AND BEFORE ANY INTERVIEW

- The Investment Association newsroom for UK flow data.
- The FCA newsroom for policy statements and consultations.
- Fidelity International's own outlooks, the Analyst Survey and its podcast output.
- Ignites Europe and Financial News London for the industry's internal politics.
- Morningstar research for the active-versus-passive evidence base.

One discipline worth more than the reading itself: for each story, write one sentence on what it means for a firm like Fidelity International. Fifteen of those sentences is a commercial awareness answer bank that no generic preparation can match.

PART 8

Forming your own view

Six arguments where a thoughtful person could land on either side, with the evidence for each. The point of this section is not to tell you what to think. It is to make sure that whatever you think, you know the strongest version of the opposing case.

Interviewers at this level are not testing whether you agree with them. They are testing whether your view survives contact with a counter-argument. A candidate who holds a position under mild pressure and concedes a genuine point gracefully beats a candidate with a more fashionable opinion every time.

8.1 Is active management worth paying for?

THE CASE FOR

- Underperformance statistics are dominated by large, efficient markets, especially US large-cap. They are much weaker evidence about Asian smaller companies, credit or property.
- Most savers do not want a benchmark return. They want an outcome: income in retirement, capital preserved, volatility they can tolerate. An index cannot be asked for that.
- Someone must set prices. If everyone indexes, price discovery degrades. Active management is the mechanism, whoever pays for it.
- Just over 40% of active funds beat their average passive peer in the twelve months to June 2026^[S218]. A minority, but a rising one.

THE CASE AGAINST

- 94.1% of US active funds underperformed over the twenty years to 2024^[S307]. Two decades is not noise.
- Morningstar's ten-year success rate was 21%^[S308]. Picking the winner in advance is a second, harder problem on top.
- Fees compound relentlessly. Roughly 60 bps against roughly 10 bps is a 50 bp annual handicap before any skill is demonstrated^[S217].
- Clients are voting: 70.4% of UK platform net inflows went passive in Q2 2026^[S232].

WHERE TO LAND

The defensible position is narrower than "active is worth it". It is: active earns its fee in specific, less efficient places and for specific client outcomes, and an honest firm should concede the passive case in large, liquid, heavily researched markets. Note that this argument has a consequence you should be willing to follow: it implies a firm should be smaller in some markets than it would like to be. Being willing to say that is what makes it sound like a view rather than a script.

8.2 Is private ownership an advantage or an excuse?

Advantage	Excuse
No quarterly earnings call, so it can invest through a cycle. The UK platform's "multi-year investment programme" visibly cost 2024 profit ^[S78] and no shareholder forced a retreat.	Less disclosure means less external scrutiny. There is no analyst asking awkward questions on a call, and no published segmental flow data.
Clients get continuity. Two close comparators are currently being acquired ^{[S129][S132]} ; this one cannot easily be.	No listed equity means no acquisition currency and a harder time paying people in shares, which matters in a talent business.
Management and family ownership aligns decisions with long horizons ^[S76] .	It also concentrates control. The clearest public ownership figure appears to date from 2012 ^[S79] . That is not transparency.
It still cut about 1,000 roles in March 2024 ^[S142] — so privacy did not mean avoiding hard decisions.	Which cuts both ways: if a private firm restructures like a listed one, how much is the ownership really buying?

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

The last row is the sharpest challenge an interviewer could put to you, and it is worth having an answer ready. A reasonable one: private ownership does not remove commercial pressure, it removes the obligation to *time* decisions around a reporting calendar. The 2024 cuts and the simultaneous platform investment are consistent with exactly that.

8.3 Should it own a platform at all?

For: it reaches the fastest-growing client group directly. Retail is now roughly 30% of UK-managed assets, having passed pension funds^[S150]. Platform assets grew 9% against 6% for managed assets^[S78]. **Against:** it drags group operating margin to roughly 5% against roughly 27% for the fund manager alone, and commits the firm to a permanent technology race against specialists who do nothing else^{[S77][S78]}.

8.4 Four more, in brief

Question	One side	The other
Pulling back from onshore China	Disciplined. Reportedly needed \$14bn of assets to break even against roughly 4.5bn yuan actually raised ^[S223] . Stopping is the right call.	Short-termist. Three years is nothing in a market that size, and re-entry later would be expensive and slow.
Private assets in workplace pensions	Better long-term returns for savers who have decades before they need the money, and the policy direction is set ^[S235] .	Illiquid, harder to value, and harder to explain. Default-fund members did not choose it. If it goes wrong it goes wrong for people who were not asked.
AI in this function	BCG projects 25-35% cost reduction and three to five times more client coverage ^[S192] . Drafting a factsheet is an obvious use.	Every output is a regulated communication. A drafting tool that is confidently wrong is a compliance incident, and the reviewer still carries the liability.
Does this job get automated?	The production half might substantially. Assembly from approved components is exactly what software does well.	The judgement half will not: deciding what can honestly be claimed, and sitting in a room while a client is angry.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW — IF ASKED WHETHER AI THREATENS THE ROLE

"I think it splits the job in two. The production side — assembling a factsheet from approved components, drafting a first version of an RFP answer — is genuinely exposed, and probably should be. The part that isn't is the judgement about what you're allowed to claim and what the evidence actually supports, because that sits under COBS 4.2 and someone has to be accountable for it. A model can draft it. It can't be the person who signs it off. If anything that makes the reviewing skill more valuable, not less, and it's what I'd want to learn."

Why it works: it concedes the real threat rather than being defensive, it uses a rule reference, and it ends on what you want to learn.

PART 9

The interview

The stages and the real dates from the posting, the one structural fact about their method that changes how you should answer everything, a bank of forty-seven questions with scaffolds, and ten questions to ask that only real research would produce.

9.1 The process

FIGURE 25 · THE FUNNEL, WITH THE REAL DATES

Stages and dates quoted from the 2027 posting [S403], with detail from the careers site [S260][S262]

1 · Online application and CV — closes Sunday 15 November 2026, 11:55pm GMT

A short form, designed to "minimize completion time". No cover letter described. YOU ARE HERE, with about sixty days left. Eligibility: penultimate year, graduating 2028, right to work in the UK at point of application.

2 · TWO online assessments — about 40 minutes EACH — both due by the same 15 November deadline

The posting is explicit: "there are two online assessments which you'll need to complete by the time the window closes." That is roughly ninety minutes of work sitting inside your application deadline, not after it. This is the most common way to lose a place by accident.

3 · A video or first interview — described on the careers site, not in this posting

Reported as pre-recorded, roughly 4 to 5 strengths and motivation questions, filmed in one sitting. [S261] Treat as likely but not confirmed for this stream.

4 · Assessment centre — December and January

"Some, if not all" of: technical, commercial and motivational interviews, a group exercise, and a case study or technical assessment. The combination is role-dependent. [S262]

Work backwards from 15 November

Application and both assessments done by mid-November. Interview preparation through late November. Assessment centre material ready by early December.

Figure 25. The stages. Dates and the two-assessment structure **Confirmed** from the posting [S403]; stage 3 **Reported** and not named in the posting. Underlying sources as marked; all accessed 16 September 2026.

THE STRUCTURAL FACT THAT CHANGES EVERYTHING: THIS IS STRENGTHS-BASED, NOT COMPETENCY-BASED

Fidelity's own FAQ refers to a "strengths-based assessment process"[S262] **Confirmed**, and a recruiter is quoted saying the firm moved away from "competency-based questions" toward "core strengths that motivate someone"[S261] **Reported**.

What this means in practice. A competency interview asks "tell me about a time you worked in a team" and rewards a polished STAR story. A strengths interview asks "what kind of work do you lose track of time doing?" and is designed to catch rehearsal. The questions come faster, they are more varied, and the interviewer is listening for energy and consistency rather than structure.

So prepare differently. Do not memorise six STAR stories. Instead know, honestly: what you are good at, what drains you, what you would choose to do on a free afternoon, and why this specific seat fits those answers. Then have the *facts* from this pack available to support whatever you say. Strengths format does not excuse you from knowing things. It just means you cannot recite.

SOURCE UNCERTAIN — WHAT THE TWO ASSESSMENTS ACTUALLY CONTAIN

The posting confirms there are two, each around 40 minutes^[S403], but does not say what they are or who supplies them. No source confirms the publisher: "Cappfinity" and "SHL" appeared in secondary summaries, contradicted each other, and did not survive verification^{[S264][S265]}.

What every detailed source does agree on: numerical reasoning, logical reasoning, and a personality or situational judgement component^{[S264][S265][S266]}. Two blocks of about 40 minutes is consistent with one cognitive assessment and one behavioural or situational one, though that is inference *Inferred*, not something the firm states.

Practise percentage change, ratios, and reading values off charts and tables. Do not buy a preparation product sold on a named-provider claim that this research could not verify.

9.2 What each stage is really testing

Stage	What they are testing	What to do about it
Application	Whether you understand what the team does. Their own line: they do not seek pre-existing technical skill but do seek "an understanding of what we do and what you would need to do in the role and team you are applying for" ^[S262] .	Use Part 1. Name the function correctly, name one real duty, and name one thing about the firm that is not on the homepage. Their person spec asks for "analytical, eager to learn and ready to take on a challenge" and "attention to detail" ^[S403] — answer those words.
The two online assessments	Baseline numeracy and reasoning under time pressure, plus a behavioural or situational component. About 40 minutes each ^[S403] .	Practise percentage change, ratios and reading data off charts. Do them on paper first — most failures are arithmetic slips, not conceptual gaps. Book two quiet 45-minute slots well before 15 November.
Video interview	Motivation and strengths, with no interviewer to react to you.	Answer to the lens. Short answers. Get your best point out in the first fifteen seconds because there is no follow-up question to rescue you.
Case study	Thought process. Their own materials describe the case as testing reasoning rather than a single right answer ^[S260] .	Narrate your assumptions out loud, state what you would want to know that you have not been given, and commit to a recommendation anyway.
Group exercise	Whether you make the group better.	Bring in the quiet person, keep time, summarise where the group has got to. Do not win the argument.

9.3 The question bank

Forty-seven questions. For each: what is really being tested, how to build the answer, which facts from this pack to use, and the trap. These are scaffolds. If you memorise them the strengths format will expose you.

A · Motivation

1 Why asset management rather than investment banking or private equity?

TESTS genuine interest against prestige-chasing. **BUILD** contrast the ownership mindset — you hold the asset for years and answer to the person whose money it is — with deal-based advisory work. Anchor it in one specific thing: a fund, a market event, a book. **TRAP** criticising banking to seem virtuous. You will be working alongside ex-bankers.

2 Why Fidelity International and not Schroders, M&G, abrdn or BlackRock?

TESTS research depth. **BUILD** one differentiator you can defend under one more question. **USE** private ownership while two named peers are being acquired^{[S129][S132]}; or owning manufacturing and UK distribution together^[S78]; or Asia from 1969^[S70]. **TRAP** naming a fact you cannot extend by one sentence.

3 Why Investment Directing rather than research or portfolio management?

TESTS whether you know the role is commercial. **BUILD** the JD says the team exists to "commercialise" the investment capabilities; you are drawn to translation and to breadth across five asset classes rather than depth in one name. **TRAP** describing it as portfolio management. This is the single fastest disqualifier in the process.

4 Why not equity research?

BUILD respect for the function, then the honest difference: research goes deep on one name, this seat goes wide across Equities, Fixed Income, Multi Asset, Systematic and Real Estate and is judged on whether a client understood and stayed. **TRAP** implying research is dull.

5 Why not sales?

BUILD Investment Directing sits closer to the investment process — reporting on portfolios, thought leadership — while sales owns the relationship and the number. **TRAP** implying sales is less intellectual. They sit ten feet away.

6 What do you think an Investment Directing intern actually does?

BUILD straight from the duty lines: supporting investment directors, preparing presentation and reporting material, sourcing data and internal views from busy people, project support. Add that you expect most of it to be drafting that someone senior marks up. **TRAP** describing a trading floor.

7 What do you want to learn in ten weeks?

BUILD something only this seat offers: how a firm decides what it can honestly claim about a portfolio, and where the line sits between simplifying and misleading. **TRAP** an answer that would fit any internship anywhere.

8 Tell me about Fidelity International.

BUILD thirty seconds, not three minutes. 1969, independent since 1980, private, Bermuda-registered with London its main hub, five investment groups, and unusually it owns UK distribution too. Then stop and let them direct you. **TRAP** reciting the whole of Part 2.

9 What attracted you to the culture?

USE the firm's stated purpose, "working together to build better financial futures", which is in the audited accounts rather than only the marketing^[S78], and its own line "as a private company we think generationally"^[S76]. Pair with one concrete example of your own. **TRAP** reciting values words with no evidence.

10 Where do you want to be in five years?

BUILD a real path: associate investment director, then investment director covering an asset class^[S1]. Naming the actual grade structure shows you looked. **TRAP** "a portfolio manager", which says you want a different job.

B · Commercial awareness

11 What is happening in the asset management industry right now?

BUILD three forces with numbers: passive took 70.4% of UK platform net inflows in Q2 2026^[S232]; UK industry assets hit a record £11.1trn in 2025^[S234]; consolidation, with two close peers in play^{[S129][S132]}. **TRAP** listing trends with no figures or dates.

12 If passive keeps winning, what happens to a firm like this?

BUILD three responses it is visibly making: active ETFs^[S226], private markets via the LTAF^[S224], and owning distribution so it earns from assets it does not manage^[S78]. **TRAP** denying the premise.

13 Tell me about a recent news story relevant to us.

USE the China story of 21 August 2026 and the tension with the house investment view^[S223]. **TRAP** a Fidelity Investments story from Boston. Check which firm before you open your mouth.

14 What is the Mansion House Accord and why does it matter here?

BUILD signed 13 May 2025, 17 DC providers, about 90% of active DC savers, 10% of default funds into private markets by 2030 with 5% ringfenced for the UK^[S235]. Then the link: it is why the LTAF exists. **TRAP** knowing the name but not the mechanism.

15 What regulation most affects this team?

BUILD COBS 4.2's fair, clear and not misleading test^[S14], COBS 4.6 on past performance^[S400], Consumer Duty's consumer understanding outcome^[S401], and the live Consumer Composite Investments transition to June 2027^[S224]. **TRAP** saying "MiFID II" and stopping.

16 What do you think of the fee pressure in the industry?

USE the fulcrum fee: 0.65% base flexing 0.45% to 0.85%, launched July 2018 after the FCA market study, pulled from open-ended funds May 2021 for lack of demand^[S72]. **TRAP** treating fee pressure as purely bad. It also forces firms to say what they are actually for.

17 Where do you think markets go from here?

BUILD a view with a mechanism and a thing that would change your mind. **TRAP** false confidence. "I don't have a strong directional view, but here's the debate I find most interesting and where I lean" is a perfectly good answer from an intern.

18 What is one risk to this firm's business model?

BUILD pick a real one: platform technology spend depressing group margin to roughly 5%^{[S77][S78]}; senior investment turnover^[S78]; or dependence on active flows while passive wins. **TRAP** refusing to name one.

19 Who are this firm's competitors?

BUILD segment it: UK active peers (Schroders, M&G, Aberdeen, Baillie Gifford), global scale players (BlackRock, Amundi, JPMAM), and UK platform competitors, which are a different set entirely. **TRAP** naming Fidelity Investments as a competitor without explaining the 1980 split.

20 What do you make of AI in this industry?

USE the split in Part 8.4: production is exposed, judgement and accountability are not, and everything produced is a regulated communication someone must sign. **USE** BCG's projected 25-35% cost reduction^[S192].

C · Technical and industry

21 What is the difference between AUM and AUA?

ANSWER managed versus administered. **USE** the real numbers: £189.5bn and £104.4bn in the UK at end-2024^[S78], earning roughly 35 bps and roughly 20 bps respectively. Almost no candidate can do this.

22 What is a basis point, and why does the industry use them?

One hundredth of one per cent. Fees are charged on asset value, so revenue moves with markets without an invoice. Hence a market fall is immediately a revenue event.

23 What is performance attribution?

Decomposing return against a benchmark into its causes: stock selection, sector or asset allocation, duration, currency. It is the core analytical content of a client review.

24 Explain active share and tracking error.

Active share is how much the portfolio differs from the benchmark by holdings. Tracking error is how much the *return* has differed, annualised. High fees with low active share is the "closet tracker" problem regulators care about.

25 What is an OEIC? A unit trust? An investment trust?

See Part 5.1. The key distinction: investment trusts are closed-ended and listed, so the price can differ from the value of the assets, which is why they can use structures open-ended funds cannot — including the surviving fulcrum fee^[S72].

26 What is an LTAF and what is hard about it?

A UK structure for illiquid private assets in long-term savings^[S224]. Hard because notice periods, valuation uncertainty and explaining illiquidity honestly to default-fund members who did not choose it.

27 What is a benchmark and why does the choice matter?

The yardstick. It matters because it defines outperformance, and because under COBS 4.6.2R past performance must be shown against an appropriate reference^[S400]. Choosing a flattering benchmark is a conduct issue, not a marketing choice.

28 What is GIPS?

Global Investment Performance Standards. Composite construction rules that stop a firm showing only its best account^[S18]. Frequently a precondition in institutional RFPs.

29 What is an RFP and who reads it?

See Part 1.2. Written by you, read by a consultant or a scheme's investment team, scored against competitors, and effectively contractual in tone.

30 What does an investment consultant do, and why should you care?

They gatekeep institutional searches through ratings and buy lists^[S11]. A downgrade closes more business than any campaign replaces. The CMA ran a full market investigation into their power^[S12].

31 What is the difference between DB and DC pensions?

Defined benefit promises an income and the employer carries the risk; defined contribution builds a pot and the member carries it. DB is closing and de-risking; DC is where growth and policy attention are.

32 Why can't you just show the best five-year period?

THE SINGLE BEST TECHNICAL ANSWER IN THIS PACK. COBS 4.6.2R fixes the window: the preceding five years in complete twelve-month periods, not the most prominent feature, with the reference period and source stated and a prominent warning that past performance is not a reliable indicator of future results^[S400].

33 What is the anti-greenwashing rule?

In force 31 May 2024. Every sustainability claim must be fair, clear and not misleading. Separately the fund naming and marketing rules applied from 2 December 2024^[S19].

34 What is Consumer Duty, in one sentence?

A requirement to act to deliver good outcomes for retail customers, published 27 July 2022 as PS22/9 and in force for open products from 31 July 2023, with four outcomes including consumer understanding^[S401].

35 What is inside information, and why does it matter in this seat?

Price-sensitive non-public information. It matters because you sit near people who hold it. Reference the FCA's 2015 thematic review on market abuse in asset management and its wall-crossing good practice^[S17].

D · Strengths and behaviour

36 What kind of work makes you lose track of time?

TESTS whether your stated motivation matches your actual preferences. **BUILD** answer honestly, then connect. If the honest answer is "making something complicated make sense to someone", that is this job. If it is "building models alone", say so and explain why you still want this seat.

37 What are you not good at?

BUILD a real weakness plus the specific mechanism you use to manage it. **TRAP** a disguised strength. In a strengths-based process this is the most obviously rehearsed answer and the easiest to spot.

38 Tell me about a time you got something wrong.

BUILD what happened, who you told and how fast, what you changed. **EMPHASISE THE DISCLOSURE**, not the recovery. In a regulated firm, speed of escalation is the competence being tested.

39 Describe explaining something technical to someone who did not have the background.

THIS IS THE JOB. Give a real example, and include what you deliberately left out and why leaving it out was still honest. That last part is the whole skill.

40 How do you handle competing deadlines from people more senior than you?

BUILD surface the collision rather than silently choosing; ask which slips; confirm in writing. See the scenario playbook in Part 11.

41 Tell me about working with someone difficult.

TRAP making them the villain. The signal they want is whether you can be generous about a colleague while still describing a real problem.

42 How do you check your work?

BUILD an actual method, not "I'm detail-oriented". Reading backwards, checking every figure against source, leaving it and rereading, having a named second pair of eyes. Detail orientation is the core requirement of this seat, so assert it with evidence or not at all.

E · Case study and curveballs

43 A fund you cover is down 8% against a benchmark down 2%. Draft the client update.

BUILD get the facts and the attribution first; establish what the manager actually says; state the shortfall plainly at the top rather than burying it; explain the causes; say what would have to change for the thesis to be wrong. **TRAP** leading with market conditions. Clients read that as evasion, and under Consumer Duty's understanding outcome it is a real risk, not just bad style.

44 Should we launch this product? Here is the data.

BUILD demand evidence, capability to run it, whether it can be explained honestly, target market under MiFID II product governance^[S16], and cannibalisation of existing funds. Commit to a recommendation.

45 Pitch me a stock.

Not confirmed as a standard component for this stream^[S268], but prepare one anyway. Two minutes: what it does, why it is mispriced, what would prove you wrong. **TRAP** a company you cannot explain the business model of.

46 Sell me this pen.

WHAT IT REALLY TESTS here: whether you ask what the person needs before pitching. That is the honest-selling instinct the whole regulatory framework is built around.

47 What haven't I asked you that I should have?

BUILD have one prepared. The strongest use is the thing that most differentiates you and has not come up — for most readers of this pack, the regulatory understanding in Part 1.5 or the audited-accounts research in Part 2.2.

9.4 Ten questions to ask

Each of these is only askable by someone who did the research. Pick two or three, and adapt them to what you actually heard in the conversation.

1. "Investment Directing seems to sit under Distribution rather than under the CIO, from what I could find publicly. Does it feel like a commercial function that has to be technically credible, or a technical function that happens to be commercial? I'd imagine that shapes the day quite a lot."
2. "How does the team decide when a market move is big enough to justify new client commentary, rather than waiting for the scheduled update?"
3. "With the Consumer Composite Investments regime replacing PRIIPs by June 2027, how much of the team's capacity is going into rebuilding client documentation, and will that still be live next summer?"
4. "The 2024 accounts described stepping back from manufacturing non-core private assets while the firm was also launching an LTAF for the workplace default. Is the distinction that you'd rather distribute private assets than build them yourselves?"
5. "Given the firm runs both the funds and the UK platforms, does Investment Directing ever produce material aimed at end investors on the platform, or is the output always intermediated through advisers and institutions?"
6. "Would an intern support one of the five asset-class groups for the whole ten weeks, or see how the approach differs across them? I'd be curious whether Real Estate works very differently, given it's illiquid."
7. "Is there a feedback loop from an actual client win or a retained mandate back to the people who wrote the material, or is that connection hard to trace?"
8. "The careers site says you don't expect technical skills but do expect an understanding of the role. What's the one piece of context you wish interns arrived with that isn't obvious from the outside?"
9. "How much does the London team work with the Asia offices day to day, given the firm's history there goes back to Tokyo in 1969?"

10. "When compliance pushes back on a piece of material, what does that conversation usually look like? I'm curious whether it's a negotiation about wording or a harder line than that."

DON'T ASK THIS

Anything answered on the first page of the careers site. Anything about salary or hours at first-round stage. And do not ask "what do you enjoy about working here?" — it is not a bad question, it is just the question everyone asks, and it wastes the one slot where you could have shown your research.

PART 10

Who you will meet

You have not told me who is interviewing you, so this is built on the three archetypes you will actually face, plus the publicly identifiable people whose views set the house line you may be tested against. Public professional information only.

A NOTE ON HOW THIS SECTION WAS BUILT

Everything here comes from public professional sources: company announcements, trade press, conference and survey material, and the firm's own pages. Nothing personal. Where a person's identity or current title could not be confirmed against a fetched primary source, that is stated rather than smoothed over. Titles change. **Verify anyone you intend to name before you name them.**

10.1 The three people you will actually face

FIGURE 26 · READING THE ROOM, AND ADJUSTING

Three archetypes. Same facts, three different pitches.

The early careers recruiter Listening for Motivation, coachability, whether you'd be pleasant to sit next to for ten weeks. Bores them Deep technical detail they can't assess, and rehearsed competency answers. Pitch Warm, specific, human. One concrete fact to prove you did the work, not six.	The practitioner Listening for Whether you understand the actual job, and whether you'd create work for them. Bores them Brand enthusiasm. Anything from the homepage. Pitch Go technical. The duty-line decode, COBS 4.6, the AUM/AUA distinction. This is who Part 1 is written for.	The senior investor Listening for Judgement. Whether you can hold a view and change it for a reason. Bores them Recited facts with no view attached. Fake certainty. Pitch Lead with an opinion, then the evidence, then what would change your mind. Part 8 is written for them.
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How to tell quickly: ask early who you are speaking with and what they do. It is a normal question, and the answer tells you which column to run. Archetypes are the author's framework, built on the process evidence in [S260][S261][S262]. No source confirms a senior investor sits on internship panels specifically. [Inferred]

Figure 26. Interviewer archetypes. Inferred framework. Underlying sources as marked; all accessed 16 September 2026.

10.2 The people whose views set the house line

Person	Role	Public professional background	Confidence
Abigail Johnson	Chair of Fidelity International	Also chief executive of Fidelity Investments in Boston, the separate firm[S402]. The one person who connects the two companies today.	Confirmed
Keith Metters	President	Appointed with effect from 1 March 2024, previously global head of platform solutions, and earlier in his career at Fidelity Investments in the US[S221].	Confirmed
Anne Richards	Vice Chair	Chief executive from December 2018; announced on 20 November 2023 she would step down, moving to vice chair[S220]. A further move to a senior adviser role in January 2026 was reported but could not be confirmed[S222].	Reported

Person	Role	Public professional background	Confidence
Niamh Brodie-Machura	Co-CIO, Equities	Appointed 4 March 2024 when the CIO role was split ^[S289] . The named voice of the Analyst Survey 2026. Previously at Fidelity Investments in the US, which is worth knowing and being straight about ^[S291] .	Confirmed
Marion Le Morhedec	Global CIO, Fixed Income	Joined September 2025 after two decades at AXA Investment Managers, latterly Global Head of Fixed Income. Replaced Steve Ellis ^[S290] .	Confirmed
Tom Stevenson	Investment Director, Fidelity Personal Investing	The firm's most publicly visible commentator. Writes a quarterly outlook for UK retail investors, the Q2 2026 edition published 9 April 2026 ^[S295] , and appears on the FidelityConnects platform.	Confirmed
Derek Young	Global Head of Asset Management Distribution	Reported to oversee, since March 2024, "the Client Propositions team comprised of product, solutions and investment directing teams" ^{[S41][S53]} — the clearest public evidence of where your function sits.	Reported
Cara Hewitt	Chief executive, FIL Holdings (UK)	Appointed 19 July 2024, succeeding Tony Lanser. Board chaired separately by Peter Horrell ^[S78] .	Confirmed

Public professional information only. Confidence as marked. **Not found:** any named Head of Investment Directing globally or for the UK, and no named CIO for Systematic Investing or Real Estate. Those are gaps, not omissions — see Part 16.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW — THE SINGLE BEST-VALUE NAME TO KNOW

"I've been reading Tom Stevenson's quarterly outlook, partly for the market view and partly because his job title is Investment Director, which is the role I'm applying to. It's been quite useful to see what the output of the job actually looks like from the outside rather than just reading a description of it."

Why it works: it proves you engaged with the firm's actual published output, it shows you understood the role well enough to find someone doing it in public, and it is verifiably true because you can go and read it this afternoon.

10.3 The house view you may be tested against

Fidelity International's flagship publication is its annual **Analyst Survey**. The 2026 edition, "A power puzzle", was published 4 April 2026, drawing on more than 120 analysts and over 20,000 company management meetings, with data captured through early March 2026^[S291] **Confirmed**.

Headline findings worth knowing:

- An AI-driven rebound in corporate sentiment: 81% of analysts covering IT and 65% covering materials reported moderate to significant confidence for the year ahead.
- AI infrastructure spending broadening out of large technology platforms into materials, industrials and energy, driven by demand for power and commodities for datacentres.
- Persistent cost pressure: **only 8% of analysts expect inflation to ease** over the next twelve months; about half expect it to hold and 40% expect further increases.
- A "K-shaped" divide between AI-exposed sectors growing strongly and consumer-facing sectors under affordability strain.

Niamh Brodie-Machura is quoted saying AI investment "is cascading through power and industrial supply chains" and that "detailed fundamental research and active stock selection become increasingly important"^[S291] **Confirmed**.

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE — AND NOTE THE SELF-INTEREST

That second quotation is a house that sells fundamental research concluding that fundamental research is becoming more important. It may well be right. It is also exactly what they would conclude. Being able to say "I found the survey persuasive on the capex broadening, and I noticed the conclusion about active stock selection is one the firm has an interest in reaching — though the K-shaped dispersion argument does actually support it" is the kind of remark that gets remembered.

DON'T SAY THIS

"Anne Richards, your CEO." She is not, and has not been since 2024. See Part 0. Also avoid quoting the Outlook 2026 document in detail: it exists, but this pack could not read it^[S297], so anything you have heard about its contents second-hand is unverified.

PART 11

The scenario playbook

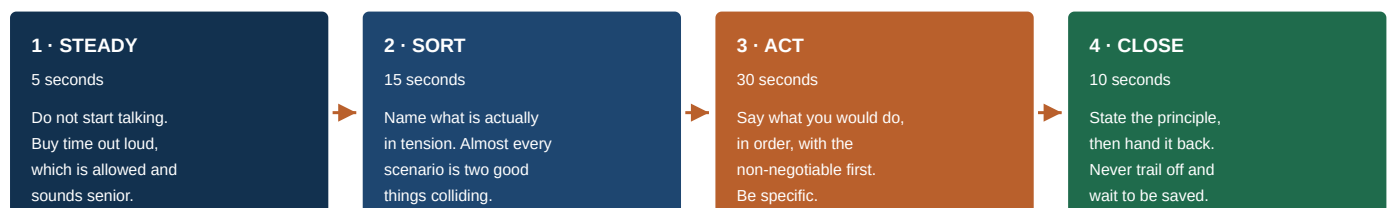
A method for answering any situational question in under a minute and a half, the priority order for when good things collide, the eight ways an interviewer will try to break your frame, twenty-seven scenarios built from the job description, five composure tests with decision trees, and the CV grill.

11.1 The four-step protocol

Every scenario question is the same question underneath: when this gets hard, what kind of person are you? The protocol below buys you three seconds of thinking time, imposes a structure, and ends with you in control of the conversation rather than waiting to be rescued.

FIGURE 27 · STEADY, SORT, ACT, CLOSE

Forty-five to seventy-five seconds. Any scenario. Every time.



The exact phrases that execute each step

Steady	"Let me take that in order, because I think there are two things going on here."
Sort	"The tension is between [the deadline] and [the thing that cannot be wrong]. The second one binds."
Act	"So, first I'd... then I'd... and in parallel I'd tell [person] that [consequence]."
Close	"The principle I'd hold is that we can be late and explain it. We can't be wrong and unexplain it. Would you have gone further?"

Method is the author's. The priority order it encodes follows from the regulatory obligations sourced in Part 1.5 and Part 11.2.

Figure 27. The answer protocol. **Inferred** method. Method diagram: no external source. Devised by the author of this pack; compiled 16 September 2026.

WHY THE CLOSE MATTERS MORE THAN THE REST

Most candidates produce a reasonable middle and then evaporate: "...so yeah, I think that's what I'd do." The close does two things. It converts your answer from an anecdote into a principle, which is what gets remembered. And handing a question back turns an interrogation into a conversation, which is the position you want to be in for the next forty minutes.

11.2 The priority order when good things collide

Almost every scenario in this job is a collision between four legitimate goods. They are not equal, and knowing the order is most of the answer.

FIGURE 28 · THE ORDER, AND WHY

When these collide, the higher one wins. Always, and without agonising.

1 · The rules, and the firm's licence to operate

COBS 4.2 fair, clear and not misleading. COBS 4.6 on performance. Market abuse. Nothing below this line outranks it. Ever.

2 · Fair treatment of every client, not just the one shouting

Consumer Duty Rule 6: act to deliver good outcomes for retail customers. The loudest client does not get the best answer.

3 · The process and the record

Four eyes on anything client-facing. Write down what you were told and when. Records are the only thing that survives a dispute.

4 · Speed

Genuinely matters. Comes last. A missed deadline is a bad day; a wrong number in a client document is a different category of event.

"We can be late and explain it. We cannot be wrong and unexplain it."

Figure 28. The priority order, encoding obligations sourced in Part 1.5. **Inferred** as a ranking. Method diagram: no external source. Devised by the author of this pack; compiled 16 September 2026.

That closing sentence is the one line to hold every frame. It works because it concedes that speed matters, rather than pretending it does not, and then explains why it still loses.

The conduct rules underneath it

You do not need to recite these, but knowing they exist changes how you answer. The FCA's Code of Conduct sets out Individual Conduct Rules applying to almost everyone at a regulated firm^[S351] **Confirmed** :

1. You must act with integrity.
2. You must act with due skill, care and diligence.
3. You must be open and cooperative with the FCA, the PRA and other regulators.
4. You must pay due regard to the interests of customers and treat them fairly.
5. You must observe proper standards of market conduct.
6. You must act to deliver good outcomes for retail customers.

Rules 1 to 5 have applied since 7 March 2016; Rule 6 was added on 31 July 2023 to align individual accountability with Consumer Duty^[S350] **Confirmed** . These sit inside the Senior Managers and Certification Regime, extended to asset managers from December 2019^[S352].

The point for you: a mis-stated performance number in a pitchbook is not a marketing slip. It is potentially a Rule 1 or Rule 2 matter for whoever signed it off. That is why the people around you will seem disproportionately careful, and why matching their care is how you earn trust as an intern.

11.3 Eight ways they will break your frame

Some interviewers deliberately apply pressure to see what happens. None of this is personal, and all of it has a counter. The general principle: **do not speed up, and do not abandon a correct position just because someone frowned.**

Tactic	What it looks like	What it is testing	The counter
1 Interruption	You are cut off mid-sentence, repeatedly.	Whether you get flustered or resentful.	Stop cleanly, answer what they asked, then: "Can I finish the earlier point? There was one part that matters." Never talk over them.

Tactic	What it looks like	What it is testing	The counter
2 Flat contradiction	"That's wrong."	Whether you fold instantly or dig in stupidly.	"It may be. What I based it on was [source]. What am I missing?" You are right or you learn something. Both are fine.
3 Silence	You finish; they say nothing and look at you.	Whether you fill the gap with worse material.	Stop. Count to three. If it continues: "Happy to go deeper on any part of that." Do not ramble into the vacuum. Almost everyone does.
4 Escalation	"Fine — but what if the client is now threatening to pull the mandate?"	Whether your principle survives a bigger number.	The principle does not move as the stakes rise. "That raises the urgency and it doesn't change what we're allowed to say. It does change who needs to know, so I'd get my manager involved immediately."
5 Authority squeeze	"The head of the desk has told you to just send it."	Whether seniority overrides rules for you.	Respect the person, hold the line, escalate upward not sideways. See the composure set in 11.5.
6 False choice	"So do you miss the deadline or send it unchecked?"	Whether you accept a rigged frame.	Reject the two options, name a third: "Neither. I'd send the part that is checked, flag what's outstanding, and give a time for the rest."
7 Knowledge trap	A question about something you cannot know, sometimes about a thing that does not exist.	Whether you will bluff.	"I don't know." Then add how you would find out. Bluffing is the single most damaging thing you can do in a regulated firm, and they are testing precisely for it.
8 Invitation to badmouth	"Your last manager sounds difficult." Or "what do you make of [competitor]?"	Discretion. What you would say about <i>them</i> later.	Be generous about people and specific about problems. "It was a hard environment for reasons that weren't really anyone's fault. What I took from it was..."

Author's construction from standard interview practice **Inferred**. The underlying obligations that make tactics 4 and 5 answerable are sourced in Part 1.5 and Part 11.2.

SAY THIS WHEN YOU GENUINELY DO NOT KNOW

"I don't know. I'd want to check that with the performance team rather than guess, because it's the kind of number that ends up in a client document. What I can tell you is how I'd think about it..."

This converts ignorance into evidence of judgement. It is one of the strongest things you can say in the whole interview, and it is only available to people who are willing to say the first three words.

11.4 Staying physically calm

- **Breathe out longer than you breathe in.** Four in, six out, twice, before you go in. It slows your heart rate. It is not mysticism, it is the vagus nerve.
- **Slow your first sentence deliberately.** Nerves show up as speed. If the first sentence is slow, the rest follows.
- **Put both feet on the floor and your hands still.** On video, keep your hands in frame; fidgeting is much more visible on camera than in a room.
- **Drink water when you need thinking time.** It is a legitimate, invisible pause.
- **If you lose your thread, say so.** "Sorry, I've lost where I was going — can I restart that answer?" Universally granted, and far better than trailing off.

11.5 The scenario ladder

Twenty-seven scenarios, three for each duty line in the job description, easy to hard. Work down a ladder rather than across, because the hard rung is always the easy rung with the stakes raised, and the answer should not change.

HOW TO USE THESE

Do not memorise the words. For each card, cover the answer and try it yourself using the four-step protocol in Figure 19. Then compare. The value is in noticing *which principle* the answer reaches for, not in the phrasing.

FIGURE 29 · THE LADDER

Nine duty lines, three rungs each. The principle never changes; only the stakes do.

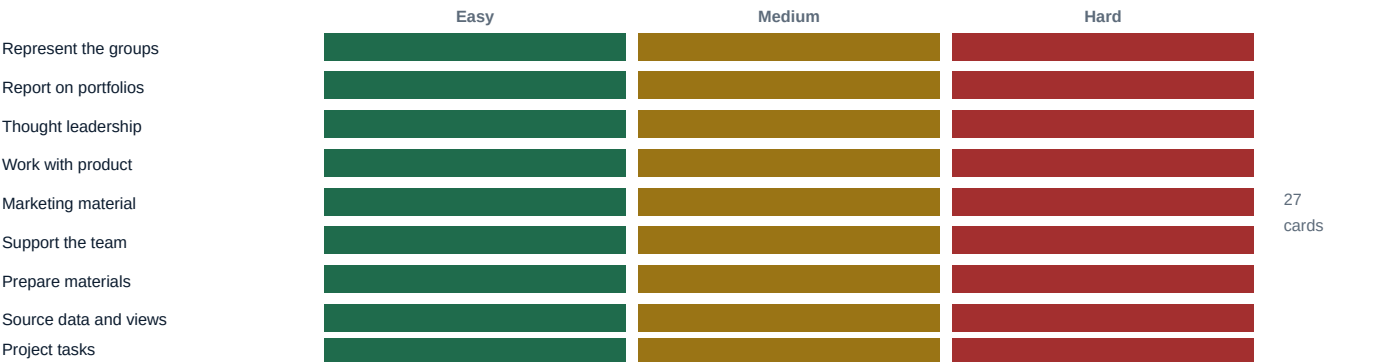


Figure 29. Coverage map of the scenario set. Method diagram: no external source. Devised by the author of this pack; compiled 16 September 2026.

Duty line 1 · "Representing the Equities, Fixed Income, Multi Asset, Systematic Investing and Real Estate groups to prospective and existing clients"

A client asks a question you cannot answer in the meeting

EASY

THE SETUP

You are sitting in on a client review. The client asks about the fund's exposure to a sector and nobody in the room has the number.

THE TRAP

Guessing, or producing an approximate number to look useful.

WHAT TO SAY

"I don't want to give you a number from memory on something you may act on. I'll come back to you today with the exact figure as at a stated date." Then actually do it the same day.

WHY IT WORKS

It shows you understand that a number given verbally in a client meeting is still a communication with a client. Following up the same day converts a non-answer into evidence of reliability.

THE TWIST, AND HOLDING IT

Twist: "They're pushing — they want it now." Hold. "I'd rather be an hour late and right. If it's genuinely urgent I'd step out and call the desk."

The client asks what the manager is buying right now

MEDIUM

THE SETUP

A large prospective client asks, reasonably, whether the manager is adding to a position they have been discussing.

THE TRAP

Answering. It feels helpful and harmless, and it is neither.

WHAT TO SAY

"I can talk about how the manager thinks about that position and the published positioning as at the last reporting date. What I can't do is talk about live trading intentions, because that would be selective disclosure and it's not something we do for any client."

WHY IT WORKS

It names the boundary and, crucially, frames it as protecting *them* too. The discipline is the same one the FCA set out in its 2015 thematic review on market abuse in asset management.^[S17]

THE TWIST, AND HOLDING IT

Twist: "Our other manager tells us." Answer: "Then I'd be a bit concerned on their behalf. I'm happy to be the boring one on this."

You are asked to present a strategy you have doubts about

HARD

THE SETUP

You are covering a fund whose recent performance you privately find hard to defend, in front of a consultant who has done their homework.

THE TRAP

Either overselling it or visibly distancing yourself from your own firm's product.

WHAT TO SAY

"The last two years have been below benchmark, and here's the attribution for why. The manager's case is that the thesis is intact and here's the specific evidence for that. Here's what would tell us the thesis is actually broken."

WHY IT WORKS

Naming a falsification condition is what separates an honest investment case from marketing. It is also what a consultant is actually listening for.

THE TWIST, AND HOLDING IT

Twist: "Do you believe it?" Answer: "My job is to represent the manager's view accurately, and I've pushed them on exactly the question you're asking. What persuaded me was..."

Duty line 2 · "Reporting on portfolios"

The performance number does not tie out

EASY

THE SETUP

The figure in your draft factsheet does not match the performance team's official number. It is close, but not the same.

THE TRAP

Assuming yours is a rounding difference and shipping it.

WHAT TO SAY

"I'd stop and reconcile before anything goes further. Any difference has a cause, and I'd want to know whether it's share class, currency, or period before I decide it's immaterial."

WHY IT WORKS

Everything traceable back to a GIPS-governed composite has to be exact.^[S18] "Close enough" is not a category that exists here.

THE TWIST, AND HOLDING IT

Twist: "It's 0.01%." Answer: "Then it'll take five minutes to explain, and I'll know why. If I can't explain a difference I don't know what else it's affecting."

A factsheet error is found after distribution**MEDIUM****THE SETUP**

A factsheet went out yesterday with a wrong figure. You spotted it. Nobody else has.

THE TRAP

Waiting to see whether anyone notices, or fixing it silently in the next version.

WHAT TO SAY

"I'd tell my manager and compliance immediately, today, before working out the fix. Then: how many clients received it, is it material, does it need a correction notice. I wouldn't quietly correct the next edition."

WHY IT WORKS

Speed of escalation is the competence being tested. Conduct Rule 3 is about being open with regulators; the internal version is the same instinct.^[S350]

THE TWIST, AND HOLDING IT

Twist: "You'll look incompetent." Answer: "I'll look worse in three months when a client finds it. And the person who finds their own mistake is more trustworthy than the person who has never reported one."

You are asked to start the track record at a flattering date**HARD****THE SETUP**

Someone senior suggests the performance chart would look much better starting from the market low rather than the standard period.

THE TRAP

Treating this as a presentational preference to be negotiated.

WHAT TO SAY

"I don't think we can. COBS 4.6.2R requires past performance to cover the preceding five years in complete twelve-month periods, and it can't be the most prominent feature. If we want to show the recovery we'd have to show it alongside the required periods, not instead of them."

WHY IT WORKS

This is the single strongest technical answer available in the whole playbook, because it is precise, correct, verifiable, and answers a request almost every candidate would simply comply with.^[S400]

THE TWIST, AND HOLDING IT

Twist: "It's for an institutional client, so retail rules don't apply." Answer: "That may change which rule applies, and I'd check rather than assume. But the fair, clear and not misleading test in COBS 4.2 doesn't go away."

Duty line 3 · "Promoting thought leadership on topics"**You are asked to write a market commentary in a day****EASY****THE SETUP**

A view piece is wanted on a market move, by tomorrow morning.

THE TRAP

Writing something confident and generic that could have been written a year ago.

WHAT TO SAY

"I'd get the house view first rather than invent one — go to the strategist or the PM, get the line to take, and write to that. My value here is clarity, not originality."

WHY IT WORKS

Interns who invent house views create compliance problems. Interns who go and get the view build relationships with the people who have it.

THE TWIST, AND HOLDING IT

Twist: "Nobody's available." Answer: "Then I'd draft from published material we've already approved and flag clearly which parts need a view attached before it can go out."

The interesting angle is the one the firm cannot take

MEDIUM

THE SETUP

The genuinely compelling piece would argue something at odds with the firm's positioning.

THE TRAP

Either writing it anyway, or writing something dishonest.

WHAT TO SAY

"I'd raise it rather than bury it. If our own analysts' evidence points somewhere uncomfortable, that's worth a conversation, not a quiet edit. What we can't do is publish a view the investment team doesn't hold."

WHY IT WORKS

Thought leadership is a financial promotion under the same COBS 4.2 test as a factsheet.^[S14] It is not a free space.

THE TWIST, AND HOLDING IT

Twist: "So you'd just write the safe version?" Answer: "I'd write the honest version of the view we actually hold. Safe and honest aren't the same thing, and the honest one is usually more interesting anyway."

You are asked to comment on a competitor's problem

HARD

THE SETUP

A rival has had a public failure. Marketing wants a piece implicitly contrasting it with your firm.

THE TRAP

Writing it. It is commercially tempting and reputationally cheap.

WHAT TO SAY

"I'd want to be careful. A piece about what went wrong in general terms and what good practice looks like is defensible. A piece that is really about a named competitor's difficulty is a different thing, and I don't think it's the way we'd want to win."

WHY IT WORKS

It shows commercial judgement and an understanding that reputation is an asset with a long duration.

THE TWIST, AND HOLDING IT

Twist: "You're being squeamish, this is a competitive industry." Answer: "Maybe. My worry is that the client thinks less of us for it, not more. I'd want a second opinion rather than decide that on my own."

Duty line 4 · "Working with product development to create new products to meet investors' demands"

The same RFP question keeps coming up

EASY

THE SETUP

You notice the same question appearing in four different RFPs in a month.

THE TRAP

Answering it four times and moving on.

WHAT TO SAY

"I'd log it and raise it. Four clients asking the same thing isn't four questions, it's a signal. That's the kind of thing Product would want, and it's the cheapest research the firm will get all month."

WHY IT WORKS

It shows you understand the feedback loop the job description describes, and that you would be a useful node in it rather than a pass-through.

THE TWIST, AND HOLDING IT

Twist: "Four isn't a trend." Answer: "Agreed, which is why I'd report it as four instances with the wording, not as a trend. Product can decide if it's a pattern."

A client wants a product you are not sure should exist**MEDIUM****THE SETUP**

A large client asks for a variant of an existing fund that would be complex to explain.

THE TRAP

Saying yes because the client is large.

WHAT TO SAY

"I'd take it seriously and ask the hard question early: can we explain this honestly to everyone who'd end up in it? If it needs three paragraphs of caveats to be accurate, that's a problem worth surfacing before we build it, not after."

WHY IT WORKS

This is MiFID II product governance thinking: a product needs a defined target market and the distributor needs to be able to sell it into that market.^[S16] The fulcrum fee is the firm's own cautionary tale about a good idea that was hard to explain.^[S72]

THE TWIST, AND HOLDING IT

Twist: "They're threatening to go elsewhere." Answer: "Then that's a decision for people above me, and I'd make sure they had the explainability problem in front of them when they made it."

You are asked whether a fund should be labelled sustainable**HARD****THE SETUP**

There is internal appetite to market a fund on its sustainability characteristics.

THE TRAP

Treating it as a marketing decision.

WHAT TO SAY

"That's not a naming choice, it's a regulatory one. The anti-greenwashing rule has applied since 31 May 2024, and the FCA's naming and marketing rules since 2 December 2024, so the fund has to actually qualify. I'd start with whether it meets the criteria, not with what we'd like to call it."

WHY IT WORKS

Correct, precisely dated, and it reframes a commercial question as a compliance one — which is exactly the instinct this seat requires.^[S19]
^[S20]

THE TWIST, AND HOLDING IT

Twist: "Competitors are doing it." Answer: "Then some of them may have a problem coming. I'd rather we didn't."

Duty line 5 · "Generating marketing material to support sales activity"**Sales wants the deck an hour before the meeting****EASY****THE SETUP**

A salesperson needs a pitchbook for a meeting this afternoon; compliance has not signed it off.

THE TRAP

Sending it and asking forgiveness.

WHAT TO SAY

"I'd send what's already approved and tell them clearly which slides aren't cleared yet and can't be used. Then I'd chase compliance with the actual deadline attached, because they can often prioritise if they know."

WHY IT WORKS

It solves the real problem — the salesperson needs something usable — without breaking the control. It also shows you treat compliance as a person with a queue rather than an obstacle.

THE TWIST, AND HOLDING IT

Twist: "They used it anyway." Answer: "Then I'd tell my manager the same day. That's not me reporting a colleague, that's a control failure someone needs to know about."

The claim is technically true and clearly misleading

MEDIUM

THE SETUP

A draft says the fund is "top quartile" — true, over a carefully chosen period that is not the standard one.

THE TRAP

Defending it because it is factually accurate.

WHAT TO SAY

"It's true and I still don't think it passes. COBS 4.2 is a fair, clear and not misleading test, not a technically-accurate test, and Consumer Duty adds a consumer understanding requirement on top. If the period is doing the work, a reader is being misled by a true sentence."

WHY IT WORKS

The distinction between *true* and *not misleading* is the most important conceptual point in this whole job, and very few candidates will articulate it. ^{[S14][S401]}

THE TWIST, AND HOLDING IT

Twist: "Everyone quotes their best quartile." Answer: "Some do. It's still the rule, and it's the kind of thing that looks very bad in hindsight if the fund turns."

You are asked to remove a risk warning because it spoils the page

HARD

THE SETUP

A designer or a salesperson wants a warning moved to the back, or shrunk, for the sake of the layout.

THE TRAP

Treating prominence as an aesthetic matter.

WHAT TO SAY

"Prominence is part of the rule, not part of the design. COBS 4.6.2R requires a prominent warning that past performance is not a reliable indicator of future results, and says the performance itself can't be the most prominent feature. Moving it to the back is the thing the rule is specifically about."

WHY IT WORKS

It demonstrates you know the rule constrains *layout*, not just words. This is genuinely specialist knowledge for a candidate at this stage. ^[S400]

THE TWIST, AND HOLDING IT

Twist: "You're being inflexible." Answer: "On this one, yes. I'd happily redesign the page around it — the constraint is the warning's prominence, not where everything else sits."

Intern line 1 · "Support investment directing and investment specialists"

You have finished your work and nobody has given you more

EASY

THE SETUP

It is 3pm in week two and your task is done.

THE TRAP

Sitting quietly, or asking "is there anything I can help with?" into the void.

WHAT TO SAY

"I'd go to someone specific with something specific: 'I've finished the attribution check. I noticed the Q2 factsheets still need the commentary pulled across — shall I start on those?' Asking a narrow question is much easier to say yes to."

WHY IT WORKS

Interns who make themselves easy to delegate to get given real work. It is the single highest-return behaviour of a ten-week internship.

THE TWIST, AND HOLDING IT

Twist: "What if you're wrong about what's needed?" Answer: "Then they'll tell me, and I've still shown I was paying attention to what the team is doing."

Two people ask you for different things at once**MEDIUM****THE SETUP**

Two investment directors, both senior to you, both want something by the end of the day.

THE TRAP

Silently picking one, and letting the other discover it late.

WHAT TO SAY

"I'd tell both immediately rather than choose in private. 'I've got X from you and Y from her, both for five. X looks like two hours. Which should land first?' Then I'd confirm in writing."

WHY IT WORKS

It moves a prioritisation decision to the people who can actually make it, which is the correct escalation, and it means nobody is surprised.

THE TWIST, AND HOLDING IT

Twist: "They both say theirs is urgent." Answer: "Then I'd ask them to settle it between them, or take it to my manager. I'm not the right person to rank two directors' priorities, and pretending I am would be the real mistake."

You are asked to sit in on a call you think you should not be on**HARD****THE SETUP**

You are invited to a discussion that sounds like it involves price-sensitive information about a listed company.

THE TRAP

Staying because leaving feels rude and presumptuous.

WHAT TO SAY

"I'd ask before the call rather than during it: 'Is this one I should be on?' If something sounds like inside information once I'm there, I'd say so and leave, and tell compliance. Being wall-crossed without realising it is the outcome I'd most want to avoid."

WHY IT WORKS

The FCA's thematic review identified exactly this failure: people receiving inside information and never formally logging it.^[S17] Raising it unprompted is a very strong signal.

THE TWIST, AND HOLDING IT

Twist: "You'd really walk out of a meeting?" Answer: "I'd ask first, and I'd rather ask a slightly awkward question than be a person who has to be untangled from a list later."

Intern line 2 · "Prepare core marketing presentations and reporting materials"**Your first draft comes back covered in red****EASY****THE SETUP**

You get your first piece of work back with more corrections than original text.

THE TRAP

Taking it personally, or apologising at length.

WHAT TO SAY

"I'd read every change and work out the category — is it accuracy, house style, or judgement? Then I'd ask one consolidated question about the judgement ones and not make the style mistakes twice."

WHY IT WORKS

It shows you treat feedback as information rather than as a verdict, and grouping questions rather than asking sequentially respects the reviewer's time.

THE TWIST, AND HOLDING IT

Twist: "Does it bother you?" Answer: "A bit, the first time. But an unmarked first draft in this job would mean nobody checked it, which is worse."

You are asked to produce something you have never seen before**MEDIUM****THE SETUP**

Someone asks for a DDQ response and you do not know what one is.

THE TRAP

Pretending, then producing something wrong.

WHAT TO SAY

"I'd say I haven't done one and ask for a good recent example to work from. In most of this work there's an approved library, so the right first question is 'what's the best previous version of this?' rather than starting from scratch."

WHY IT WORKS

Understanding that this output is assembled from approved components rather than written fresh is a genuinely inside-baseball insight.

THE TWIST, AND HOLDING IT

Twist: "There's no example." Answer: "Then I'd draft a structure first and get that agreed before writing any content, so we find out early if I've misunderstood the ask."

You realise the approved library itself is out of date**HARD****THE SETUP**

The standard approved answer you are copying refers to something that has since changed.

THE TRAP

Using it, because it is approved and therefore someone else's problem.

WHAT TO SAY

"I'd flag it rather than use it. Approved means it was checked at a point in time, not that it's still true. If the underlying fact has changed, reusing it makes it a new misstatement with my name on it."

WHY IT WORKS

This is the difference between following a process and understanding it, and it is precisely the judgement the role is ultimately paid for.

THE TWIST, AND HOLDING IT

Twist: "That's not your call as an intern." Answer: "Agreed, which is why I'd flag it rather than change it. But not mentioning it would be a call too."

Intern line 3 · "Work with internal stakeholders to source key data and obtain the latest internal views"**A portfolio manager has not replied to you****EASY****THE SETUP**

You need a view from a PM for a deadline tomorrow and two emails have gone unanswered.

THE TRAP

Continuing to email, or escalating immediately.

WHAT TO SAY

"I'd change channel and make it easy to answer: go to the desk or send one short message with the deadline and a suggested answer they can just confirm or correct. Busy people answer yes-or-no questions much faster than open ones."

WHY IT WORKS

Drafting the answer for someone to approve is the single most useful habit in this job.

THE TWIST, AND HOLDING IT

Twist: "Still nothing." Answer: "Then I'd tell my manager before the deadline, not after, and let them decide whether to push or to change the plan."

You are not sure you understood what the analyst told you**MEDIUM****THE SETUP**

An analyst explained their view quickly and you are about 70% sure you followed it.

THE TRAP

Writing it up at 70% and hoping.

WHAT TO SAY

"I'd write it up and send it back: 'Here's how I've captured your view — have I got this right?' That's a thirty-second check for them and it protects both of us."

WHY IT WORKS

A misquoted analyst is a real problem. Confirming back is standard practice and marks you as safe to rely on.

THE TWIST, AND HOLDING IT

Twist: "You'll look like you weren't listening." Answer: "Checking a paraphrase reads as careful, not slow. Getting their view wrong in a client document is what actually looks bad."

Two internal sources give you different numbers**HARD****THE SETUP**

The performance system and the PM's own figure disagree.

THE TRAP

Picking the one that suits the story, or averaging them.

WHAT TO SAY

"I'd treat the official performance record as the number that goes in the document, and go back and understand the difference rather than just discarding one. The PM may be looking at a different share class or period — or there may be a genuine error, which someone needs to know about either way."

WHY IT WORKS

It shows you know which source is authoritative for a client-facing document, and that a discrepancy is information rather than an inconvenience.

THE TWIST, AND HOLDING IT

Twist: "The PM insists theirs is right." Answer: "Then I'd get them and the performance team in the same conversation. I shouldn't be the one adjudicating it, and it shouldn't go out until it's resolved."

Intern line 4 · "Assist with project management tasks as assigned by the team"**You are given work that feels beneath you****EASY****THE SETUP**

You are asked to update a spreadsheet of meeting follow-ups for a week.

THE TRAP

Visible disappointment, or doing it carelessly.

WHAT TO SAY

"I'd do it properly and then look for the improvement — if I'm doing it by hand for a week, is there a way it doesn't have to be done by hand again? Turning a dull task into a better process is the most useful thing an intern can leave behind."

WHY IT WORKS

Every senior person has watched an intern be visibly bored by admin. The ones who improve the admin get remembered.

THE TWIST, AND HOLDING IT

Twist: "What if they don't want it changed?" Answer: "Then I'll have learned why, and I've still done the task."

You realise a deadline is going to be missed**MEDIUM****THE SETUP**

Three days into a two-week project you can see it will not be ready.

THE TRAP

Waiting, hoping, and telling them on the day.

WHAT TO SAY

"I'd say so on day three, not day thirteen. Early is a problem that can be solved with more people or less scope. Late is just a failure. I'd bring a proposal rather than just the bad news."

WHY IT WORKS

The willingness to deliver bad news early is one of the clearest signals of professional maturity there is.

THE TWIST, AND HOLDING IT

Twist: "You'll look like you can't cope." Answer: "For three days, maybe. On day thirteen I'd have taken the whole team's option to fix it away."

You are asked to cover for someone else's slip**HARD****THE SETUP**

A colleague missed something and suggests presenting the timeline in a way that obscures it.

THE TRAP

Going along with it because you are junior and they are not.

WHAT TO SAY

"I wouldn't misstate the timeline. I'd also not make it about them — I'd focus on where the project actually is and what we do next. If someone asks directly what happened, I'd answer honestly rather than volunteering a colleague's mistake unprompted."

WHY IT WORKS

It holds the integrity line while showing you are not sanctimonious or eager to expose a colleague, which matters as much.

THE TWIST, AND HOLDING IT

Twist: "So you'd drop them in it?" Answer: "No. I'd tell the truth about the project. There's a big difference between not covering something up and going out of your way to point at someone."

11.6 The composure set

Five situations designed to make you uncomfortable. For each there is a decision tree simple enough to redraw from memory in the thirty seconds before you answer.

WHY THESE HAVE REAL CASES BEHIND THEM

Two of these scenarios are grounded in actual FCA enforcement, so you can reference a real consequence rather than a hypothetical one. The Woodford Equity Income Fund was suspended on 3 June 2019 holding about £3.5bn. On 11 April 2024 the FCA issued a Final Notice against Link Fund Solutions, the fund's authorised corporate director, ordering restitution of **£298,403,919** and stating it would otherwise have proposed a penalty of £50m^[S355] **Confirmed**. On 5 August 2025 the FCA announced fines of **£5,888,800** against Neil Woodford personally and £40m against Woodford Investment Management^[S356] **Confirmed**. Separately, on 14 September 2026 the Upper Tribunal upheld a lifetime ban on Crispin Odey^[S358] **Confirmed** — a pure integrity case rather than a marketing one.

You do not need to cite these unprompted. But if an interviewer asks whether the controls really matter, having one precise number is worth more than any amount of principle.

Composure 1 · Two senior people want the same scarce resource

FIGURE 30 · DECISION TREE, THE COLLISION

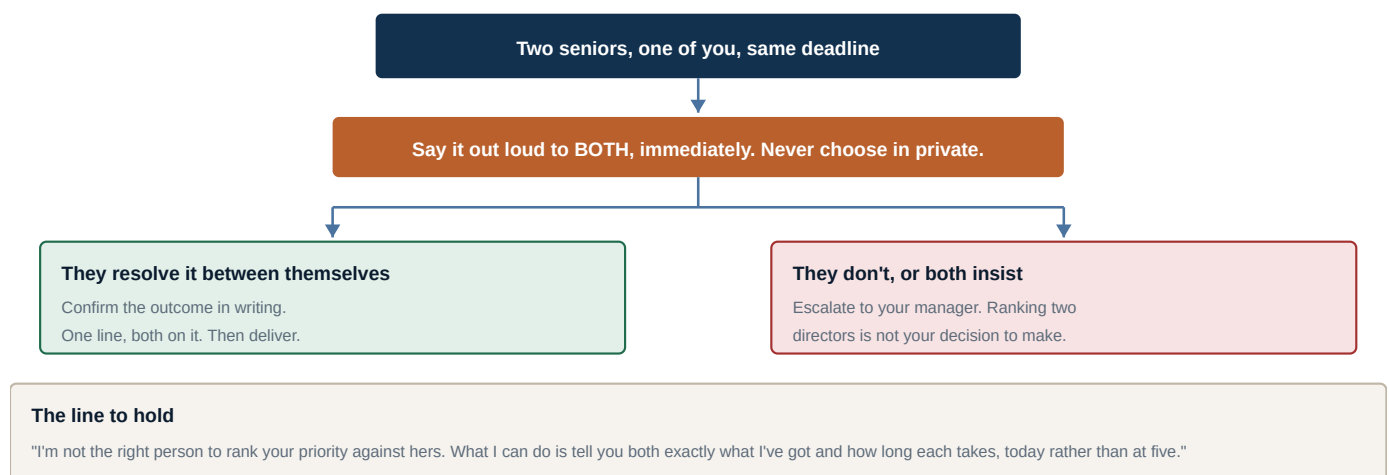


Figure 30. The collision tree. **Inferred** method. Method diagram: no external source. Devised by the author of this pack; compiled 16 September 2026.

Composure 2 · A senior person asks you to skip a control

FIGURE 31 · DECISION TREE, THE SQUEEZE

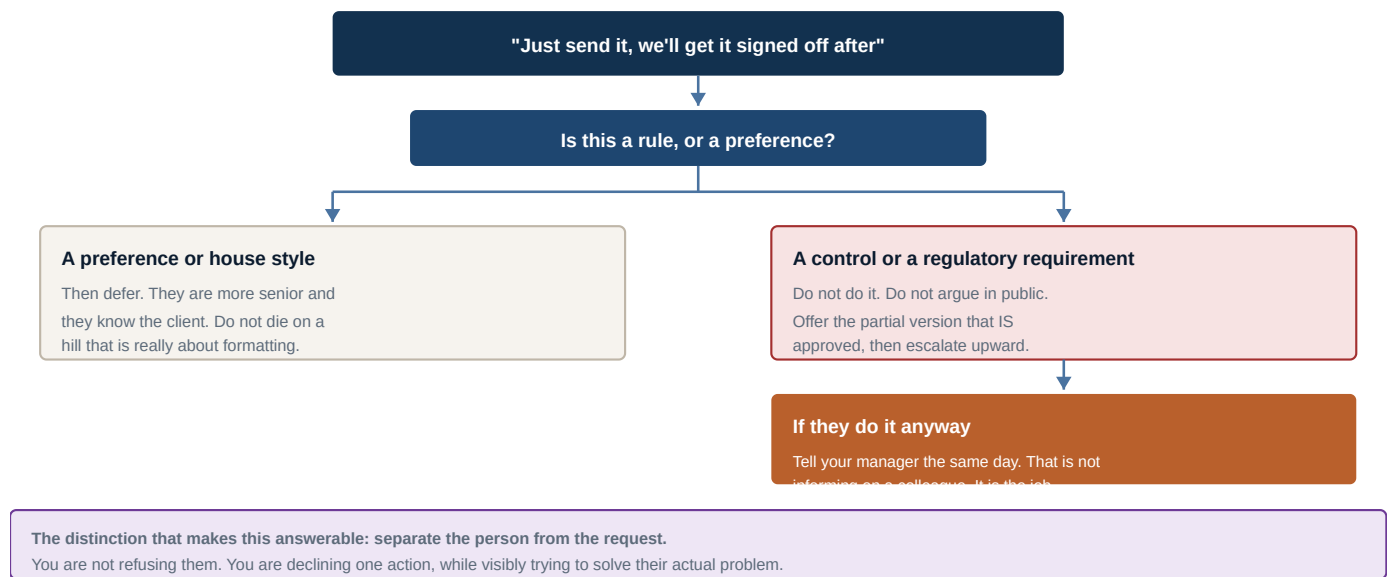


Figure 31. The authority squeeze. **Inferred** method, resting on the conduct obligations in Part 11.2. Method diagram: no external source. Devised by the author of this pack; compiled 16 September 2026.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

"I'd separate the person from the request. I'm not refusing them, I'm declining one specific action, and I'd try hard to solve the underlying problem — send the approved slides now, flag what's outstanding, chase compliance with the real deadline. If they went ahead anyway I'd tell my manager the same day. In a regulated firm that's not informing on someone, it's the control working."

Composure 3 · You hear something that might be inside information

The tree: Stop → say so immediately, in the room if possible → leave if appropriate → tell compliance the same day → write down what you heard, from whom and when → do not repeat it to anyone, including colleagues.

Why the write-down matters: the FCA's 2015 thematic review identified, as poor practice, fund managers being wall-crossed, deciding not to trade, and never logging that it happened^[S17] **Confirmed**. The record is the control. Saying that shows you understand why the paperwork exists.

The line: "I'd rather ask an awkward question in the moment than be someone who has to be untangled from a list three months later."

Composure 4 · A mistake you made

The tree: Confirm it is real → tell your manager before you fix it → establish the blast radius (who received it, is it material) → fix → propose the change that stops it recurring.

The structure for the answer: spend 20% on what happened, 20% on how fast you disclosed, 60% on what changed afterwards. Most candidates invert this and spend the whole answer on mitigation, which reads as defensiveness.

DON'T SAY THIS

"I can't think of a significant mistake." This reads as either dishonest or inexperienced, and in a regulated firm it is close to a disqualifying answer. The willingness to report your own errors is a core competence of the job, and you are being asked to demonstrate it right now.

Composure 5 · Acting on incomplete information against a deadline

The tree: Separate what you know from what you are assuming → decide whether the gap is material to the decision → if not, proceed and state the assumption in writing → if yes, deliver the part that is solid, name the gap, give a time for the rest.

The principle: "Incomplete and labelled is fine. Incomplete and unlabelled is the problem." This is the answer to the false-choice tactic in Part 11.3, and it works for almost any case-study question too.

11.7 The CV grill

A good interviewer takes one line of your CV and goes three levels down. Level one is what you did. Level two is how you did it. Level three is whether you actually understood it. Most candidates are solid at level one, fine at level two, and fall apart at level three.

FIGURE 32 · HOW THREE LEVELS DEEP WORKS

One CV line: "Built a financial model for a client project"

Level 1 — "Tell me about that."

Everyone survives this. You describe the project. No information is transferred.

Level 2 — "What were the key assumptions?"

Most prepared candidates survive. You name growth rates, margins, a discount rate.

Level 3 — "Which assumption was the model most sensitive to, and how did you know?"

This is where it is decided. There is no way to answer it well without having actually done the work and thought about it. Preparation cannot fake it. Reflection can supply it.

Figure 32. The three-level attack. **Inferred** framework. Method diagram: no external source. Devised by the author of this pack; compiled 16 September 2026.

Eight attacks, and how to hold

The attack	How to hold your frame
1 "That sounds like it was mostly your team, not you."	Claim your part precisely and give the others theirs. "The analysis was mine, the client relationship wasn't. What I owned specifically was..." Over-claiming here is fatal; under-claiming is nearly as bad.
2 "Why did you choose that approach?"	Have a reason that is not "that's what we were told to do." If it was, say so and add what you would do differently now.
3 "What would you do differently?"	Have a real answer, and make it a judgement change, not a resource complaint. "More time" is not an answer.
4 "What was the actual outcome?"	If you do not know, say so: "I left before it concluded, so I genuinely don't know — what I can tell you is what we'd expected and why." Never invent a result.
5 "That doesn't sound very impressive."	Do not inflate in response. "It was a small piece of work. What made it useful to me was..." Re-anchoring on the learning beats defending the scale.
6 "Explain that to me as if I don't know the sector."	This is the job interview inside the job interview. Take it seriously. No jargon, one concrete analogy, sixty seconds. Then check: "Does that land, or shall I take a different angle?"
7 "Walk me through the numbers again — that doesn't add up."	Slow down. Go back to the source. If you cannot reconcile it live: "I can't square that from memory and I don't want to guess at it. I'll send you the workings." That answer is fine here for exactly the reasons it is fine in the job.
8 "Why did you leave?" / "Why this gap?"	One clean sentence, no defensiveness, no criticism of anyone, then forward. Length signals discomfort more than content does.

THE FOUR-LINE DRILL — DO THIS FOR EVERY BULLET ON YOUR CV

1. **What I did**, in one sentence, with my part clearly separated from the team's.
2. **One number** attached to it, that I can defend and explain the source of.
3. **The hardest judgement call** I made, and why I made it that way.
4. **What I'd do differently**, phrased as a change in judgement rather than a change in circumstances.

Four lines per bullet. If your CV has ten bullets that is forty lines, which is about an hour of work and covers perhaps 70% of everything you will be asked. There is no higher-return preparation available to you.

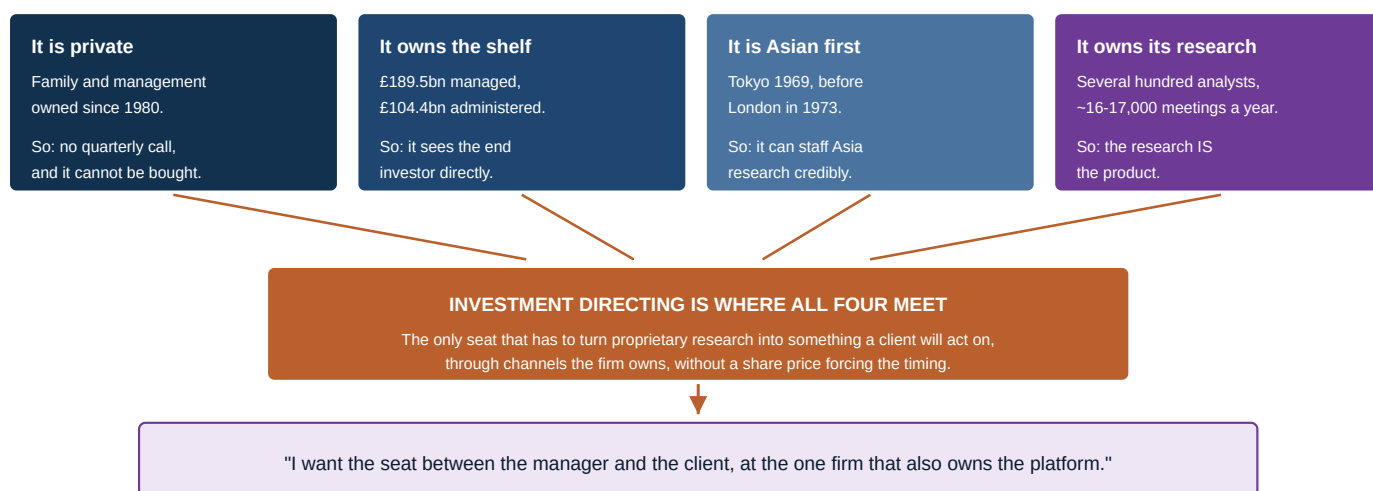
PART 12

"Why Fidelity International?"

Three lengths, a table of what everyone else will say against what you can say, and an honest list of reasons you might not want this job. Built from mechanism, not adjectives. Test: if you could swap in "Schroders" and the answer still worked, it is not finished.

FIGURE 33 · THE ANSWER ON ONE PAGE

Four mechanisms, one conclusion



The transplant test

Substitute "Schroders" into that sentence. It breaks, because Schroders does not own a UK retail platform and has an agreed acquirer. That is how you know the answer is real.

Figure 33. The mechanism map. Facts sourced throughout Parts 2 to 4; the synthesis is the author's **Inferred**. Method diagram: no external source. Devised by the author of this pack; compiled 16 September 2026.

12.1 Thirty seconds

"Fidelity International is one of very few active managers that both makes the funds and owns the distribution around them — its own retail platform, its own adviser platform, its own workplace pensions business — and it has been privately owned since splitting from the US Fidelity in 1980. That means it can invest through a cycle without a quarterly earnings call, and it also means it has to genuinely manage the conflict of selling its own funds on its own shelf. Investment Directing sits exactly on that seam: turning what the analysts and portfolio managers are doing into something a client can actually act on. That's the part of this industry I find most interesting — not picking the stock, but explaining and defending the decision to the people whose money it is."

Roughly 90 words. Say it in about 30 seconds. Do not speed up.

12.2 Two minutes

Build outward from the same spine. Four beats, roughly 30 seconds each.

- The structure, with a number.** The 30-second version, plus the audited UK figures: £189.5bn managed and £104.4bn administered^[S78]. Add that you had to get those from Companies House filings because the parent is private and publishes no group accounts — which tells them how you research.
- The cost, stated honestly.** That structure drags group operating margin to roughly 5% against roughly 27% for the fund management entity alone^{[S77][S78]}, and it carries a real conflict governed by SYSC 10^[S304], with a whole-of-market platform as the visible mitigant^[S305]. Showing you can name the cost of the thing you admire is what makes the admiration credible.

3. **The industry context, with the counter-case conceded.** Passive took 70.4% of UK platform net inflows in Q2 2026^[S232] and most active funds underperform over most horizons^[S307]. So the case for a firm like this cannot be "we beat the index". It is depth of proprietary research, Asia access going back to 1969, and one relationship across a saver's whole life.
4. **Why this seat, specifically.** If distribution is becoming the competitive edge rather than performance^[S192], then the function that translates investment capability into something clients act on is where the firm's advantage actually gets realised. And everything it produces is a regulated communication under COBS 4.2, which makes it a technical craft, not a marketing one^[S14].

12.3 The close

"The specific thing I want to get good at is reading a factsheet and portfolio commentary the way someone in this team reads it — not just what the fund holds, but what story the positioning is meant to tell a client, and where the honest caveats sit. I've started doing it with Tom Stevenson's quarterly outlooks, since he does this job in public. I'd like to learn to do it properly."

Concrete, checkable, and it names a real person doing the real job. Adapt it once you have actually read a few.

12.4 What most candidates will say, and what you can say

Theme	What most will say	What you can say
Why here	"A big, well-known global asset manager with a strong reputation."	"One of a small number of active managers that owns manufacturing and distribution end to end, and has been private since the 1980 split — which changes its incentives against a listed peer, especially now two of its closest comparators are being acquired."
Size	Quotes one number, often the Boston firm's.	"Public figures range from about \$469bn of managed assets to over a trillion of total client assets depending on whether platform money is counted. They're private, so it's hard to pin down — and the gap between those numbers <i>is</i> the business model."
Ownership	Does not mention it, or says "it's private."	"Family and management owned, with the family reported at just under 40% of voting stock — though that figure appears to date from 2012, so I'd treat it as indicative rather than current."
Research	"Fidelity has great research."	"Several hundred investment professionals and somewhere between sixteen and seventeen thousand company meetings a year, depending which of their own pages you read. The point is that it's a shared fixed cost, which only works if every asset class uses it."
Active vs passive	Avoids it, or defends performance.	States the counter-case unprompted with figures, then makes the narrower and more defensible case for where active earns its fee.
Conflicts	Does not realise there is one.	Names the conflict, names SYSC 10, and names the mitigant.
The role	"I want client-facing exposure."	"It's the PM proxy seat — your own advert uses that phrase — sitting under Distribution rather than the CIO, which tells you it's a commercial function that has to be technically credible."
Regulation	Says "compliance is important."	COBS 4.2, COBS 4.6.2R on performance windows, Consumer Duty's understanding outcome, and the live CCI transition to June 2027.

12.5 The counter-case: honest reasons not to want this

Think these through. If one of them genuinely bothers you, better to know now than in March 2027.

- **It is not an investing job.** The duties are support and translation: material, reporting, sourcing other people's views, project work. If what you actually want is to generate ideas, this is adjacent to that, not inside it. Interviewers can tell, and they will ask.
- **The output is constrained by design.** You will spend real time on wording, sign-off and version control. If that reads to you as bureaucracy rather than craft, ten weeks will feel long.
- **You are defending a proposition under pressure.** Most active funds underperform their benchmark over most horizons^[S307]^[S308]. If you find the passive argument more convincing than the active one, you should reckon with that honestly rather than

spend a career arguing against your own view.

- **Less transparency than a listed firm.** The clearest ownership figure available appears to be from 2012^[S79]. If you want an employer whose numbers you can fully see, this is not that.
- **It has been cutting.** Around 1,000 roles globally in March 2024^[S142], UK headcount down about 13%^[S78], and senior investment turnover. A stable private firm is not the same as a firm that is not under pressure.

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

Pick the one of these that most concerns you and write your honest answer to it. If asked "what worries you about this role?" — and in a strengths-based process you may well be — a specific, thought-through concern is a far better answer than "nothing, I'm just excited." The second one is not believed by anybody.

PART 13

The cheat sheet

One page. Print it. Read it in the twenty minutes before you go in, then put it away — walking in holding notes changes how you sit.

Fidelity International · Investment Directing

Apply by Sun 15 Nov 2026, 11:55pm GMT. Two assessments, ~40 min each, due by then.

Compiled 16 Sep 2026 — re-check the leadership page and market levels on the day.

THE FOUR-STEP PROTOCOL

Steady "Let me take that in order, there are two things going on."

Sort "The tension is between X and Y. Y binds."

Act "First I'd... then I'd... and I'd tell [person] that [consequence]."

Close State the principle. Hand it back with a question.

THE PRIORITY ORDER

1 The rules and the licence → 2 Fair treatment of every client → 3 The process and the record → 4 Speed.

"We can be late and explain it. We can't be wrong and unexplain it."

THE NEVER LIST

- Never confuse this firm with Fidelity Investments, Boston.
- Never say "your CEO Anne Richards". Chair Abigail Johnson, Vice Chair Anne Richards, President Keith Metters.
- Never quote a single AUM figure as fact.
- Never bluff. "I don't know, here's how I'd find out" is a strong answer.
- Never claim it is the biggest or best-performing.
- Never describe the role as portfolio management.
- Never say Class of 2027. It is **2028**.

THE EIGHT FRAME-BREAKERS, COUNTERED

Interruption stop, answer, then reclaim. **Contradiction** "It may be — here's my source, what am I missing?" **Silence** stop talking.

Escalation principle doesn't move, urgency does. **Authority** separate person from request. **False choice** name a third option. **Knowledge trap** say you don't know. **Badmouth bait** generous about people, specific about problems.

LINES TO HAVE READY

- "Your own advert calls it a **PM proxy**."
- "It sits under Distribution, not the CIO — a commercial function that has to be technically credible."
- "It's a regulated-communications job before it's a marketing one."
- "You can't pick a flattering start date. COBS 4.6 fixes the window."
- "The gap between managed and administered assets is the business model."
- "Two of your closest peers are being acquired. You can't be."

NUMBERS, IF ASKED

UK assets managed	£189.5bn at 31 Dec 2024
UK assets administered	£104.4bn — the platform
UK turnover	£1,228m FY2024, flat
UK operating profit	£66.8m, down from £103.1m
UK headcount	2,941 average, from 3,370
Group size	~\$469bn managed to ~\$1.09trn client assets — give the range
Ownership	Family ~39.89% of voting stock, reported, 2012 vintage
Founded / split	1969 / independent 1980. "Over 50 years", "25+ locations"
Q2 2026 UK flows	Passive 70.4%, active 29.6%
UK industry	£11.1trn in 2025, up 11%

RULES, WITH DATES

COBS 4.2.1R fair, clear and not misleading.

COBS 4.6.2R past performance: not most prominent; five years in complete 12-month periods; prominent warning; currency and fee disclosure.

Consumer Duty PS22/9, 27 Jul 2022; in force 31 Jul 2023.

Anti-greenwashing 31 May 2024. **Fund naming** 2 Dec 2024.

CCI replaces PRIIPs from 6 Apr 2026, full by 8 Jun 2027.

ONE QUESTION TO ASK

"Investment Directing seems to sit under Distribution rather than the CIO. Does it feel like a commercial function that has to be technically credible, or the other way round? I'd imagine that shapes the day quite a lot."

Before you go in: breathe out longer than in, twice. Slow the first sentence. Both feet on the floor.

Full sourcing in Part 15.

PART 14

Glossary

80 terms. Every one of these appears somewhere in this pack, defined in plain English. If you can define thirty of them without looking, you are ahead of almost every other applicant.

Active management

Choosing investments in an attempt to beat a benchmark, rather than tracking it. Costs more; most funds do not beat their benchmark over long horizons.

Active share

How much a portfolio's holdings differ from its benchmark's, as a percentage. Low active share plus a high fee is the "closet tracker" problem.

Adviser platform

Technology through which financial advisers hold and administer client investments. Fidelity Adviser Solutions is one.

Alpha

Return above what the benchmark explains. The thing active management claims to produce.

AMC

Annual management charge. The manager's own fee, distinct from the fund's total costs.

Anti-greenwashing rule

FCA rule in force from 31 May 2024 requiring any sustainability claim about a product or service to be fair, clear and not misleading.

Assessment of Value

An annual public report a UK fund manager must publish judging whether each of its funds delivers value. In force since September 2019.

Attribution

Breaking a portfolio's return against its benchmark into causes: stock selection, sector or asset allocation, duration, currency.

AUA

Assets under administration. Money held on a platform that the firm may not manage. Earns a thinner service fee than AUM.

AUM

Assets under management. Money the firm actually invests, and charges a management fee on.

AUMA

Assets under management and administration combined. A wider measure; check which one a figure refers to.

Basis point (bp)

One hundredth of one per cent. The unit fees are quoted in. 35 bps on £1,000 is £3.50 a year.

Benchmark

The index or yardstick a fund is measured against. Choosing a flattering one is a conduct issue, not a presentational choice.

Beta

Sensitivity to the market as a whole. Broadly, the return you get for simply being invested.

Buy list

The approved list of funds a wealth manager, platform or consultant will recommend. Getting on it is the commercial prize.

CASS

The FCA's Client Assets sourcebook, governing client money and custody assets. Fidelity's UK board runs a dedicated CASS Oversight Forum.

CCI

Consumer Composite Investments. The UK regime replacing PRIIPs, commenced 6 April 2026 with full implementation by 8 June 2027.

Client Portfolio Manager (CPM)

The industry-standard name for the seat Fidelity calls Investment Director. A client-facing investment professional who represents a strategy but does not run it.

Closed-ended

A fund with a fixed number of shares, such as an investment trust. The share price can differ from the value of the underlying assets.

COBS

The FCA's Conduct of Business sourcebook. COBS 4 governs financial promotions and is the rulebook this role lives inside.

COCON

The FCA's Code of Conduct sourcebook, containing the Individual Conduct Rules that apply to almost everyone at a regulated firm.

Composite

A grouping of similar portfolios whose combined performance is presented to prospective clients, constructed to GIPS rules so a firm cannot show only its best account.

Consultant

An adviser to institutional investors, such as Mercer, WTW or Aon, that rates managers and effectively gatekeeps institutional searches.

Consumer Duty

FCA regime published 27 July 2022 as PS22/9, in force for open products 31 July 2023. Four outcomes: products and services, price and value, consumer understanding, consumer support.

Custodian

The institution that physically holds a fund's assets, separately from the manager who decides what to buy.

DB pension

Defined benefit. Promises a set income; the employer carries the investment risk. Largely closed and de-risking in the UK.

DC pension

Defined contribution. Builds a pot; the member carries the risk. Where UK savings growth and policy attention sit.

DDQ

Due diligence questionnaire. A structured set of questions about how a firm is run, answered largely from an approved library.

Default fund

Where a workplace pension member's money goes if they make no choice. Most members never choose, so the default carries enormous responsibility.

Depositary

An independent body that oversees a fund and polices the manager's compliance with the rules.

Drawdown

Two meanings. The peak-to-trough fall in a portfolio's value; and, in pensions, taking income from a pot rather than buying an annuity.

Duration

A bond portfolio's sensitivity to interest rate changes. Longer duration means bigger moves for a given rate change.

ETF

Exchange-traded fund. A fund traded on an exchange like a share. Historically index-tracking; increasingly also actively managed.

Factsheet

The standard monthly or quarterly one- or two-page fund summary. A core output of this role and a regulated communication.

Fee compression

The long-run fall in what managers can charge. Active funds now average under 60 bps against roughly 10 bps for passive.

Financial promotion

In FCA terms, an invitation or inducement to engage in investment activity. Most of what this team produces is one.

Flows

Money coming in (inflows) and going out (outflows). Net flows is the difference, and is the number the function is ultimately judged on.

Four-eyes principle

Nothing client-facing goes out on one person's say-so. At least one preparer and one independent reviewer.

Fulcrum fee

A fee that moves with performance. Fidelity's version ran from July 2018 with a 0.65% base flexing between 0.45% and 0.85%, withdrawn from open-ended funds in May 2021.

GIPS

Global Investment Performance Standards. Rules for calculating and presenting performance, widely required in institutional RFPs.

Greenwashing

Overstating the sustainability characteristics of a product. Now specifically prohibited by an FCA rule.

Illiquid

Hard to sell quickly at a fair price. Property and private assets are illiquid, which changes how they must be explained and valued.

Information barrier

Also "Chinese wall". A control that stops sensitive information passing between parts of a firm. Governed by FCA SYSC 10.

Institutional

Large professional investors: pension schemes, insurers, sovereign wealth funds, endowments.

Investment Director

Fidelity International's house title for the client-facing investment specialist seat. Junior grade: Associate Investment Director.

Investment trust

A closed-ended, listed company whose business is holding investments. Has an independent board and one share class.

ISA

Individual Savings Account. A UK tax wrapper, not an investment in itself.

KID / KIID

Key information document. The short standardised disclosure a retail investor receives. Being replaced under the CCI regime.

LTAF

Long-Term Asset Fund. A UK structure letting long-term savers hold illiquid private-market assets. Fidelity was authorised for its first in August 2025.

Mandate

An instruction to manage money to agreed rules. "Winning a mandate" means being hired.

Mansion House Accord

Signed 13 May 2025. Seventeen DC providers committed to 10% of default funds in private markets by 2030, with 5% ringfenced for UK assets.

MiFID II

EU and UK regime in force from January 2018. Unbundled research from dealing commission and introduced product governance and target markets.

MNPI

Material non-public information. Price-sensitive information not yet public. Acting or dealing on it is market abuse.

Multi asset

Portfolios holding several asset classes at once. One of Fidelity's five investment groups.

NAV

Net asset value. What a fund's assets are worth per unit or share, usually struck daily.

OCF

Ongoing charges figure. The total annual cost of running a fund, including the AMC. The number an investor should actually compare.

OEIC

Open-ended investment company. A standard UK pooled fund structure; grows and shrinks as investors buy and sell.

Open-ended

A fund that issues and cancels units as money arrives and leaves, so the price tracks the underlying assets.

Passive

Tracking an index rather than trying to beat it. Cheap, and taking the large majority of new money.

Performance fee

An additional charge levied if a fund beats a hurdle. Rewards risk-taking rather than asset-gathering.

PM proxy

A portfolio manager's stand-in for client-facing work. Fidelity's own advert uses this phrase for the Investment Director role.

PRIIPs

The disclosure regime behind the KID, now being replaced in the UK by the CCI regime.

Product governance

The MiFID II requirement to define a fund's target market and review it over time, and to equip distributors to sell only into that market.

RFP

Request for proposal. The formal document a prospective client or consultant issues when hiring a manager. Scored against competitors.

SDR

Sustainability Disclosure Requirements. The FCA regime from PS23/16, published 28 November 2023, including labels and fund naming rules.

Segregated mandate

A single client's own portfolio, run to its own rules, rather than a pooled fund.

Share class

Different versions of the same fund with different fees, currencies or minimums. A frequent source of performance figures that do not match.

Sharpe ratio

Return earned per unit of volatility taken. A measure of risk-adjusted performance.

SICAV

A common continental European pooled fund structure, broadly the equivalent of a UK OEIC.

SIPP

Self-invested personal pension. A UK pension wrapper allowing the holder to choose investments.

SM&CR

Senior Managers and Certification Regime. Makes named individuals accountable. Extended to asset managers from December 2019.

SYSC 10

The FCA rules on conflicts of interest and information barriers. The framework governing selling your own funds on your own platform.

Target market

The defined group of investors a product is designed for. Marketing must be consistent with it.

Tracking error

How much a fund's returns have deviated from its benchmark, annualised. Not the same as active share.

UCITS

An EU regulatory standard for retail funds, widely trusted and used well beyond Europe.

Unit trust

A UK pooled fund structure holding assets in trust for investors. Practically similar to an OEIC for the investor.

Value chain

The full sequence from saver to security: adviser, platform, manager, broker, custodian, depositary, administrator.

Wall-crossing

Being formally brought inside a wall and given inside information, with the obligation to log it and not deal. The FCA's 2015 thematic review set out good and poor practice.

Wholesale

The intermediary market: fund selectors, wealth managers, private banks. Distinct from both retail and institutional.

Workplace pensions

Pensions provided through an employer. One of Fidelity International's three UK distribution channels.

PART 15

Source table

Every source marker used in this pack, with outlet, title, publication date, URL, access date and how it was obtained. 119 sources. VERBATIM means the full text was supplied directly. FETCHED means the page was read in full. SNIPPET means only a search-result summary was seen. PAYWALLED means the content was not read and was not guessed at.

HOW TO READ THE STATUS COLUMN

Treat SNIPPET and PAYWALLED rows as weaker evidence. If a claim in this pack matters to an answer you plan to give, check the status of its source here first. Several notable facts rest on single sources, and this table is where you find that out.

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL	Status	Accessed
S1	Built In (job board, Fidelity International posting)	Associate Investment Director - Systematic Investing	Undated (live posting)	https://builtin.com/job/associate-investment-director-systematic-investing/10707832	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S2	Schroders careers site / job aggregators	Investment Director postings (Sustainable Investment Advisory & Integration, London; Schroders Capital Americas CPM)	Undated	https://schroders.referrals.selectminds.com/careers/jobs/investment-director-8268 (fetch failed, DNS error)	SNIPPET	2026-09-16
S3	Wall Street Careers / job aggregator (Janus Henderson)	Client Portfolio Manager postings, various	Undated	https://jobs.wallstreetcareers.com/jobs/107248436-client-portfolio-manager-and-related-listings	SNIPPET	2026-09-16
S4	CFA Institute Careers / M&G plc	Investment Specialist (Equities), London	Undated	https://careers.cfainstitute.org/job/9207862/investment-specialist/	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S5	BlackRock Careers	Investment Product Strategy & Solutions — Students & Graduates	Undated	https://careers.blackrock.com/students-and-graduates-functions-investment-product-strategy-solutions	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S6	Baillie Gifford (bailliegifford.com)	Client Manager Programme / Investment Specialist description	Undated	https://www.bailliegifford.com/en/uk/individual-investors/careers/client-manager-programme/	SNIPPET	2026-09-16
S8	Mercer	Investment manager research page	Undated	https://www.mercer.com/en-us/solutions/investments/wealth-managers/investment-manager-research/	SNIPPET	2026-09-16
S10	Fidelity Careers (careers.fidelityinternational.com)	Investment Management — professionals overview	Undated	https://careers.fidelityinternational.com/professionals-overview/investment-management/	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S11	Mercer (via search summary, not independently re-verified ag)	Manager research / ratings as prerequisite for search inclusion	Undated	https://www.mercer.com/en-us/solutions/investments/wealth-managers/investment-manager-research/	SNIPPET	2026-09-16
S12	GOV.UK	Investment consultants market investigation (CMA case page)	Case opened 2017 (page itself)	https://www.gov.uk/cma-cases/investment-consultants-market-investigation	SNIPPET	2026-09-16
S13	Responsive / Callan Consulting (via Responsive blog)	Study on RFP software and win-rate uplift	Undated	https://www.responsive.io/blog/asset-management-rfp	SNIPPET	2026-09-16
S14	FCA Handbook	COBS 4.2 Fair, clear and not misleading communications	Rule text as currently in fo	https://handbook.fca.org.uk/handbook/cobs4/cobs4s2	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S16	FCA	MiFID II: product governance review (multi-firm review)	Undated	https://www.fca.org.uk/publications/multi-firm-reviews/mifid-ii-product-governance-review	SNIPPET	2026-09-16

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL	Status	Accessed
S17	Osborne Clarke (law firm insight, citing FCA Thematic Review	"Wall-crossings and inside information: good practice, poor practice from the FCA"	FCA review published 2 March	https://www.osborneclark.co.uk/insights/wall-crossings-and-inside-information-good-practice-poor-practice-from-the-fca	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S18	CFA Institute	Overview of the Global Investment Performance Standards (GIPS)	2026 refresher reading	https://www.cfainstitute.org/insights/professional-learning/refresher-readings/2026/overview-of-the-global-investment-performance-standards	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S19	FCA	News statement, "FCA sets out temporary measures for firms on 'naming and marketing' sustainability rules"	Undated statement, describes	https://www.fca.org.uk/news/statements/fca-sets-out-temporary-measures-firms-naming-and-marketing-sustainability-rules	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S20	FCA	PS23/16, Sustainability Disclosure Requirements (SDR) and investment labels	Published 28 November 2023	https://www.fca.org.uk/publications/policy-statements/ps23-16-sustainability-disclosure-requirements-investment-labels	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S21	Bright Network	Investment Directing Summer Internship 2026 — Fidelity International	Undated (live/recent posting)	https://www.brightnetwork.co.uk/graduate-jobs/fidelity-international/investment-directing-summer-internship-2026	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S41	Fidelity Careers (fidelityinternational.com)	Investment Management - Fidelity Careers	undated, live page	https://careers.fidelityinternational.com/professionals-overview/investment-management/	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S43	eFinancialCareers	jobs in London at Fidelity International	live listing at time of sear	https://www.efinancialcareers.com/jobs/at-fidelity-international/in-london,-uk	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S44	eFinancialCareers	jobs in Hong Kong at Fidelity International	live listing at time of sear	https://www.efinancialcareers.com/jobs/at-fidelity-international/in-hong-kong,-hong-kong	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S45	eFinancialCareers	jobs in Dublin at Fidelity International	live listing at time of sear	https://www.efinancialcareers.com/jobs/at-fidelity-international/in-dublin,-ireland	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S47	LinkedIn (job ad)	Investment Director, Fixed Income - Fidelity International	live at time of search	https://hk.linkedin.com/jobs/view/investment-director-fixed-income-at-fidelity-international-4169446709	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S48	Built In	Associate Investment Director - Systematic Investing - Fidelity International	live at time of search	https://builtin.com/job/associate-investment-director-systematic-investing/10707832	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S53	Troy Today (Troy University news)	"Young adding new responsibilities at Fidelity as Global Head of Asset Management Distribution"	26 November 2024	https://today.troy.edu/news/young-promoted/	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S64	J.P. Morgan Asset Management	"Our integrated team model"	page as accessed	https://am.jpmorgan.com/us/en/asset-management/institutional/media/our-integrated-team-model/	SNIPPET	2026-09-16
S70	Wikipedia	"Fidelity International"	undated (live page)	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Fidelity_International	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S72	Portfolio Adviser	"Fidelity International drops fulcrum fees following muted demand from retail investors"	11 May 2021	https://portfolioadviser.com/fidelity-international-drops-fulcrum-fees-following-muted-demand-from-retail-investors/	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S73	Investment Week	"Fidelity International eyes LTAF launch as private assets co-CIO exits"	16 May 2024	https://www.investmentweek.co.uk/news/4208923/fidelity-international-eyes-ltfa-launch-private-assets-cio-exits	PAYWALLED	2026-09-16
S76	Fidelity International (fidelityinternational.com, via web.a	"About us"	archived copy, data as at 30	https://web.archive.org/web/2025/https://www.fidelityinternational.com/about-us/	FETCHED	2026-09-16

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL	Status	Accessed
S77	Companies House (filed accounts)	"FIL Investment Services (UK) Limited — Annual Report and Financial Statements, year ended 31 December 2024"	filed 21/06/2025	https://find-and-update.company-information.service.gov.uk/company/02016555/filing-history	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S78	Companies House (filed accounts)	"FIL Holdings (UK) Limited — Group Annual Report and Financial Statements, year ended 31 December 2024"	filed 21/06/2025	https://find-and-update.company-information.service.gov.uk/company/06737476/filing-history	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S79	FA-mag (Financial Advisor magazine)	"Hidden Johnson Billionaires Found In Fidelity Family Fund Empire"	undated in search snippet	https://www.fa-mag.com/news/hidden-johnson-billionaires-found-in-fidelity-family-fund-empire-12005.html	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S84	Aggregated search results (Forbes, Hubbis, RIABiz, NBC Bosto	Fidelity International ~1,000 job cuts, ~9% of staff, ~\$125m savings target, announced ~March 2024	various, dated March 2024 an	https://www.forbes.com/sites/caileygleeson/2024/03/06/fidelity-international-laying-off-1000-employees-globally/ (representative; direct fetch return e	SNIPPET	2026-09-16
S85	ETF Express, Funds Europe (aggregated search results)	Fidelity International sustainable/active ETF range expansions	October 2023, October 2024	https://etfexpress.com/2024/10/23/fidelity-international-expands-sustainable-active-etf-range-2/ (representative)	SNIPPET	2026-09-16
S89	IFA Magazine	"Fidelity International integrates private assets into its £16.9bn default investment strategy for UK-based workplace pension schemes"	2025 (exact date not confirm	https://ifamagazine.com/fidelity-international-integrates-private-assets-into-its-16-9bn-default-investment-strategy-for-uk-based-workplace-pension-sc	SNIPPET	2026-09-16
S90	Aggregated search results (Wealthbriefing, Citywire Funds In	Marion Le Morhedec appointed Global CIO Fixed Income (from AXA IM, September 2025); Steve Ellis departure; FCA reference numbers for FISL/FII/FASL/FPM	2025	https://www.wealthbriefing.com/html/article.php/fidelity-international-names-new-global-cio-of-fixed-income (representative)	SNIPPET	2026-09-16
S120	Wikipedia	Fidelity International	undated, page as accessed	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Fidelity_International	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S122	Fidelity International Careers	Investment Management (professionals overview)	undated, page as accessed	https://careers.fidelityinternational.com/professionals-overview/investment-management/	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S124	PR Newswire / Invesco	Invesco Ltd. Announces December 31, 2025 Assets Under Management	12 Jan 2026	https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/invesco-ltd-announces-december-31-2025-assets-under-management-302658784.html	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S126	Janus Henderson Investors	Janus Henderson Group plc Reports Fourth Quarter and Full-Year 2025 Results	early 2026	https://www.janushenderson.com/corporate/press-releases/janus-henderson-group-plc-reports-fourth-quarter-and-full-year-2025-results/	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S128	J.P. Morgan Asset Management	About Us (Global Liquidity page)	undated, page as accessed	https://am.jpmorgan.com/us/en/asset-management/liquidity/about-us/	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S129	Wikipedia	Schroders	undated, page as accessed	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Schroders	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S130	Wikipedia	M&G	undated, page as accessed	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/M%26G	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S131	Wikipedia	Abrdn / Aberdeen Group	undated, page as accessed	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Abrdn	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S132	Wikipedia	Janus Henderson	undated, page as accessed	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Janus_Henderson	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S133	Wikipedia	Invesco	undated, page as accessed	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Invesco	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S134	Wikipedia	Amundi	undated, page as accessed	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Amundi	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S135	Wikipedia	BlackRock	undated, page as accessed	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/BlackRock	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S137	Wikipedia	Fidelity Investments	undated, page as accessed	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Fidelity_Investments	FETCHED	2026-09-16

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL	Status	Accessed
S138	Bloomberg	Fidelity Assets Hit \$5.9 Trillion as Revenue Jumps to Record	18 Feb 2025	https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2025-02-18/fidelity-assets-hit-5-9-trillion-as-revenue-jumps-to-record	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S140	FIL Limited	Pillar 3 - Public Disclosures Report (as at 30 June 2025)	30 Jun 2025	https://www.fidelityinternational.com/static/fidelity-international/media/international/PDF/disclosure-notes.pdf	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S141	Multiple trade press (Investment Week, London Stock Exchange)	Schroders half-year results 2025 coverage	30-31 Jul 2025	https://www.rns-pdf.londonstockexchange.com/rns/2764T_1-2025-7-30.pdf ; https://www.investmentweek.co.uk/news/4524258/schroders-hits-825bn-aum-amid-si	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S142	Forbes	Fidelity International Laying Off 1,000 Employees Globally	6 Mar 2024	https://www.forbes.com/sites/caileygleeson/2024/03/06/fidelity-international-laying-off-1000-employees-globally/	PAYWALLED	2026-09-16
S143	Boston Globe	Fidelity announces job cuts and hiring spree, all at once	7 May 2026	https://www.bostonglobe.com/2026/05/07/business/fidelity-hiring-sprees-job-cuts-return-to-office/	SNIPPET	2026-09-16
S144	Citywire Selector	Fidelity International: Top-selling funds battle long tail of outflows	undated (referenced 2023 flo	https://citywire.com/selector/news/fidelity-international-top-selling-funds-battle-long-tail-of-outflows/a2431582	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S149	Institutional Investor	High Fidelity	undated	https://www.institutionalinvestor.com/article/2btgj6f5taemnjdadj4/home/high-fidelity	PAYWALLED	2026-09-16
S150	The Investment Association	UK investment management industry hits record £11.1 trillion AUM (press release)	6 Aug 2026	https://www.theia.org/news/press-releases/uk-investment-management-industry-hits-record-ps111-trillion-aum	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S152	The Investment Association	UK Investment Management Industry Reaches New Heights with £10 Trillion AUM (press release)	2025	https://www.theia.org/news/press-releases/uk-investment-management-industry-reaches-new-heights-ps10-trillion-aum	SNIPPET	2026-09-16
S166	Latham & Watkins	FCA Pushes Back Deadline for SDR Naming and Marketing Rules	2024	https://www.lw.com/en/insights/fca-pushes-back-deadline-for-sdr-naming-and-marketing-rules	SNIPPET	2026-09-16
S186	GOV.UK	Pension schemes back British growth (Mansion House Accord announcement)	13 May 2025	https://www.gov.uk/government/news/pension-schemes-back-british-growth	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S191	PwC	Asset and wealth management industry outlook to 2030	2026	https://www.pwc.com/gx/en/industries/financial-services/asset-management/asset-wealth-management-outlook.html	SNIPPET	2026-09-16
S192	BCG	Global Asset Management Report 2026: An Imperative for Growth and the New Economics of Asset Management	2026	https://www.bcg.com/publications/2026/an-imperative-for-growth-and-the-new-economics-of-asset-management	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S195	Coalition Greenwich	Asset management 2026: A laser focus on profitability	25 Feb 2026	https://www.greenwich.com/asset-management/asset-management-2026-laser-focus-profitability	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S196	Debevoise & Plimpton	Review of Sustainable Finance Disclosure Regulation — Commission Proposal Published	Nov 2025	https://www.debevoise.com/insights/publications/2025/11/review-of-sustainable-finance-disclosure-regulat	SNIPPET	2026-09-16
S210	Artemis Funds	What are the different types of funds?	current	https://www.artemisfunds.com/en-gb/individual/resources/knowledge-centre/understanding-funds/what-are-the-different-types-of-funds/	SNIPPET	2026-09-16

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL	Status	Accessed
S217	Morningstar	New Era for Asset Managers: Fee Compression, Passive Competition Erode Competitive Advantages of Active Firms	Q4 2024	https://magazine.morningstar.com/issues/q4-2024/new-era-for-asset-managers-fee-compression-passive-competition-erode-competitive-advantages-of-active-firms	SNIPPET	2026-09-16
S218	Morningstar	Active Fund Manager Success Rates Ticked Up in 2026, but Passive Funds Still Hold the Advantage	2026	https://www.morningstar.com/funds/active-fund-manager-success-rates-ticked-up-2026-passive-funds-still-hold-advantage	SNIPPET	2026-09-16
S220	Investment Week	Anne Richards steps down as Fidelity International CEO	2023-11-20	https://www.investmentweek.co.uk/news/4148440/anne-richards-steps-fidelity-international-ceo	PAYWALLED	2026-09-16
S221	Investment Week	Fidelity International replaces Anne Richards with platform boss as president	2024-03-01	https://www.investmentweek.co.uk/news/4180283/fidelity-international-replaces-anne-richards-platform-boss-president	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S222	(search-engine synthesis, no single article independently fe	"Anne Richards became Senior Adviser at Fidelity International in January 2026"	claimed Jan 2026		SNIPPET	2026-09-16
S223	Private Banker International	Fidelity weighs exit from China fund business – report	2026-08-21	https://www.privatebankerinternational.com/news/fidelity-china-fund-business-exit/	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S224	IPE	Fidelity International to integrate private markets assets into default investment strategy	undated on fetch attempt (40)	https://www.ipe.com/news/fidelity-international-to-integrate-private-markets-assets-into-default-investment-strategy/10126399.article	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S225	Professional Pensions	Fidelity International gets green light to launch private assets LTAF	2024-08-06	https://www.professionalpensions.com/news/4343633/fidelity-international-green-light-launch-private-assets-ltaf	PAYWALLED	2026-09-16
S226	ETF Express	Fidelity International expands Research Enhanced ETF range	2026-01-28 (per search list)	https://etfexpress.com/2026/01/28/fidelity-international-expands-research-enhanced-etf-range/	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S228	ESG Today	Fidelity International to Adopt FCA Sustainability Label for Three Funds	2024-11-18	https://www.esgtoday.com/fidelity-international-to-adopt-fca-sustainability-label-for-three-funds/	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S229	(search-synthesis of FIL SDR precontractual disclosure PDFs	97.00% / 73.26% sustainability-criteria coverage figures	as of 2026-02-28	https://www.fidelityinternational.com/legal/documents/en/sdrcfd.en.gb.6B00BLC81944.pdf (and equivalent for European Equity fund)	SNIPPET	2026-09-16
S230	Multiple trade outlets (PwC, Oliver Wyman, InvestmentNews, A	Asset & wealth management M&A/consolidation outlook 2026	2026 (various)		FETCHED	2026-09-16
S231	Ropes & Gray, "The Principal View"	2026-vintage megafund mean management fee fell to 1.57%	Aug 2026	https://www.ropesgray.com/en/insights/alerts/2026/08/the-principal-view-trends-shaping-private-markets-august-2026	SNIPPET	2026-09-16
S232	Money Marketing	UK passive funds capture 70% of Q2 net inflows as active flows slump	2026-07-24	https://www.moneymarketing.co.uk/news/uk-passive-funds-capture-70-of-q2-net-inflows-as-active-flows-slump/	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S234	Investment Association (theia.org press releases, primary tr	UK investment management AUM hits £11.1tn (2025); June 2026 £3.8bn inflow; July 2026 £278m inflow	2026-08-06 and 2026-09-03	https://www.theia.org/med/ia/press-releases	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S235	Macfarlanes	The Mansion House Accord and its impact on private capital markets	2025-05-14 (signing 2025-05-	https://www.macfarlanes.com/insights/102loh5/the-mansion-house-accord-and-its-impact-on-private-capital-markets/	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S236	SEC EDGAR filing index + etfdb.com	SEC exemptive relief for ETF share classes on mutual funds; Dimensional first active ETF share class	2026 (Jan/Mar/Apr filings)	https://etfdb.com/news/2026/03/20/dimensional-launches-first-active-etf-share-class/	SNIPPET	2026-09-16

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL	Status	Accessed
S237	Trading Economics	UK stock market (FTSE 100) level, YTD performance, 2026 high	2026-09-16 (live data page)	https://tradingeconomics.com/united-kingdom/stock-market	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S238	Trading Economics	UK government bond yield (10-year and 30-year gilts)	2026-09-16 (live data page)	https://tradingeconomics.com/united-kingdom/government-bond-yield	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S260	Fidelity Careers (FIL)	Our hiring process	Undated (evergreen)	https://careers.fidelityinternational.com/working-here-overview/our-hiring-process/	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S261	TargetJobs	Insider advice for the strengths-based Fidelity application process	Undated	https://targetjobs.co.uk/careers-advice/interviews-and-assessment-centres/insider-advice-strengths-based-fidelity-application-process	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S262	Fidelity Careers (FIL)	FAQs	Undated (evergreen)	https://careers.fidelityinternational.com/faqs/	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S264	practiceaptitudetests.com	Fidelity Online Assessment Tests: Practice Questions (2026)	2026	https://www.practiceaptitudetests.com/top-employer-profiles/fidelity-assessments/	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S265	JobTestPrep	Fidelity Assessment - Internship & Graduate Scheme Preparation [2026]	2026	https://www.jobtestprep.co.uk/fidelity-internship	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S266	Fintest.io	Fidelity Online Assessment: Free Practice Questions [2025]	2025	https://www.fintest.io/employers/fidelity-international/	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S267	Higherin	Equity Research Intern at Fidelity International Review 17760	Undated	https://higherin.com/review/17760/fidelity-international/equity-research-intern	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S268	Higherin	Investment Directing Intern at Fidelity International Review 17755	Undated	https://higherin.com/review/17755/fidelity-international/investment-directing-intern	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S281	Bright Network	Investment Directing Summer Internship 2026 - Fidelity International	undated listing	https://www.brightnetwork.co.uk/graduate-jobs/fidelity-international/investment-directing-summer-internship-2026	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S288	Wikipedia	Fidelity International	last edited undated, access	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Fidelity_International	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S289	Investment Week	Fidelity International appoints co-CIO to lead equities division	4 March 2024	https://www.investmentweek.co.uk/news/4181025/fidelity-international-appoints-cio-lead-equities-division	PAYWALLED	2026-09-16
S290	WealthBriefing	Fidelity International Names New Global CIO Of Fixed Income	c. mid-2025 (announcement ah)	https://www.wealthbriefing.com/html/article.php/fidelity-international-names-new-global-cio-of-fixed-income	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S291	IFA Magazine	Fidelity International 2026 Analyst Survey finds AI powers corporate rebound as cost pressures rise and geopolitical risks intensify	4 April 2026	https://ifamagazine.com/fidelity-international-2026-analyst-survey-finds-ai-powers-corporate-rebound-as-cost-pressures-rise-and-geopolitical-risks-intensify	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S295	Fidelity International (fidelity.co.uk, UK retail primary)	Investment Outlook 2026 - Quarter 2	9 April 2026	https://www.fidelity.co.uk/markets-insights/markets/global/investment-outlook-2026-quarter-2/	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S297	Fidelity International (primary)	Outlook 2026 (PDF)	2026, exact date not confirm	https://www.fidelityinternational.com/static/master/media/pdf/outlook/Fidelity-International-Outlook-2026.pdf	PAYWALLED	2026-09-16
S303	Fidelity International Careers	"Investment Management" (Professionals overview)	undated	https://careers.fidelityinternational.com/professionals-overview/investment-management/	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S304	Fidelity International Careers	Careers homepage/navigation	undated	https://careers.fidelityinternational.com/	FETCHED	2026-09-16

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL	Status	Accessed
S305	Fidelity International Careers	"Internships" (Early careers)	undated	https://careers.fidelityinternational.com/early-careers-overview/interns-and-insights/internships/	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S306	Fidelity International Careers	"Professionals overview"	undated	https://careers.fidelityinternational.com/professionals-overview/	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S307	Fidelity International Careers	"Customer Operations"	undated	https://careers.fidelityinternational.com/professionals-overview/customer-operations/	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S308	Fidelity International Careers	"Central Functions"	undated	https://careers.fidelityinternational.com/professionals-overview/central-functions/	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S309	Fidelity International Careers	"Distribution"	undated	https://careers.fidelityinternational.com/professionals-overview/distribution/	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S348	Norton Rose Fulbright	The FCA SDR Policy Statement: Some of the headlines	2023/2024	https://www.nortonrosefulbright.com/en-gb/knowledge/publications/a058fd86/the-fca-sdr-policy-statement-some-of-the-headlines	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S349	FCA	Authorised fund managers' assessments of their funds' value (multi-firm review)	ongoing/2023 review	https://www.fca.org.uk/publications/multi-firm-reviews/authorised-fund-managers-assessments-their-funds-value	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S350	FCA	COCON 2.1 Individual Conduct Rules (Handbook)	Rules 1-5 from 7 Mar 2016, R	https://www.handbook.fca.org.uk/handbook/COCON/2/1.html	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S351	FCA	COCON 1.1 Application (Handbook)	current	https://www.handbook.fca.org.uk/handbook/COCON/1/1.html	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S352	FCA	Senior Managers and Certification Regime overview	current, SM&CR extended	https://www.fca.org.uk/firms/senior-managers-certification-regime	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S355	FCA	Final Notice: Link Fund Solutions Limited	11 April 2024	https://www.fca.org.uk/publication/final-notices/link-fund-solutions-limited-2024.pdf	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S356	FCA	Press release: FCA fines over Woodford Equity Income Fund	5 August 2025	https://www.fca.org.uk/news/press-releases/fca-fines-over-woodford-equity-income-fund	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S358	FCA	Press release: Upper Tribunal upholds Crispin Odey ban	14 September 2026	https://www.fca.org.uk/news/press-releases/upper-tribunal-upholds-crispin-odey-ban	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S400	FCA Handbook	COBS 4.6 Past, simulated past and future performance (COBS 4.6.2R)	Rule text in force at access	https://www.handbook.fca.org.uk/handbook/COBS/4/6.html	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S401	FCA	PS22/9 A new Consumer Duty	Published 27 July 2022	https://www.fca.org.uk/publications/policy-statements/ps22-9-new-consumer-duty	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S402	Wikipedia	Fidelity International	Accessed 2026-09-16	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Fidelity_International	FETCHED	2026-09-16
S403	Fidelity International	Investment Directing Summer Internship 2027 — London. Full job posting, supplied verbatim by the candidate.	2026 cycle, window closing 15 Nov 2026	careers.fidelityinternational.com	VERBATIM	2026-09-16

All URLs accessed 16 September 2026. Titles truncated for layout; full titles are in the research files kept alongside this report in the repository.

PART 16

What could not be found

Every research pack has holes. Most hide them. These are this one's, listed so that you never state something confidently that rests on nothing, and so you know which questions are genuinely worth asking on the day.

16.1 The blocking constraint

Fidelity International's corporate website, fidelityinternational.com, returned access-denied responses to every automated request made during this research. Its annual report and its MIFIDPRU Pillar 3 disclosure could not be retrieved at all. The careers subdomain was reachable and was used extensively.

The workaround, and it is a good one: the UK subsidiaries are UK companies and must file audited accounts at Companies House. That is where the hard financial numbers in Part 2 come from. But it means **this pack has excellent UK data and weak global data**, and you should know which is which when you speak.

16.2 What is genuinely unknown

Gap	What this means	What to say if it comes up
Group assets under management	Public figures conflict: about \$469bn managed plus \$203bn administered at 30 June 2025, against \$1,086bn of total client assets at 31 December 2025, against \$862bn of total client assets at 30 June 2024 on the firm's own site ^{[S140][S120][S76]} . These are different measures on different dates and were not reconciled.	Give the range and name the measure. Never one number.
The ownership split	The only concrete figure is a reported 39.89% family holding of voting stock, which appears to originate in a 2012 filing ^[S79] . The employee share was never established.	"Family and management owned, with the family reported at just under 40% of voting stock, though that figure is old."
Who runs Investment Directing	A "Head of Investment Directing, Asia Pacific" is confirmed to exist because a Hong Kong advert names it as a reporting line ^[S47] . No name was found for it, and no UK or global equivalent was found at all.	Ask. It is a genuinely good question and you will not look uninformed for asking it.
The team's size	No source gives a headcount. A cross-check of five asset classes against two to three regions suggests very roughly 30 to 80 people globally ^[S40] . This is an estimate built by this research, not a published figure.	Do not quote it as fact. If pressed, explain the method and call it a guess.
The reporting line	Genuinely ambiguous in public sources. Investment Directing sits under Distribution via Client Propositions ^{[S41][S53]} , yet a London Systematic role reports to the Head of Systematic Investing instead ^[S48] . Both are real.	Present it as a matrix, and say the public record does not fully resolve it. That is more impressive than a confident wrong answer.
2027 application dates <i>CLOSED</i>	Resolved. The verbatim posting gives them: window closes Sunday 15 November 2026 at 11:55pm GMT, two online assessments of about 40 minutes each due by then, assessment centres in December and January ^[S403] . Confirmed .	Nothing. Apply, and do the assessments early.
The online test provider	Unconfirmed. "Cappfinity" and "SHL" appeared in secondary summaries, contradicted each other, and did not survive verification ^{[S264][S265]} .	Prepare for numerical and logical reasoning plus a personality or situational questionnaire, which every detailed source agrees on.

Gap	What this means	What to say if it comes up
Enforcement history	No FCA fine or censure against a Fidelity International entity was found, but the register was not checked entity by entity . Absence of evidence is not evidence of absence.	"I didn't find any in my research, though I wouldn't claim that's exhaustive." Never "they've never been fined."
The research platform's size	Two of the firm's own pages disagree: roughly 360 against 400-plus investment professionals, and roughly 16,000 against 17,000 company meetings a year ^[S306] .	Give both and note the discrepancy. It quietly proves you read more than one page.
The job description itself <i>CLOSED</i>	Resolved. The verbatim 2027 posting was supplied by the candidate and Part 1 has been rebuilt against it ^[S403] . It corrected the graduation year to Class of 2028, added two team duty lines and one intern duty line the reconstruction had missed, and fixed the office postcode to EC4M 5AB.	Nothing. Part 1 is now authoritative.
Peer team structures	How rivals organise their equivalent function, and how large those teams are, could not be verified for most of the comparison set.	Avoid claims about how Schroders or BlackRock structure this seat beyond the job titles, which are sourced.
Some senior people's current status	Anne Richards' reported move to a senior adviser role in January 2026 could not be confirmed ^[S222] . Andrew McCaffery's current title could not be pinned down. No CIO was identified for Systematic Investing or Real Estate.	Check the leadership page the week of any interview and let it override this pack.
A UK office name	The careers site names a main UK operations campus as "Kingswood Fields", Surrey, while the FCA register lists Oakhill House, Hildenborough, Kent as a registered address ^[S40] . Both may be true; it was not resolved.	Do not make a point of either.
The firm's own Outlook 2026	Located but not readable ^[S297] . The Analyst Survey 2026 was read and is safe to use ^[S291] .	Quote the Analyst Survey. Do not quote the Outlook second-hand.

16.3 Weaker evidence you should treat carefully

- **The active underperformance statistics.** The SPIVA and Morningstar figures in Parts 3 and 8 come from trade-press summaries, not the primary reports^{[S307][S308]}. They are widely reported and directionally reliable, but check the current edition before quoting an exact percentage.
- **Two of the four industry views.** The BCG and PwC material was read via search summaries because the primary reports were access-blocked^{[S192][S191]}. Attribute them as "BCG has argued" rather than quoting them as verbatim.
- **The GIPS composite mechanism.** The primary standards document could not be read; the description in this pack rests on the CFA Institute's educational material^[S18].
- **Market levels in Part 7.** Compiled on 16 September 2026 and stale by the time you read this.
- **No anti-greenwashing enforcement case exists yet** to point to. The rule is new. Do not invent an example.

16.4 The five things to check yourself before any interview

- ☐ The leadership page. Titles change, and Part 0 flags this as the highest-risk fact in the pack.
- ☐ Whether the posting has been amended since 16 September 2026, particularly the deadline.
- ☐ Market levels that morning: FTSE, gilt yields, Bank Rate.
- ☐ Any Fidelity International news in the preceding fortnight, checking each story is about the right firm.
- ☐ Whether the China reporting in Part 7.1 has developed, since it was unresolved at compile date.

A CLOSING THOUGHT ON HONESTY

The instinct this section is training is the same one the job itself requires. An Investment Director who says "I don't know, I'll check, here's what I can tell you now" is trusted. One who fills gaps with confident approximations is eventually found out, usually by a client with a spreadsheet. The habit that makes you good in the interview is the same habit that makes you good in the seat. That is not a coincidence, and it is worth saying out loud if you get the chance.